NOURISH & STRENGTHEN RECIPES

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Every recipe here, on your phone — with a shopping list that builds itself.

SCAN TO OPEN

The companion volume is **Run and Not Be Weary**.

215 recipes · Volume II of II · 2026

NOURISH & STRENGTHEN RECIPES

Around the Table

Two hundred and fifteen family recipes built from everyday pantry staples: three-minute breakfasts to Sunday roasts, by way of an afternoon at the stove, the restaurant favourites worked out at home, and a section for chocolate alone.

VOLUME II OF II

215 RECIPES · MMXXVI

NOURISH & STRENGTHEN RECIPES

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VOLUME II OF II

And did eat their meat with gladness and singleness of heart.

ACTS 2:46

How to read a recipe

Built from everyday pantry staples.

This is not an official product of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints and is not affiliated with or endorsed by the Church. It is a family's own collection.

THE NUMBER

Every recipe has one, running from 001 straight through both volumes. The contents at the front of each book lists them in order with its page.

EFFORT

Easy	No real cooking, or one pan and a few minutes.
Medium	A hot stove and some timing, but nothing that can go badly wrong.
In-depth	An afternoon, or a long slow oven, or a technique worth learning.

THE LINE UNDER THE TITLE

Servings, time, effort, and a nutrition score out of 100. Six things make it up: how much of the energy comes from protein (27 points, full marks at 45%), how many calories a serving carries (18, full marks up to 300), how much of the energy comes from fat (8, full marks at or below a tenth), how much sodium a serving carries (22, full marks to 300 mg and nothing left by 1,200), how much fiber (13, full marks at 7 g), and how much of the energy is carbohydrate that arrived without any (12).

That last one is not a carbohydrate count. Oats and frosting are both carbohydrate, and a number that cannot tell them apart is worse than no number. A gram of fiber covers ten grams of carbohydrate — roughly the ratio a whole food comes in — and only what is left over costs anything. A bowl of oats loses nothing; a mug of hot milk and brown sugar loses all twelve.

Sodium, fiber and carbohydrate are worked out from the ingredients rather than measured, in both volumes. Canned goods carry the salt; that is most of what the sodium figure is telling you.

It measures one thing only. A high score does not mean a dish is good, and a low one does not mean it is bad — a plate of fudge scores badly and is still fudge. Whether a recipe needs anything beyond the standard order is a separate question, answered on the line at its foot.

ALSO NEEDS

The line at the foot of each recipe. Either it says everything is on the standard list, or it names exactly what is not, so you know before you start rather than halfway through.

SERVINGS

Written for a household. Halving or doubling most of these is safe; baking is the exception, where the ratios are doing real work.

Temperatures and doneness

Colour is not a reliable guide. A thermometer in the thickest part is.

165°F	Chicken and turkey, every cut, and anything reheated
160°F	Ground beef and ground pork; egg dishes and casseroles
145°F	Whole cuts of beef and pork, then rested three minutes
40–140°F	The range food should not sit in. Two hours out is the limit.

> Chicken is the one to be careful with. A crisp crust, clear juices or a long time in the oven are not proof it is done — thick breasts under a sauce take far longer than they look. Where a recipe cooks chicken, it says what to check for.

OVENS LIE

Most run hot or cold by a good margin. Check five minutes before the stated time the first time you make something, and write the real time in the margin.

NO. 365 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR 15 MINS · MEDIUM 62

Homemade Tater Tots

Two Pounds of Potatoes, a Box Grater

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs potatoes
- 2 tbsp flour
- 1 tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper
- 3 tbsp oil

METHOD

1. Peel the potatoes and boil them whole 8 to 10 minutes, until a knife goes in a quarter inch and the middle is still hard.
2. Drain them and let them cool completely, at least 30 minutes. Grated warm, they turn to paste.
3. Grate them on the large holes of a box grater and toss with the flour, salt and pepper.
4. Heat the oven to 425°F and brush a baking sheet with half the oil.
5. Squeeze tablespoons of the potato into little logs and set them on the sheet. Brush them with the rest of the oil.
6. Bake 25 to 30 minutes, turning once, until deep gold and crisp.
7. To keep a batch, freeze the shaped tots on the tray before baking, then bag them. Bake them straight from the freezer and add 5 minutes.

187 kcal · 3g protein · 28g carbs · 7g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 364

10 SERVINGS · 1 HR 5 MINS · EASY 52

Fry Sauce

Two Things, One Hour

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup mayo
- ⅓ cup ketchup

METHOD

1. Stir the mayo and ketchup together until the colour is even all through.
2. Chill it an hour before it goes on the table. Straight from the bowl it tastes like its two halves; an hour later it tastes like one thing.
3. It keeps as long as the mayo would.

161 kcal · 0g protein · 2g carbs · 17g fat

All pantry staples

Weights and swaps

One cup, level, unpacked unless it says otherwise.

125 g	Flour, one cup
200 g	Granulated sugar, one cup
220 g	Brown sugar, one cup, packed
120 g	Powdered sugar, one cup
227 g	Butter, one cup — two sticks
80 g	Rolled oats, one cup
244 g	Milk or water, one cup
7 g	Yeast, one packet — 2¼ teaspoons

WHEN YOU ARE MISSING SOMETHING

Buttermilk	A cup of milk with a spoonful of vinegar or lemon juice, left ten minutes
Self-raising flour	A cup of flour with 1½ teaspoons baking powder and a pinch of salt
One egg	In a bake, three tablespoons of applesauce — not in a custard, where the egg is the point
Cake flour	A cup of flour with two tablespoons taken out and two of cornstarch put back
Sour cream	Plain yogurt, in most things that are not baked

The pantry these recipes assume

What an ordinary kitchen keeps. Anything a recipe needs beyond this is named at its foot.

CANNED MEATS	Fully cooked beef · Beef stew · Chili · Pork and beans · Tuna · Chicken breast pieces
CANNED SOUPS	Chicken rotini · Cream of chicken · Cream of mushroom · Tomato · Broth
CANNED FRUIT	Applesauce · Peaches · Pears
CANNED VEG	Corn · Green beans · Diced tomatoes · Tomato sauce · Spaghetti sauce
BEANS, RICE, POTATOES	Black beans · Pinto beans · Great Northern beans · Dry pinto beans · Refried beans · Instant potatoes · Rice
MEAT	Beef franks · Ground beef · Pork sausage · Stewing beef · Beef roast · Chicken breasts · Sliced ham · Pork roast
DAIRY AND EGGS	Butter · Cheddar · Parmesan · Cottage cheese · Eggs · 2% milk · Sour cream · Vanilla yogurt
FRESH	Apples · Bananas · Grapes · Oranges · Cucumbers · Lettuce · Bell peppers · Broccoli · Carrots · Garlic · Onions · Potatoes · Tomatoes
FLOUR AND PASTA	White flour · Pancake and waffle mix · Macaroni · Ribbon pasta · Spaghetti · Mac and cheese
CEREAL	Rolled oats · Honey nut o's · Raisin bran
BAKING	Baking powder · Baking soda · Cornstarch · Cream of tartar · Yeast · Cocoa · Chocolate chips · Evaporated milk · Raisins · Vegetable oil
SUGARS	Brown · Granulated · Powdered

NO. 363

8 SERVINGS · 8 MINS · EASY 46

Pancake Syrup

Three Minutes and Leave It Alone

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup brown sugar
- ½ cup water
- 2 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Brown sugar and water into a small pan. Stir it over medium heat only until the sugar has gone — after that, leave it alone. Stirring a boiling sugar syrup is how it turns grainy.
2. Let it boil three minutes without touching it. It will look far too thin. Sugar syrup does almost all of its thickening as it cools, and a syrup that looks right in the pan sets like a toffee in the jug.
3. Off the heat, stir in the butter until it disappears. That is what makes it taste like syrup rather than like sweet water.
4. It thickens as it cools and keeps a month in the fridge. Warm it before it goes on anything — cold syrup on a hot pancake is a bad trade.
5. It is not maple and does not pretend to be. What it is, is the difference between pancakes and no pancakes on a morning when the bottle is empty.

135 kcal · 0g protein · 27g carbs · 3g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 362 · 4 SERVINGS · 30 MINS · EASY · 60

Mashed Potatoes, in Place of Instant

Cold Water, Warm Milk

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs potatoes
- ½ cup milk
- 3 tbsp butter
- 1 tsp salt

METHOD

1. Peel and cut the potatoes into pieces of roughly the same size — two inches or so. Uneven pieces mean the small ones are falling apart while the big ones are still hard in the middle.
2. Start them in cold salted water, not boiling. Dropped into boiling water the outsides cook long before the centres, and you get a lumpy mash however hard you work at it afterwards.
3. Simmer 15 to 20 minutes, until a knife meets no resistance. Drain them and stand them in the hot empty pan a minute — the steam coming off is water that would otherwise end up in the mash. Warm the milk and butter before they go in; cold dairy stiffens it.
4. Mash, then stop. Potato has a great deal of starch in it and working it hard turns it to glue — this is the one dish where a stand mixer makes things worse. A masher, a fork, or a ricer if you have one.
5. Where a recipe wants three cups of instant made up, this quantity stands in for it; for two cups, use about two-thirds of it. It is wetter than the instant and holds together less under a topping, so for a shepherd's pie let it cool a little first.

269 kcal · 6g protein · 41g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

SEASONINGS	Salt · Black pepper · Cinnamon · Vanilla · Paprika · Garlic powder · Onion powder · Cumin · Chili powder · Oregano · Thyme · Basil · Ginger · Italian seasoning · Mustard powder · Celery salt · Taco seasoning
CONDIMENTS	Ketchup · Mustard · Mayo · Ranch · Salsa · BBQ sauce · Hot sauce · Soy sauce · Worcestershire · Vinegar · Pickles · Honey · Jams · Peanut butter · Syrup · Black olives
DRINKS AND DESSERTS	Non-fat dry milk · Hot cocoa · Gelatin · Puddings · Cake mixes
BREAD	White · Whole wheat · Hamburger buns · Hot dog buns · Tortillas · Breadcrumbs

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NO. 361

6 SERVINGS · 12 MINS · EASY 65

Cream of Chicken Soup

A White Sauce With Chicken In It

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp butter
- 3 tbsp flour
- 1 cup milk
- ½ cup water
- 5 oz canned chicken
- ½ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Melt the butter over medium heat and whisk in the flour. Let it cook a full minute, bubbling, before anything else happens. Raw flour is what makes a sauce taste like paste, and a minute is all it takes.
2. Off the heat, add the milk a splash at a time, whisking each one smooth before the next. The first half-cup is the part that decides whether it is lump-free; after that you can pour.
3. Back on the heat with the water. Stir until it comes to the boil and thickens — it will look thin for a long while and then arrive all at once.
4. Drain the chicken, break it up small, and stir it in with the salt. Simmer two minutes more.
5. This is one can. Use it anywhere a recipe opens one, straight in, no dilution. It is thicker than the tin when cold and loosens the moment it is heated.
6. Keeps four days in the fridge; it does not freeze well, as the sauce splits.

111 kcal · 7g protein · 5g carbs · 7g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 360

8 SERVINGS · 5 MINS · EASY 47

Pancake & Waffle Mix

Lumps Are Correct

INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups flour
- ¾ cup dry milk
- 3 tbsp sugar
- 1½ tbsp baking powder
- 1½ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Whisk all five together thoroughly — a full minute, not a few turns. Baking powder that is not evenly spread makes some pancakes rise and others sit there, and you will not be able to tell which is which until they are in the pan.
2. Keep it in a jar with the lid on. Six months is fine; after that the baking powder starts giving up and they come out flat. The dry milk is why it takes water: the milk is already in the jar.
3. Everyday pancakes: 1 cup of mix, ¾ cup of water, 1 egg, 2 tablespoons of oil or melted butter and half a teaspoon of vanilla. Stir until the dry patches are gone and then stop — batter that has been beaten smooth makes tough pancakes. Lumps are correct.
4. Let the batter stand five minutes before the first one goes in the pan. Medium heat, and turn each pancake when the bubbles on top stop closing over. One flip only.
5. For waffles, Recipe 178 is the Sunday method: sour cream in the batter, the whites whipped and folded in last, browned butter. Same jar.

213 kcal · 7g protein · 44g carbs · 1g fat

All pantry staples

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NO. 359

8 TORTILLAS · 45 MINS · MEDIUM

51

Flour Tortillas

Rest the Dough or Fight It

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- ⅓ cup oil
- ¾ cup warm water
- 1 tsp salt

METHOD

1. Stir the flour and salt, pour in the oil, and rub it through until it looks like damp sand. Oil before water is what keeps them soft; flour that meets water first goes tough.
2. Add the warm water, bring it together, and knead two minutes until it stops sticking. It should feel like an earlobe — too dry, wet your hands; too sticky, a spoonful of flour.
3. Cover it and leave it 20 minutes. It is not rising, it is the gluten letting go, and it is the difference between a dough you can roll thin and one that springs back every time.
4. Divide into 8 balls and roll each as thin as you can, a quarter turn between passes so they stay round. Thin is the whole thing; a thick one is a flatbread.
5. Dry skillet, medium-high, no oil. About 45 seconds until bubbles rise and the underside freckles, then 30 seconds on the other side. Longer and it is a cracker. Stack them under a towel as they come off — the steam is what softens them.

189 kcal · 3g protein · 24g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 358

6 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · EASY 63

Breadcrumbs, Dry or Soft

The Ends of the Loaf, Kept

INGREDIENTS

- 6 bread slices 295
- ½ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Decide which kind first. Soft crumbs go into meatballs and meatloaf, where the job is holding moisture. Dry crumbs go on top of things, where the job is going crisp. The same bread makes either.
2. Soft: tear fresh bread and pulse it a few seconds at a time in a blender. Stale bread will not do this, it powders. Use them the same day — in a covered jar they go mouldy in three.
3. Dry: slices straight on the oven rack at 300°F for 15 to 20 minutes, turning once, until they snap rather than bend. Cool them completely before crushing — warm bread tears instead of shattering.
4. Dry, faster: an air fryer does it in about 6 minutes at 350°F, and does it better — moving air dries the bread through instead of toasting the outside. One layer, and shake the basket once.
5. Cool them, then put them through a food processor. It is the one thing that gets crumbs even; a blender leaves half powder and half lumps.
6. Salt and nothing else. Crumbs seasoned in the jar are a decision made weeks early. Dry crumbs keep a month with the lid on, and heels and crusts are the right bread for this.

77 kcal · 3g protein · 14g carbs · 1g fat

All pantry staples

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NO. 357

10 SERVINGS · 1 HR 5 MINS · EASY 64

Lighter Mayo

Blend It Longer Than You Think

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup cottage cheese
- ¼ cup mayo
- 1 tsp mustard
- ¼ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Blend the cottage cheese on its own until it is not curds any more — a full minute, which is longer than it feels like it should take. Stop early and it stays grainy, and nothing added afterwards will hide that.
2. Add the mayo, mustard and salt and blend a few seconds more, just enough to bring it together.
3. Give it an hour in the fridge. It firms up and the cottage cheese taste settles back into the mayo.
4. It is not mayonnaise and it will not pass off a spoon. In tuna, in egg salad, on a sandwich, it does the same job.

61 kcal · 3g protein · 1g carbs · 5g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 356

8 SERVINGS · 12 MINS · EASY 55

Pan Gravy, Brown or Pale

Brown the Flour and Nothing Lumps

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp butter (or the fat from the pan)
- 3 tbsp flour
- 2 cups water (or the juices from the roast)
- ½ cup milk
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp celery salt (optional)

METHOD

1. Melt the butter in a wide pan over medium heat and whisk in the flour. It has to cook either way — raw flour is why packet gravy tastes like paste, and this is the minute that fixes it.
2. For brown gravy for beef, whisk 4 or 5 minutes, until it smells like toast and is the colour of peanut butter. For pale gravy for chicken, stop after a minute, while it is still blond.
3. Take the pan off the heat before any liquid goes near it. Add the water a splash at a time, whisking each one smooth before the next. The first half-cup is what decides whether it is lump-free.
4. Back on medium heat with the milk stirred in. It will look far too thin for a while and then thicken all at once as it comes to the boil. Let it bubble two minutes to lose the floury edge.
5. Now salt it, with the celery salt if you are using it. Taste first — off a roast it may need none. Too thick, add liquid; too thin, simmer it down. Do not add flour to a finished gravy, it will not cook out.

61 kcal · 1g protein · 3g carbs · 5g fat

All pantry staples

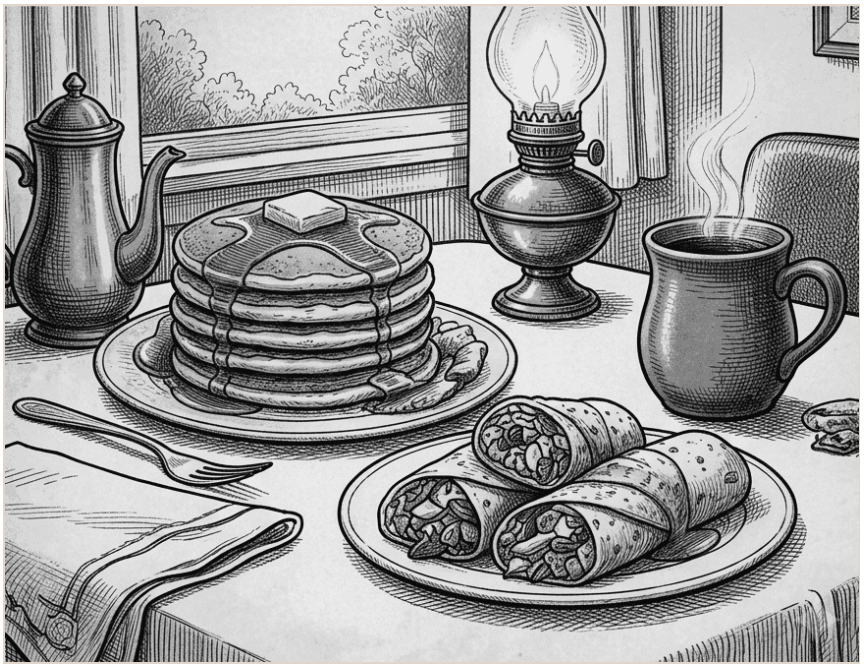
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SECTION 1

Speedy Weekday Breakfasts & Morning Treats

Weekday mornings, on the clock.

30 RECIPES

NO. 355

12 SERVINGS · 30 MINS · EASY 46

Everyday BBQ Sauce

The Onion Does What the Smoke Would

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tbsp butter
- ½ onion (grated)
- 1 cup ketchup
- ⅓ cup brown sugar
- 2 tbsp mustard
- 1 tbsp honey
- ¼ cup water
- ½ tsp salt
- ½ tsp celery salt (optional)

METHOD

1. Grate the onion on the coarse side of a box grater. Chopped is fine, but you will taste the pieces.
2. Cook it in the butter over low heat for 8 minutes, until it is soft, slightly gold, and has stopped smelling sharp. This is where the sauce gets its depth, and there is no shortcut on high heat.
3. Stir in the ketchup, brown sugar, mustard, honey, water, salt and celery salt. There is no vinegar on the storehouse list and none is needed — the ketchup and the mustard between them bring plenty.
4. Bring it to a bare simmer and leave it 15 to 20 minutes, stirring now and then so the sugar does not catch. It is ready when a spoon drawn across the pan leaves a line for a second.
5. Take it off and let it cool. It thickens again cold, so stop while it still looks slightly loose. In a jar in the fridge it keeps two weeks.

61 kcal · 0g protein · 13g carbs · 1g fat

All pantry staples



SECTION 9

Made, Not Bought

The three bottles you would otherwise buy, made from what is already on the shelf.

11 RECIPES

NO. 151

4 SERVINGS · 15 MINS · MEDIUM

46

Golden Cinnamon Waffles with Warm Peach Compote

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups waffle mix [360]
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup milk
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 can (29 oz) peaches, drained
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ¼ cup syrup [363]

METHOD

1. Whisk waffle mix, eggs, milk, and melted butter.
2. Cook in hot waffle iron 4 mins until golden.
3. Simmer the drained, sliced peaches with the syrup and cinnamon in a small pot for 5 mins; spoon on top.

476 kcal · 12g protein · 80g carbs · 12g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 152

6 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · MEDIUM

66

Cinnamon Roll Baked Oatmeal

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups rolled oats
- 2 cups milk
- 2 eggs
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- ½ cup brown sugar
- ¼ cup raisins
- 1 tsp butter

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F and butter an 8-inch square baking dish.
2. Toast the oats in a dry skillet over medium heat for two minutes, until they smell like biscuits. Nutty instead of flat. Tip them into the dish and stir in the milk, eggs, cinnamon, and raisins.
3. Bake at 350°F for 30 to 35 mins, until the center is no longer wet to the touch.
4. Melt the butter with the brown sugar in a small pan over low heat, stirring, until the sugar has dissolved into it — about a minute. That is the glaze. Drizzle it over the top while the bake is still warm so it soaks in.

297 kcal · 9g protein · 45g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 153 · 4 LARGE BURRITOS · 20 MINS · MEDIUM · 51

Loaded Breakfast Burrito Factory

INGREDIENTS

- 6 scrambled eggs
- 4 oz pork sausage
- 1 cup cubed potatoes
- ½ cup cheddar
- 4 tortillas [359]
- salsa

METHOD

1. Fry the cubed potatoes and sausage in a skillet about 10 mins, until the potatoes are tender and no pink is left in the sausage (160°F). Get the pan hot before the pork goes in, and leave it alone until it lets go of the pan on its own — grey meat is meat that was stirred too soon.
2. Scramble eggs 3 mins.
3. Set out warm tortillas, eggs, sausage, potatoes, and cheese for custom burrito rolling. Salsa out beside them.

428 kcal · 21g protein · 32g carbs · 24g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 154 · 4 SERVINGS · 12 MINS · EASY · 34

Fluffy Pancake Stack

INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups pancake mix [360]
- 1.5 cups milk
- 1 egg
- 2 tbsp butter
- syrup [363]

METHOD

1. Whisk pancake mix, milk, egg, and melted butter.
2. Pour batter onto hot skillet, cook 2 mins per side until bubbles burst and pancakes turn golden. Serve with syrup.

485 kcal · 13g protein · 79g carbs · 13g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 354 · 16 BARS · 50 MINS · MEDIUM · 49

Salted Chocolate Chip Cookie Bars

Chewy, Not Cakey

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup butter
- 1 cup brown sugar
- ½ cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 2 cups white flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp salt
- 1.5 cups chocolate chips

METHOD

1. Melt the butter and let it cool for 5 minutes. Melted rather than creamed butter is what makes these chewy instead of cakey.
2. Beat in both sugars, then the eggs and vanilla, and keep beating a minute until the mixture looks glossy.
3. Fold in the flour, baking soda and salt just until combined.
4. Fold through most of the chocolate chips.
5. Press into a 9x13-inch pan lined with parchment hanging over two sides, and press the remaining chips into the top. The overhang is what lifts the slab out whole to be cut.
6. Sprinkle the top with a little coarse salt.
7. Bake at 350°F for 25 to 28 minutes, until the edges are golden and the middle is barely set.
8. Cool completely in the pan before cutting — warm, they fall apart.

306 kcal · 3g protein · 42g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 353 · 8 SERVINGS · 5 HRS 30 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 48

Chocolate Cream Pie

No Skin, No Soggy Bottom

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 cups white flour
- ½ cup cold butter
- 4 tbsp cold water
- 1 tsp salt
- ¾ cup sugar
- ⅓ cup cocoa powder
- ¼ cup cornstarch
- 3 cups milk
- 4 egg yolks
- 2 tbsp butter
- 2 tsp vanilla

METHOD

1. Rub the cold butter into the flour and salt, add the water, and gather into a dough. Rest it 30 minutes in the fridge.
2. Roll it out, line a deep 9-inch pie dish, prick the base all over and line it with paper and baking weights.
3. Bake blind at 400°F for 20 minutes, then remove the weights and bake 8 minutes more until dry and sand-coloured. A raw-bottomed cream pie is a sad thing.
4. Whisk the sugar, cocoa, cornstarch and a pinch of salt in a pan, then whisk in the milk a little at a time so no lumps form.
5. Cook over medium heat, whisking constantly, until it thickens and bubbles. Let it bubble a full minute — that is what cooks out the starch.
6. Beat the egg yolks in a bowl, pour in a ladle of the hot mixture while whisking, then return it all to the pan.
7. Cook 2 minutes more, still whisking, then take off the heat and stir in the butter and vanilla.
8. Pour into the cooled crust and press plastic wrap directly onto the surface so no skin forms.
9. Chill at least 4 hours before cutting.

395 kcal · 9g protein · 47g carbs · 19g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 155 · 4 SERVINGS · 23 MINS · MEDIUM · 65

Crispy Hash Brown & Ham Egg Skillet

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tbsp oil
- 2 cups cubed potatoes
- 4 oz diced ham
- 4 eggs
- ½ cup cheddar cheese

METHOD

1. Heat the oil in a skillet over medium-high and fry the potatoes 12 to 15 mins, turning now and then, until crisp outside and tender when poked with a fork.
2. Add ham and crack eggs on top.
3. Sprinkle cheddar, cover skillet, and cook on low for 5 mins until eggs are set.

255 kcal · 16g protein · 14g carbs · 15g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 156

6 SERVINGS · 55 MINS · MEDIUM

59

French Toast Bake with Strawberry Jam

INGREDIENTS

- 8 bread slices [295]
- 4 eggs
- 1 cup milk
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp vanilla
- ½ cup strawberry jam
- 2 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Butter an 8-inch square baking dish well. A bake this eggy welds itself to a dry one, and that is what the two tablespoons are for.
2. Tear the bread into the dish. Stale bread is better than fresh here — it drinks the custard and keeps its shape.
3. Whisk the eggs, milk, cinnamon and vanilla together until no streaks of white are left.
4. Pour it over the bread and press the pieces down with the back of a spoon until every one of them is wet.
5. Leave it to soak 20 minutes, pressing it down once more halfway. Baked straight away, the custard sets around the bread instead of inside it.
6. Heat the oven to 350°F while it soaks.
7. Spoon the jam over in blobs rather than spreading it. Spread out it bakes into one sweet layer; in blobs you get pockets of it.
8. Bake 25 to 30 minutes, until the edges are set and the middle only just wobbles when you move the dish.
9. Stand it 5 minutes before cutting. It firms as it cools.

273 kcal · 9g protein · 39g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 352

12 SLICES · 1 HR 20 MINS · MEDIUM

53

Chocolate Chip Banana Bread

Chips That Stay Suspended

INGREDIENTS

- 3 ripe bananas
- ½ cup butter
- ¾ cup brown sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1.75 cups white flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 cup chocolate chips

METHOD

1. Mash the bananas well. They should be heavily freckled or nearly black — underripe bananas make bland bread.
2. Melt the butter and beat it with the brown sugar.
3. Beat in the eggs and vanilla, then the mashed banana.
4. Whisk the flour, baking soda and salt together, then fold them in just until combined.
5. Toss the chocolate chips in a spoonful of flour before folding them through — floured chips stay suspended instead of sinking to the bottom.
6. Pour into a parchment-lined 9x5-inch loaf tin and scatter a few more chips on top.
7. Bake at 350°F for 55 to 60 minutes, covering the top with foil if it darkens too fast.
8. Cool in the tin 15 minutes, then turn out. Slicing it hot makes it gummy.

305 kcal · 4g protein · 43g carbs · 13g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 351 · 36 SQUARES · 3 HRS 30 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 46

Old-Fashioned Chocolate Fudge

Rich Enough That Small Is Right

INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups sugar
- 1 cup evaporated milk
- ½ cup butter
- 2 cups chocolate chips
- 1 tsp vanilla
- salt

METHOD

1. Butter an 8-inch square pan and line it with a strip of parchment hanging over two sides.
2. Bring the sugar, evaporated milk and butter to a boil in a heavy pan, stirring constantly.
3. Boil 5 minutes, still stirring, without letting it catch. Scorched fudge cannot be rescued.
4. Take it off the heat and tip in the chocolate chips, vanilla and a pinch of salt.
5. Stir until every chip has melted and the mixture turns thick, glossy and loses its shine at the edges.
6. Pour into the pan at once and spread it level — it begins setting immediately.
7. Leave at room temperature 3 hours to set, then lift out and cut into small squares. It is rich enough that small is the right size.

150 kcal · 1g protein · 23g carbs · 6g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 157 · 6 MUFFIN BISCUIT CUPS · 35 MINS · MEDIUM · 40

Cheesy Sausage & Egg Biscuit Cups

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 4 tbsp butter
- ¾ cup milk
- 3 eggs
- 4 oz sausage
- ¼ cup cheddar
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp butter, for the tin

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F and grease six cups of a muffin tin with the teaspoon of butter.
2. Cook the sausage in a skillet, breaking it up, until no pink is left (160°F). Drain it. Get the pan hot before the sausage goes in, and leave it alone until it lets go of the pan on its own — grey meat is meat that was stirred too soon.
3. Rub the cold butter into the flour, baking powder and the salt with your fingertips until it looks like coarse crumbs. Stir in the milk with a fork until it just comes together — a few dry patches are better than a smooth dough.
4. Divide the dough into 6 equal pieces and press each into a cup and up the sides to make a shell.
5. Divide the sausage between the shells, beat the eggs and pour them over, and top with the cheddar.
6. Bake 20 minutes, until the egg is set and the edges are golden.

355 kcal · 12g protein · 34g carbs · 19g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 158 1 SERVING · 2 MINS · EASY 70

Honey Nut O's & Fresh Banana Crunch Bowls

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 cups Honey Nut O's
- 1 sliced banana
- 1 cup cold milk

METHOD

1. Pour cereal into bowl.
2. Slice fresh banana on top.
3. Pour cold milk and serve.

456 kcal · 13g protein · 83g carbs · 8g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 159 2 PARFAIT JARS · 5 MINS · EASY 64

Vanilla Yogurt & Peach Parfait Jars

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups vanilla yogurt
- 1 can (29 oz) peaches, drained and diced
- ½ cup Honey Nut O's

METHOD

1. In each jar, layer ½ cup yogurt, a quarter of the peaches, and 2 tbsp cereal.
2. Repeat the layers once and serve chilled.

396 kcal · 14g protein · 76g carbs · 4g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 160 2 SERVINGS · 4 MINS · EASY 59

PB&J Breakfast Toast Toppers

INGREDIENTS

- 4 slices bread [295]
- ¼ cup peanut butter
- ¼ cup strawberry jam
- 1 banana

METHOD

1. Toast bread slices golden.
2. Spread peanut butter and strawberry jam generously.
3. Top with banana slices.

518 kcal · 14g protein · 75g carbs · 18g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 350 36 PIECES · 1 HR 45 MINS · MEDIUM 55

Peanut Butter Buckeyes

The Bare Circle on Top

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 cups peanut butter
- ½ cup butter
- 4 cups powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 2 cups chocolate chips

METHOD

1. Beat the peanut butter with the softened butter and vanilla until smooth.
2. Work in the powdered sugar a cup at a time until you have a stiff dough that holds its shape.
3. Roll into balls and set them on a tray. Push a toothpick into each one.
4. Chill 1 hour until firm. Soft balls fall off the stick straight into the chocolate.
5. Melt the chocolate chips gently over barely simmering water, stirring until glossy.
6. Hold each ball by its toothpick and dip it into the chocolate, leaving a circle of peanut butter showing at the top — that bare circle is what makes it a buckeye.
7. Set back on the tray, smooth over the toothpick hole with a fingertip, and chill until firm.

195 kcal · 3g protein · 21g carbs · 11g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 349 24 COOKIES · 40 MINS · EASY 58

No-Bake Chocolate Oat Cookies

Boil One Minute, Exactly

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups sugar
- ½ cup butter
- ½ cup milk
- ¼ cup cocoa powder
- ½ cup peanut butter
- 3 cups rolled oats
- 1 tsp vanilla
- salt

METHOD

1. Put the sugar, butter, milk and cocoa in a pan and bring to a rolling boil, stirring.
2. Boil for exactly 1 minute, timed. Under-boiled and they never set; over-boiled and they turn dry and crumbly. This one minute is the whole recipe.
3. Take it off the heat and stir in the peanut butter and vanilla until smooth.
4. Stir in the oats and a pinch of salt, working quickly before it starts to set.
5. Drop spoonfuls onto waxed paper.
6. Leave them to set at room temperature about 30 minutes. Do not put them in the fridge, which makes them sweat.

175 kcal · 3g protein · 25g carbs · 7g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 161 12 MUFFIN PANCAKES · 20 MINS · EASY 60

Apple Cinnamon Pancake Muffins

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups pancake mix 360
- 1 cup milk
- 1 egg
- 1 diced apple
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp butter

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F.
2. Whisk pancake mix, milk, egg, diced apple, and cinnamon.
3. Butter a 12-cup muffin tin, fill each cup about two-thirds, and bake at 375°F for 15 to 18 mins, until a toothpick comes out clean.

106 kcal · 3g protein · 19g carbs · 2g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 162 4 SMALL TACOS · 8 MINS · EASY 59

Scrambled Egg & Cheese Breakfast Tacos

INGREDIENTS

- 4 eggs
- ½ cup cheddar
- 4 tortillas 359
- ¼ cup salsa
- 1 tsp butter

METHOD

1. Scramble the eggs in a buttered skillet over medium-low heat, about 3 minutes, stopping while they still look slightly wet.
2. Warm tortillas on pan.
3. Fill tortillas with eggs, cheddar, and salsa.

BETTER WITH *Hot sauce, cumin, fresh cilantro, lime* A pinch of cumin into the eggs as they cook, and hot sauce at the table. Chopped cilantro and a squeeze of lime over the top. A breakfast taco without acid tastes flat however good the eggs are.

278 kcal · 13g protein · 25g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 163

6 SERVINGS · 40 MINS · MEDIUM

62

Cheesy Potato & Egg Casserole

INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups grated potatoes
- 6 eggs
- ½ cup milk
- 1 cup cheddar cheese
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp butter

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F and butter a 9x13 dish.
2. Whisk eggs, milk, cheese, and salt.
3. Squeeze the grated potatoes dry in a towel, mix them in, pour into the dish, and bake at 350°F for 35 mins, until the center is set and no longer wet.

BETTER WITH *Parmesan* A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

220 kcal · 13g protein · 15g carbs · 12g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 164

2 SANDWICHES · 8 MINS · EASY

47

Raspberry Jam & Cream Cheese Stuffed Toast

INGREDIENTS

- 4 bread slices [295]
- ¼ cup raspberry jam
- ¼ cup cream cheese, softened
- 1 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Spread cream cheese and raspberry jam between bread slices.
2. Pan-fry in butter over medium heat 3 mins per side until golden.

409 kcal · 7g protein · 57g carbs · 17g fat

Also needs: Cream cheese

NO. 348

16 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · MEDIUM

54

Hot Fudge Sauce

Thick Enough to Coat a Spoon

INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup butter
- ⅔ cup cocoa powder
- 1.5 cups sugar
- 1 cup evaporated milk
- 1 tsp vanilla
- salt

METHOD

1. Melt the butter in a heavy pan over low heat.
2. Whisk in the cocoa and cook it 1 minute — cooking the cocoa in fat is what takes the raw, dusty edge off it.
3. Add the sugar and evaporated milk and stir until the sugar has dissolved completely. Rub a little between your fingers to check for grit.
4. Bring to a gentle simmer and cook 6 to 8 minutes, stirring, until it thickens and coats a spoon heavily.
5. Take it off the heat and stir in the vanilla and a pinch of salt.
6. Serve hot. It thickens to a spoonable fudge in the fridge and keeps two weeks — warm it gently to pour again.

159 kcal · 2g protein · 22g carbs · 7g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 347 20 SERVINGS · 1 HR 45 MINS · IN-DEPTH 43

Chocolate Sheet Cake with Fudge Icing

Hot Icing, Hot Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups white flour
- 2 cups sugar
- 1 cup butter
- ¼ cup cocoa powder
- 1 cup water
- ½ cup sour cream
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ cup butter
- ¼ cup cocoa powder
- 6 tbsp milk
- 4 cups powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla

METHOD

1. Whisk the flour, sugar and salt together in a large bowl.
2. Bring the cup of butter, the quarter cup of cocoa and the water to a boil in a pan, then pour it over the flour mixture and stir smooth.
3. Beat in the sour cream, eggs and baking soda.
4. Pour into a greased 18x13-inch half-sheet pan — the batter will be thin, which is correct.
5. Bake at 350°F for 20 minutes, until a skewer comes out clean.
6. While it bakes, make the icing: boil the half cup of butter, the second quarter cup of cocoa and the milk together.
7. Take it off the heat and beat in the powdered sugar and vanilla until pourable and glossy.
8. Pour the icing over the cake while both are still hot. This is the entire point of the recipe — hot icing on hot cake soaks in and sets to a fudgy shell.
9. Leave to set at least an hour before cutting.

376 kcal · 3g protein · 55g carbs · 16g fat All pantry staples

NO. 165 2 SERVINGS · 7 MINS · EASY 73

Warm Cinnamon Rolled Oats with Raisins & Honey

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 2 cups milk
- ¼ cup raisins
- 1 tbsp honey
- ½ tsp cinnamon

METHOD

1. Toast the oats in the dry pan over medium heat for two minutes, until they smell like biscuits. Nutty instead of flat. Then pour in the milk and simmer about 5 minutes, stirring often so the milk does not catch, until thick enough to hold a spoon-track for a second.
2. Stir in raisins and cinnamon.
3. Drizzle with honey and serve warm.

BETTER WITH *Nutmeg, vanilla, a pinch of salt* A pinch of salt in with the milk. Unsalted porridge tastes of nothing and no amount of honey fixes it. A scrape of nutmeg and a few drops of vanilla with the cinnamon.

376 kcal · 14g protein · 62g carbs · 8g fat All pantry staples

NO. 166 2 LARGE QUESADILLAS · 10 MINS · EASY 45

Sausage & Cheese Breakfast Quesadillas

INGREDIENTS

- 4 oz sausage
- ½ cup cheddar
- 2 tortillas 359

METHOD

1. Cook the sausage in the pan about 5 mins, breaking it up, until no pink is left (160°F), then scoop it out. Get the pan hot before the sausage goes in, and leave it alone until it lets go of the pan on its own — grey meat is meat that was stirred too soon.
2. Place tortillas on pan, fill with sausage and cheese, fold.
3. Griddle medium heat 3 mins per side.

438 kcal · 17g protein · 25g carbs · 30g fat All pantry staples

NO. 167

6 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · EASY

52

Fluffy Sheet-Pan Pancakes

INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups pancake mix [360]
- 1.5 cups milk
- 2 eggs
- 1 apple (sliced)
- 1 tbsp oil

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 400°F.
2. Whisk the pancake mix, milk, and eggs and pour onto a rimmed half-sheet pan (18x13) oiled with the tablespoon of oil.
3. Top with sliced apples.
4. Bake at 400°F for 15 mins.

324 kcal · 10g protein · 53g carbs · 8g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 168

6 SERVINGS · 50 MINS · MEDIUM

73

Banana Bread Oatmeal Bake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups oats
- 2 mashed bananas
- 2 cups milk
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 egg
- 1 tsp butter

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F and butter an 8-inch square baking dish.
2. Beat the egg in the dish, then mix in the oats, bananas, milk, brown sugar, and cinnamon.
3. Bake at 350°F for 40 to 45 mins, until golden on top and the center is no longer wet to the touch.

237 kcal · 8g protein · 40g carbs · 5g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 346

6 CAKES · 55 MINS · IN-DEPTH

54

Molten Chocolate Lava Cakes

A Minute Too Long and It Is Just Cake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup chocolate chips
- ½ cup butter
- 3 eggs
- ½ cup powdered sugar
- ¼ cup white flour
- 1 tsp vanilla
- salt

METHOD

1. Butter six ramekins heavily and dust them with sugar. Anything less and the cakes will not turn out.
2. Melt the chocolate chips and butter together over a pan of barely simmering water, stirring until glossy. Do not let the bowl touch the water or the chocolate will seize.
3. Whisk the eggs with the powdered sugar and a pinch of salt for 2 minutes, until thick and pale.
4. Fold the warm chocolate into the eggs, then fold in the flour and vanilla.
5. Divide between the ramekins and chill 30 minutes. You can hold them here for a day.
6. Bake at 425°F for 11 to 13 minutes. The edges should be set and the centre should still wobble like a jelly.
7. This is a recipe about timing, not doneness. A minute too long and you have a very good small chocolate cake and no lava. The centre stays undercooked on purpose, so use pasteurized eggs when serving young children, anyone pregnant, or anyone elderly.
8. Rest 1 minute, run a knife round the edge, and turn out onto plates. Serve at once.

382 kcal · 5g protein · 32g carbs · 26g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 345 · 12 LARGE COOKIES · 2 HRS 45 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 41

Thick Bakery-Style Chocolate Chip Cookies

Tall, Craggy, Molten Middle

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup butter
- 1 cup brown sugar
- ½ cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 3 cups white flour
- 1 tbsp cornstarch
- 1 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp salt
- 2 cups chocolate chips

METHOD

1. Beat the cold butter with both sugars for a full 3 minutes, until pale and fluffy. Cold butter is what keeps these thick instead of spreading flat.
2. Beat in the eggs one at a time, then the vanilla.
3. Whisk the flour, cornstarch, baking soda and salt together. The cornstarch is the whole trick — it makes the middle soft and slightly underdone-looking.
4. Fold the dry into the wet just until the last streak of flour disappears. Overmixing builds gluten and makes them tough.
5. Fold in the chocolate chips.
6. Divide into 12 large mounds, roughly 4 oz each, and pile them tall rather than flattening them.
7. Chill the mounds at least 2 hours, or overnight. Skipping this is the single most common reason cookies come out flat and greasy.
8. Bake at 400°F for 10 to 12 minutes. Pull them when the edges are set and the middles still look wet and underbaked.
9. Leave them on the hot tray 10 minutes to finish cooking through, then move to a rack.

525 kcal · 6g protein · 69g carbs · 25g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 169 · 2 SERVINGS · 8 MINS · EASY · 62

Egg in a Hole Toast Slices

INGREDIENTS

- 2 bread slices 295
- 2 eggs
- 1 tbsp butter
- salt
- pepper

METHOD

1. Cut 2-inch circle out of center of bread slices.
2. Melt butter in pan, lay bread down, crack egg into center. Salt and pepper the egg as it sets.
3. Fry 3 mins per side. A spoon of salsa on top, or a tablespoon of cheddar in the last minute: acid, salt and a crust, and neither changes the day much.

191 kcal · 9g protein · 14g carbs · 11g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 170 · 24 MINI PANCAKE BITES · 18 MINS · EASY · 57

Chocolate Chip Pancake Bites

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups pancake mix 360
- 1 cup milk
- 1 egg
- ¼ cup chocolate chips
- 1 tsp butter

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F and butter two 12-cup mini muffin tins (or bake in two batches).
2. Whisk the pancake mix with the milk and the egg into a batter a little thicker than you would pour for pancakes, then fold in the chocolate chips. Lumps are fine; beaten smooth makes them tough.
3. Fill each cup about two-thirds and bake 12 minutes, until risen and dry to a fingertip in the middle.

62 kcal · 2g protein · 9g carbs · 2g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 171

4 SERVINGS · 15 MINS · EASY

67

Hash Brown & Sausage Scramble

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups cubed potatoes
- 4 oz sausage
- 4 eggs

METHOD

1. Fry the potatoes and sausage in a skillet about 10 mins, until the potatoes are tender and no pink is left in the sausage (160°F). Get the pan hot before the sausage goes in, and leave it alone until it lets go of the pan on its own — grey meat is meat that was stirred too soon.
2. Pour beaten eggs over top and scramble 3 mins until set.

217 kcal · 11g protein · 14g carbs · 13g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 172

2 BOWLS · 2 HRS 5 MINS · EASY

60

Peach & Vanilla Yogurt Smoothie Bowls

INGREDIENTS

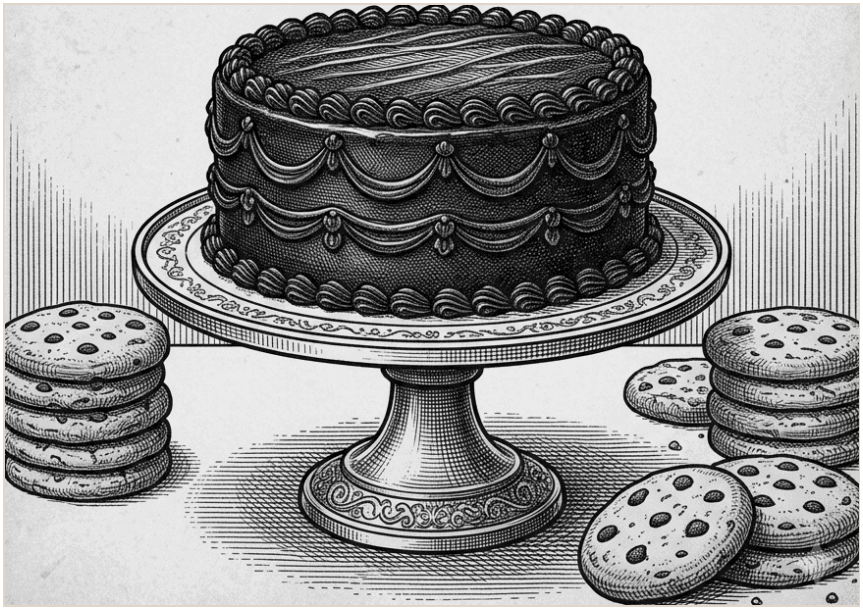
- 2 cups vanilla yogurt
- 1 can (29 oz) peaches, drained
- ¼ cup milk
- 1 tbsp honey

METHOD

1. Spread the drained peaches on a tray and freeze at least 2 hours.
2. Blend the frozen peaches with the yogurt, milk, and honey until thick, adding a spoon more milk only if the blender stalls.
3. Pour into 2 bowls and serve cold.

412 kcal · 15g protein · 79g carbs · 4g fat

All pantry staples



SECTION 8

For the Love of Chocolate

For when only chocolate will do.

10 RECIPES

NO. 344

6 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · EASY

52

Red Enchilada Sauce

From the Spice Shelf, Not a Can

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp vegetable oil
- 2 tbsp flour
- 3 tbsp chili powder
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp garlic powder
- ½ tsp dried oregano
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 2 cups water
- ½ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Warm the oil in a saucepan over medium heat, whisk in the flour and cook it a minute, stirring, until it smells toasty.
2. Add the chili powder, cumin, garlic powder and oregano and stir 30 seconds. Spices burn fast in hot fat, so keep it moving.
3. Whisk in the tomato sauce and the water until smooth.
4. Simmer 10 to 15 minutes, stirring now and then, until it coats the back of a spoon. Salt to taste. It keeps a week in the fridge.

73 kcal · 1g protein · 6g carbs · 5g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 173

2 SERVINGS · 8 MINS · EASY

56

Cinnamon Toast Soldiers with Soft Eggs

INGREDIENTS

- 4 bread slices 295
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 tsp cinnamon sugar
- 2 soft-boiled eggs

METHOD

1. Toast bread, spread cinnamon butter, and slice into long strips.
2. Soft-boil the eggs: lower them into water already at a rolling boil, 6 minutes exactly for a set white and a runny yolk, then run them under cold water for a few seconds so they stop cooking. Serve with the soldiers for dipping.

326 kcal · 11g protein · 30g carbs · 18g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 174

4 SAUSAGE ROLLS · 12 MINS · EASY

42

Sweet Sausage Roll-Ups

INGREDIENTS

- 4 cooked sausage links
- 1 cup pancake mix 360
- ½ cup milk
- 1 tbsp oil
- ¼ cup syrup 363

METHOD

1. Whisk the pancake mix with the milk into a batter thicker than you would pour for pancakes — it has to cling to a sausage rather than run off it. Add the milk a little at a time; you can always loosen it.
2. Heat the oil in a skillet over medium. Dip each sausage in the batter, turning it to coat, and fry 2 minutes a side until golden all round. Spoon the leftover batter into small pancakes in the same pan and serve them alongside.
3. Serve with the syrup.

359 kcal · 9g protein · 38g carbs · 19g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 175

2 FRUIT BOATS · 5 MINS · EASY

66

Fruity Breakfast Parfait Boats

INGREDIENTS

- 2 bananas (halved)
- 1 cup vanilla yogurt
- ½ cup grapes
- 1 tbsp honey

METHOD

1. Slice bananas lengthwise into bowls.
2. Scoop yogurt into center, top with grapes and honey.

286 kcal · 8g protein · 59g carbs · 2g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 343

10 SERVINGS · 10 MINS · EASY

62

Guacamole

Lime First, Mash Second

INGREDIENTS

- 3 avocados
- 1 lime
- ¼ cup diced onion
- 1 jalapeño
- cilantro
- ½ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Halve the avocados, twist out the pits and scoop the flesh into a bowl.
2. Squeeze the lime over straight away; it is what keeps it green. Mash with a fork, leaving some chunks.
3. Stir in the onion, the jalapeño minced fine, a handful of chopped cilantro and the salt.
4. Taste it on a chip. It should be bright and salty enough to stand up on its own; add lime or salt until it does.
5. Press plastic wrap right onto the surface if it has to wait. Air is what turns it brown.

109 kcal · 1g protein · 6g carbs · 9g fat

Also needs: Avocado, Limes, Jalapeños, Cilantro

NO. 342

8 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · EASY

74

Pico de Gallo

Fresh, Sharp, Chopped Small

INGREDIENTS

- 4 tomatoes
- 1 onion
- 1 jalapeño
- cilantro
- 1 lime
- ½ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Dice the tomatoes small. If they are very juicy, scoop out the wet seeds first or the pico ends up swimming.
2. Dice the onion as fine as you can. Mince the jalapeño; leave the seeds out for mild, in for hot.
3. Chop a big handful of cilantro and add it with the juice of the lime and the salt.
4. Stir and let it sit 15 minutes before serving so the salt draws the juices together. Best the day it is made.

20 kcal · 1g protein · 4g carbs · 0g fat

Also needs: Jalapeños, Cilantro, Limes

NO. 176

6 SERVINGS · 35 MINS · MEDIUM

26

Biscuits & Sausage Gravy

Split, and Smothered

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups flour, for the biscuits
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 6 tbsp cold butter
- ¾ cup milk, for the biscuits
- 1 lb pork sausage
- ¼ cup flour, for the gravy
- 3 cups milk, for the gravy
- ½ tsp black pepper

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 425°F.
2. Whisk the 2 cups of flour, the baking powder and salt. Cut in the cold butter with a fork or your fingertips until the biggest pieces are the size of peas. Those pieces are the flakes.
3. Stir in the ¾ cup of milk just until a shaggy dough forms. Pat it ¾ inch thick on a floured counter and cut 6 biscuits, straight down without twisting, or they rise lopsided.
4. Bake on a sheet 12 to 15 minutes, until tall and golden.
5. Meanwhile brown the pork sausage in a large skillet over medium, breaking it up, 8 to 10 minutes, until no pink remains and it reads 160°F. Leave the fat in the pan.
6. Sprinkle the ¼ cup of flour over the sausage and stir 1 minute.
7. Pour in the 3 cups of milk a little at a time, stirring, and simmer 5 to 8 minutes until thick. Season with the pepper; the sausage has brought the salt.
8. Split the biscuits and ladle the gravy over.

594 kcal · 19g protein · 44g carbs · 38g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 177

6 SERVINGS · 30 MINS · EASY

58

German Pancakes

It Climbs, Then It Falls

INGREDIENTS

- 6 eggs
- 1 cup milk
- 1 cup white flour
- ½ tsp salt
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 4 tbsp butter
- 2 tbsp powdered sugar

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 425°F with a 9x13 dish inside it and the butter in the dish. The dish has to be hot and the butter sizzling before any batter goes near it.
2. Beat the eggs hard for a full minute, until they are pale and frothy. This is where the rise comes from, and it is more beating than seems necessary.
3. Whisk in the milk, flour, salt and vanilla until the batter is completely smooth. Lumps of flour will not cook out.
4. Pour the batter into the hot buttered dish all at once and put it straight back in the oven.
5. Bake 20 minutes and do not open the door. It climbs the sides of the dish and goes deep gold; opened early, it drops and will not come back up.
6. It sinks as it comes out, which is what it is supposed to do. Dust it with the powdered sugar and cut it in the dish.
7. Jam or Recipe 363 over the top, and it wants eating straight away.

241 kcal · 10g protein · 21g carbs · 13g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 341

4 BOWLS · 15 MINS · EASY

34

Sweet Pork Rice Bowl, Cafe Rio Style

Rice, Beans, Pork, Green Dressing

INGREDIENTS

- 4 cups cilantro lime rice 308
- 1 can (15 oz) black beans
- 3 cups sweet pork 307
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- 2 cups shredded lettuce
- 1 cup pico de gallo 342
- ½ cup tomatillo ranch 312

METHOD

1. Warm the rice, the beans with a spoon of their liquid, and the sweet pork, each in its own pan or bowl.
2. Build each bowl in layers: a cup of rice, a quarter of the beans, then the pork on top.
3. Scatter the cheese over the hot pork so it melts, then the lettuce and the pico.
4. Finish with two tablespoons of tomatillo ranch drizzled across the top.

VARIATIONS Carne asada: 1½ lbs, chopped, in place of the pork. Less sweet, more protein. The Cafe Rio way: a warm flour tortilla laid in the bowl first, with everything built on top of it. A scoop of guacamole on top.

853 kcal · 35g protein · 86g carbs · 41g fat

Also needs: Cilantro lime rice, Sweet pork, Pico de gallo, Tomatillo ranch

NO. 340

6 SERVINGS · 35 MINS · EASY

36

Sweet Pork Enchiladas

The Pork in Red Sauce

INGREDIENTS

- 12 flour tortillas 359
- 3 cups sweet pork 307
- 3 cups red enchilada sauce 344
- 1½ cups shredded cheddar

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F. Warm the sweet pork so it rolls easily.
2. Spread a cup of the sauce over the bottom of a 9x13 dish.
3. Warm the tortillas until soft. Spoon a quarter cup of pork down each, roll it up and lay it seam down in the dish, snug against the last.
4. Pour the rest of the sauce over the top, all the way to the ends. Any tortilla left dry turns hard in the oven. Scatter the cheese over.
5. Bake 20 minutes until the sauce bubbles at the edges. A minute or two under the broiler browns the cheese in spots. Let it sit 5 minutes before serving.

VARIATION The Cafe Rio plate: cilantro lime rice and black beans on the side, and tomatillo ranch drizzled over the top.

698 kcal · 28g protein · 70g carbs · 34g fat

Also needs: Sweet pork, Red enchilada sauce

NO. 178

4 WAFFLES · 30 MINS · MEDIUM

45

Sunday Waffles

Whites Folded In Last

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 cups pancake mix 360
- 2 eggs
- ¾ cup milk
- ½ cup sour cream
- 3 tbsp butter
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 tbsp sugar

METHOD

1. Brown the butter first: melt it in a small pan over medium heat and swirl it until the foam goes quiet and the specks at the bottom turn the colour of toast, 3 to 4 minutes. Pour it into a bowl at once, specks and all, or it goes on cooking.
2. Separate the eggs, whites into a clean bowl. Whisk the yolks with the milk, sour cream, vanilla and the browned butter.
3. Stir the mix (Recipe 360) into the wet side until the dry patches are gone, and no further. Let it stand 10 minutes while the iron heats — the flour drinks, and the batter thickens on its own.
4. Beat the whites with the sugar to soft peaks — the tips fold over when the beater lifts — and fold them into the batter in three or four strokes. Streaks of white are fine; a batter stirred smooth has lost what the whites brought.
5. A scant cup of batter on a hot iron, and leave the lid shut until the steam slows to a thread. Crisp at the edges, soft in the middle. Keep the first ones on a rack in a warm oven, not stacked, or the steam softens what the iron just crisped.
6. Butter and Recipe 363 syrup, or canned peaches warmed through with a shake of cinnamon.

BETTER WITH *Malted milk powder* A tablespoon of malted milk powder in with the mix is the flavour of a diner waffle — sweet, toasty, faintly of the malt shop.

384 kcal · 10g protein · 41g carbs · 20g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 179

4 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · EASY

52

Buttermilk Pancakes

Sour Wakes the Soda

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup pancake mix [360]
- ¾ cup milk
- ¼ cup sour cream
- 1 egg
- 2 tbsp butter
- ½ tsp vanilla

METHOD

1. Stir the sour cream into the milk until it is smooth — that is the buttermilk, near enough, and the sour in it is what wakes the soda in the mix (Recipe 360).
2. Melt the butter. Whisk the egg and the vanilla into the soured milk, then the butter.
3. Stir the mix in until the dry patches are gone and then stop. Lumps are correct; a batter beaten smooth makes tough pancakes. Let it stand five minutes — it thickens on its own.
4. A heavy pan on medium, a film of butter, a scant quarter cup of batter to a pancake. Turn each one when the bubbles on top stop closing over, and once only. The second side takes half the time of the first.
5. Butter and Recipe 363 syrup, hot. Keep the early ones on a rack in a warm oven, not stacked.

BETTER WITH *Buttermilk, or a splash of vinegar* A cup of real buttermilk in place of the milk and sour cream: tangier, and the pancakes rise a shade higher. No buttermilk? A tablespoon of vinegar stirred into a cup of milk and left five minutes does the same job. It looks curdled; that is the point.

236 kcal · 6g protein · 26g carbs · 12g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 339

6 SERVINGS · 3 HRS 30 MINS · MEDIUM

42

Rolled Tacos, Beto's Style

Crisp Shells, Guac on Top

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs beef roast
- 1 cup water
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp chili powder
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1½ tsp salt
- 24 corn tortillas
- 2 cups vegetable oil (for frying)
- 1 cup guacamole [343]
- 1 cup shredded cheddar

METHOD

1. Cut the roast into big chunks and put it in a pot with the water, cumin, chili powder, garlic powder and salt. Cover and simmer low for 2½ to 3 hours, until it falls apart when pressed with a fork. A slow cooker on low does it in 8.
2. Shred the beef fine with two forks and stir in enough of the pot juices to make it moist but not wet. Wet filling makes soggy tacos.
3. Wrap the tortillas in a damp towel and microwave them 45 seconds so they bend without cracking. Lay a thin line of beef along one edge of each and roll it up tight, seam down.
4. Heat half an inch of oil in a heavy skillet to 350°F. Fry them seam side down first, a few at a time, turning, 2 to 3 minutes until deep golden and crisp all over. Drain on a rack.
5. Serve them the Beto's way: guacamole spooned over the top and a handful of shredded cheese.

825 kcal · 37g protein · 50g carbs · 53g fat

Also needs: Corn tortillas, Guacamole

NO. 338 · 4 BURRITOS · 15 MINS · EASY · 52

Carne Asada Burrito, Beto's Style

Meat, Guac, Pico, Nothing Else

INGREDIENTS

- 4 large flour tortillas 359
- 1½ lbs carne asada 337
- 1 cup guacamole 343
- 1 cup pico de gallo 342

METHOD

1. Warm each tortilla in a dry skillet over medium heat, about 20 seconds a side, until it is soft and floppy. A cold tortilla splits when you roll it.
2. Chop the carne asada into small pieces and heat it through in the same skillet with a splash of water, a couple of minutes.
3. Pile a quarter of the meat down the middle of a tortilla, then a quarter of the guacamole and a quarter of the pico. No rice and no beans: the meat is the burrito.
4. Fold the bottom up over the filling, fold both sides in, and roll it away from you tight.
5. Wrap each one in foil for 2 minutes. The steam seals the seam and softens the tortilla the rest of the way, which is what makes it hold together to the last bite.

VARIATIONS Chicken: the same huge burrito with 2 lbs chicken breast in the Carne Asada marinade for 2 to 6 hours, grilled hot and chopped small. California: a handful of crisp french fries rolled in with the meat, and a handful of shredded cheese. Add sour cream or shredded cheese, if you like it richer.

693 kcal · 57g protein · 42g carbs · 33g fat

Also needs: Carne asada, Guacamole, Pico de gallo

NO. 180 · 4 BURRITOS · 30 MINS · EASY · 30

Breakfast Burrito, Beto's Style

Eggs, Potatoes, Cheese, Your Meat

INGREDIENTS

- 4 large flour tortillas 359
- 1 lb pork sausage
- 8 eggs
- 2 potatoes
- 2 tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 cup shredded cheddar
- ½ cup salsa
- ½ tsp salt

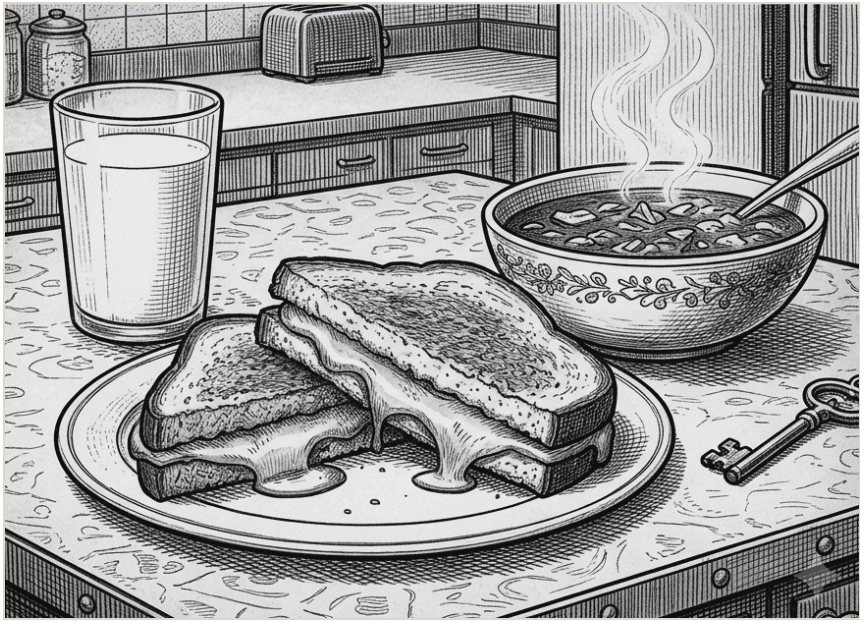
METHOD

1. Dice the potatoes small, about half an inch. Fry them in the oil in a wide skillet over medium-high, turning now and then, 12 to 15 minutes until they are crisp and brown on several sides. Salt them and keep them warm.
2. In a second pan, brown the sausage, breaking it into small crumbles. Tip off most of the fat.
3. Beat the eggs and scramble them in the sausage pan over medium-low, just until they are set with no liquid egg left, and take them straight off the heat so they stay soft.
4. Warm the tortillas in a dry skillet until soft. Down the middle of each: eggs, potatoes, sausage, a quarter of the cheese and a spoon of salsa.
5. Fold the bottom up, the sides in, and roll tight. Wrap in foil for 2 minutes so the cheese melts and the seam holds.

VARIATIONS Bacon: 8 slices, cooked crisp and crumbled, in place of the sausage or alongside it. Ham: 1½ cups diced, browned in the pan before the eggs. Chorizo: 1 lb, browned and drained like the sausage. It carries its own spice, so go light on the salsa. Add-ins for any of them: onions and peppers softened in the potato pan, a spoon of guacamole, or pico in place of the salsa.

961 kcal · 40g protein · 54g carbs · 65g fat

All pantry staples



SECTION 2

Easy Lunches, Wraps & After-School Favorites

Lunches, wraps, and the after-school hour.

25 RECIPES

NO. 337

8 SERVINGS · 2 HRS 30 MINS · MEDIUM

79

Carne Asada

Hot Fire, Thin Slices

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs flank steak
- 2 limes, for the marinade
- 1 orange, for the marinade
- ¼ cup soy sauce, for the marinade
- 3 cloves garlic, for the marinade
- 1 jalapeño, for the marinade
- cilantro
- 1 tsp ground cumin, for the marinade
- 1 tsp chili powder, for the marinade
- 1 tsp salt, for the marinade
- ½ tsp black pepper, for the marinade
- 2 tbsp vegetable oil, for the marinade

METHOD

1. Squeeze the limes and the orange into a bowl or a zip bag. Add the soy sauce, the garlic crushed, the jalapeño sliced thin, a big handful of chopped cilantro, the cumin, chili powder, salt, pepper and oil.
2. Put the steak in and turn it until it is coated all over. Refrigerate 2 to 8 hours. Past about 12 the lime starts to turn the outside mealy.
3. Get a grill or a cast iron pan as hot as it will go. Lift the steak out, let the marinade drip off and pat it dry: a wet steak steams instead of charring.
4. Cook 4 to 5 minutes a side for medium, a little less on the thin end. You want dark char at the edges; that is most of the flavour.
5. Rest it 10 minutes on the board, then slice it thin across the grain. Look for the lines running along the meat and cut across them, or it chews like rope. For burritos, chop the slices small.

VARIATION Skirt steak is the traditional cut and cooks a minute faster a side. Sirloin works too, sliced just as thin.

186 kcal · 24g protein · 0g carbs · 10g fat

Also needs: Flank steak, Limes, Oranges, Jalapeños, Cilantro

NO. 336

8 SERVINGS · 50 MINS · MEDIUM 42

Zuppa Toscana

A Bare Simmer, Never a Boil

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb pork sausage
- 4 oz ham
- 2 lbs potatoes
- 1 onion
- 4 cups water
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of chicken [361]
- 1 can (12 oz) evaporated milk
- ½ lb broccoli
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp black pepper

METHOD

1. Brown the sausage in a large pot, breaking it up small, until no pink is left. Pour off all but a spoonful of the fat.
2. Add the ham and the onion, both diced, and cook 6 minutes, until the onion has gone soft.
3. Add the potatoes cut into half-inch slices and the water. Simmer 15 minutes, until a knife goes into a potato without resistance.
4. Stir in the soup and the evaporated milk and bring it back to a bare simmer. Boiled hard from here it will split.
5. Add the broccoli cut small and give it 5 minutes more, until it is bright and still has some bite.
6. Salt and pepper it, then taste it again. A potato soup takes more salt than seems right.
7. It thickens overnight and is better the next day. Loosen it with a splash of milk as it warms.

404 kcal · 16g protein · 31g carbs · 24g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 181

4 SERVINGS · 12 MINS · EASY 40

Pressed Ham & Cheddar Melts with Tomato Soup

INGREDIENTS

- 8 slices bread [295]
- 8 oz sliced ham
- 4 oz cheddar cheese
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato soup

METHOD

1. Heat tomato soup in pot with 1 can milk/water.
2. Butter bread outsides, fill with ham and cheddar.
3. Pan-fry sandwiches on skillet over medium heat 4 mins per side until golden/melty.

BETTER WITH *Fresh garlic, mustard, black pepper* Mash a crushed clove of garlic into the butter you spread on the outside. Garlic butter is the difference between a toasted sandwich and a good one. A thin scrape of mustard inside, and black pepper on the tomato.

471 kcal · 23g protein · 43g carbs · 23g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 182

4 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · MEDIUM 54

Loaded Baked Potato Bar

INGREDIENTS

- 4 Russet potatoes
- 4 tbsp butter
- ½ cup sour cream
- 1 cup cheddar
- 4 oz diced ham
- 1 cup cooked broccoli

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 400°F. Bake potatoes 45 mins until tender.
2. Slice open and set out bowls of butter, sour cream, cheddar, ham, and cooked broccoli for custom loading.

BETTER WITH *Chives, garlic powder, hot sauce, bacon bits* Garlic powder into the butter, chives over the top. Hot sauce and bacon bits on the bar. A potato bar is a topping problem, so the answer is more toppings.

461 kcal · 16g protein · 34g carbs · 29g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 183

4 QUESADILLAS · 10 MINS · EASY

59

Cheesy Chicken Quesadillas with Salsa

INGREDIENTS

- 1 can (12.5 oz) chicken breast
- 1 cup cheddar cheese
- 4 tortillas 359
- salsa
- sour cream

METHOD

1. Drain chicken and chop.
2. Place tortillas on skillet, fill half with chicken and cheddar, fold over.
3. Cook medium heat 3 mins per side until crispy. Serve with salsa. Sour cream too.

BETTER WITH *Cumin and paprika* A teaspoon of cumin and one of paprika in with the meat as it cooks. Or the taco seasoning: Recipe 310.

352 kcal · 27g protein · 25g carbs · 16g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 184

4 SERVINGS · 8 MINS · EASY

30

Classic Beef Franks on Buns with Cucumber Sticks

INGREDIENTS

- 8 beef franks
- 8 hot dog buns
- ketchup
- mustard
- fresh cucumber slices

METHOD

1. Franks are already cooked, so this is only heating them through: simmer 6 minutes, or grill them turning often until the skins blister and split.
2. Place in buns with ketchup and mustard.
3. Serve alongside fresh cucumber sticks.

564 kcal · 20g protein · 58g carbs · 28g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 335

8 SERVINGS · 8 HRS 10 MINS · EASY

55

Mississippi Pot Roast

No Water, Eight Hours

INGREDIENTS

- 3 lbs beef roast
- ½ cup ranch dressing
- ¼ cup butter
- 6 pepperoncini
- 1 tsp black pepper

METHOD

1. Put the roast in the slow cooker. Add no water — the roast gives up more liquid than you expect, and water on top of that makes soup of it.
2. Spoon the ranch over the top and lay the butter over that in slices.
3. Scatter the pepperoncini over, and a tablespoon of the brine from the jar with them. The brine is the tang this is known for; the peppers themselves are mild.
4. Cover and cook on LOW for 8 hours, until it pulls apart under a fork. Every time the lid comes off it costs about twenty minutes.
5. Shred the beef in the pot and stir it back through the liquid.
6. Serve it over Recipe 362 or rice. The liquid in the pot is the sauce; Recipe 356 made with it instead of water turns it into gravy.

BETTER WITH *Soy sauce* A tablespoon of soy sauce in with the liquid. Nobody tastes soy; they taste more beef.

538 kcal · 30g protein · 1g carbs · 46g fat

Also needs: Pepperoncini

NO. 334 · 12 SERVINGS · 40 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 49

Churros, Piped and Fried

A Rolling Boil, Then Flour

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup water
- 1 tsp vanilla
- ¼ tsp salt
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 cup white flour
- 1 egg
- 3 cups vegetable oil (for frying)
- ½ cup cinnamon sugar

METHOD

1. Bring the water, vanilla, salt and butter to a rolling boil in a saucepan.
2. Tip the flour in all at once and beat it hard with a wooden spoon until it comes together into a smooth ball that leaves the sides of the pan.
3. A rolling boil is the part that matters. Started in water that is merely hot, churros come out soft instead of crisp.
4. Take it off the heat, let it stand a minute, then beat the egg in until the dough is glossy and smooth again.
5. Heat the oil to 375°F in a deep pan.
6. Pipe lengths of dough about 5 inches long straight into the oil, cutting each one off with a knife.
7. Fry 2 minutes a side, until deep gold and crisp all over.
8. Drain them briefly and roll them in cinnamon sugar while they are still hot.

153 kcal · 2g protein · 16g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 185 · 4 WRAP ROLLS · 8 MINS · EASY · 66

Creamy Tuna Salad Wraps

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cans (5 oz) tuna
- ¼ cup mayo
- ½ cup diced cucumbers
- shredded lettuce
- 4 tortillas [359]

METHOD

1. Mix drained tuna, mayo, and diced cucumber in bowl.
2. Spread onto 4 tortillas over lettuce, roll tightly, and cut into pinwheels.

BETTER WITH *Onion, lemon, dill, black pepper* A tablespoon of finely diced onion and a squeeze of lemon into the tuna. Dill and black pepper. Every good tuna salad is tuna, something sharp, and something crunchy.

302 kcal · 20g protein · 24g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 186

6 SERVINGS · 15 MINS · EASY

39

Stovetop Mac & Cheese with Hot Dog Coins

INGREDIENTS

- 1 pkg (16 oz) macaroni
- 2.5 cups cheddar
- 1 cup milk
- 4 tbsp butter
- 4 sliced beef franks

METHOD

1. Boil macaroni 8 mins; drain.
2. Fry sliced beef frank coins in pan 4 mins.
3. Melt the butter into the drained pasta, then add the milk and the cheddar a handful at a time over low heat, stirring until each lot has gone before the next. Off a hard boil — cheese boiled into milk goes grainy. Stir the frank coins through at the end.

BETTER WITH *Mustard powder, garlic powder, black pepper* Half a teaspoon of mustard powder and a pinch of garlic powder into the milk before the cheese goes in. Black pepper at the end. Stovetop mac is mild by design and takes seasoning better than people expect.

641 kcal · 25g protein · 61g carbs · 33g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 333

8 SERVINGS · 2 HRS · IN-DEPTH

49

Cheddar Bagels

Boiled, Then Baked

INGREDIENTS

- 4.5 cups white flour
- 1.5 tbsp yeast
- 1½ cups warm water
- 1 tbsp brown sugar
- 2 tsp salt
- 2 cups cheddar
- 8 cups water

METHOD

1. Stir the yeast and brown sugar into the warm water and leave it 5 minutes, until it foams.
2. Mix the flour, salt and half the cheddar in a large bowl, pour the yeast water in, and knead 10 minutes to a firm, smooth dough. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it will not come together; bagel dough should be stiff.
3. Rest the dough 5 minutes, then cut it into eight and roll each piece into a tight ball.
4. Push your thumb through the middle of each ball and turn it around your thumb until the hole is about two inches across.
5. Set them on a parchment-lined tray, cover them, and rise 30 minutes.
6. Heat the oven to 425°F and bring the 8 cups of water to a rolling boil.
7. Boil the bagels a minute a side, a few at a time, then lift them back onto the tray.
8. Scatter the rest of the cheddar over and bake 15 to 17 minutes, until golden.
9. Cool them 10 minutes before cutting. Cut hot, the crumb drags on the knife.

374 kcal · 14g protein · 57g carbs · 10g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 332

6 SERVINGS · 40 MINS · MEDIUM

Chicken Taquitos

Seam Side Down First

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breast
- 1 cup sour cream
- 1 cup cheddar
- ½ cup salsa
- 1 tsp salt
- 12 small tortillas 359
- 2 cups vegetable oil (for frying)

METHOD

1. Pound the thick end of the chicken level, then cook it through — 165°F, no pink at the centre — and shred it with two forks. Even thickness is what stops the thin end drying out while the thick end catches up.
2. Stir the sour cream, salsa and salt together, pour it over the chicken, and mix until every strand is coated.
3. Stir the cheddar through.
4. Warm the tortillas three at a time between two damp paper towels in the microwave, about 15 seconds, until they bend without cracking. Cold ones split as you roll them.
5. Spoon filling down the middle of each and roll it up tight.
6. Heat half an inch of oil in a wide pan to 350°F.
7. Fry them seam side down first, turning until gold all round, about 3 minutes. Seam down first is what stops them unrolling.
8. Drain them on a rack rather than on paper, so the undersides stay crisp.

550 kcal · 36g protein · 34g carbs · 30g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 187

4 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · MEDIUM

Mini Cheeseburger Sliders with Potato Wedges

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef
- 4 cheddar slices
- 8 slider buns
- 2 lbs potatoes (wedged)
- 2 tbsp oil
- 1 tsp salt

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 425°F. Toss the potato wedges with the oil and salt, spread in one layer on a baking sheet, and roast 35 to 40 mins, flipping after 20, until browned and tender.
2. Form beef into 8 small patties, cook on skillet 3 mins per side, top each with half a cheddar slice. Ground beef wants 160°F all the way through, not the pink middle a steak can have — grinding puts the outside of the meat on the inside.
3. Serve on slider buns.

BETTER WITH *Onion powder, garlic powder, Worcestershire, pickles* Work a teaspoon each of onion and garlic powder and a splash of Worcestershire into the beef before forming the patties. Pickle slices in the sliders. A cheeseburger without something sharp is just meat and bread.

710 kcal · 39g protein · 71g carbs · 30g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 188

4 SERVINGS · 8 MINS · EASY

52

Chicken Rotini Soup & Buttered Toast Soldiers

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cans (14.4 oz) chicken rotini soup
- 4 bread slices [295]
- 2 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Heat the soup in a pot over medium, stirring, about 6 mins until steaming.
2. Toast bread, butter liberally, slice into strips. Serve together.

BETTER WITH *Black pepper, hot sauce, parsley, A head of garlic, A bottle of vinegar* Canned soup is under-seasoned in one direction only: black pepper, and a few dashes of hot sauce. Chopped parsley over the top if you have it. Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last thirty seconds before the liquid goes in — any longer and it burns bitter. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself.

217 kcal · 8g protein · 26g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 189

4 BENTO MEALS · 10 MINS · EASY

62

PB&J Bento Box Platters

INGREDIENTS

- 8 bread slices [295]
- ½ cup peanut butter
- ½ cup jam
- 2 oranges
- 2 carrots

METHOD

1. Spread the peanut butter on four slices and the jam on the other four, sandwich them, and cut each into quarters.
2. Slice oranges and carrots into sticks; divide into 4 boxes.

510 kcal · 14g protein · 73g carbs · 18g fat

Also needs: Oranges

NO. 331

16 SERVINGS · 1 HR 40 MINS · MEDIUM

37

Pink Sugar Cookies, Served Cold

Pressed With a Glass

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 cups butter
- 1 cup sugar
- 2 eggs
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 4 cups white flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ cup butter
- 3 cups powdered sugar
- 3 tbsp milk
- 1 drop red food colouring

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F.
2. Cream the 1.5 cups of butter with the sugar until light. Beat in the eggs and a teaspoon of the vanilla.
3. Mix in the flour, baking powder and salt, only until it comes together.
4. Scoop the dough into sixteen balls and set them well apart on trays. They spread.
5. Dip the bottom of a drinking glass in sugar and press each ball flat, to about half an inch.
6. Bake 9 to 11 minutes, until the tops are no longer glossy. Do not wait for colour at the edges — browned, they are overbaked.
7. Let them cool on the tray.
8. Beat the remaining ½ cup of butter with the powdered sugar, the last teaspoon of vanilla, the milk and the drop of red food colouring, until smooth, light and pale pink.
9. Spread the frosting on while the cookies are barely warm, so it settles flat, then chill them 1 hour, until cold through. These are served cold.

VARIATION Half a cup of sour cream beaten in with the eggs, with a quarter cup more flour, makes a softer, cake-like cookie.

468 kcal · 4g protein · 59g carbs · 24g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 330 20 SERVINGS · 3 HRS · IN-DEPTH 49

Glazed Doughnuts

Dipped Warm

INGREDIENTS

- 5 cups white flour
- 2 packets (¼ oz) yeast
- ⅓ cup warm water
- 1.5 cups milk
- ½ cup sugar
- 1 tsp salt
- 2 eggs
- ⅓ cup butter
- 4 cups vegetable oil (for frying)
- ½ cup butter
- 2 cups powdered sugar
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 6 tbsp evaporated milk

METHOD

1. Stir the yeast into the warm water and leave it 5 minutes, until it foams.
2. Warm the milk and let it cool to blood heat, then add it to the yeast with the sugar, salt, eggs, the softened ⅓ cup of butter and 2 cups of the flour. Beat 2 minutes.
3. Work in the remaining 3 cups of flour to a soft dough, then knead it on a floured counter 5 minutes, until it is smooth and springs back when pressed. Cover and rise 1 to 2 hours, until doubled.
4. Roll the dough out half an inch thick and cut rings. Cover them loosely and leave them to rise 30 to 45 minutes, until doubled.
5. Heat at least three inches of oil to 350°F in a deep pan.
6. Fry a few at a time, about a minute a side, until golden. They cook fast, and a crowded pan drops the oil temperature.
7. Drain them on a rack.
8. Melt the ½ cup of butter and whisk it with the powdered sugar, vanilla and enough evaporated milk to make a glaze that pours off the spoon in a ribbon.
9. Dip each doughnut while it is still warm and set it back on the rack to drip. Dipped cold, the glaze sits in a lump instead of a sheet.

318 kcal · 5g protein · 43g carbs · 14g fat All pantry staples

NO. 190 4 BURRITOS · 8 MINS · EASY 60

Refried Bean & Cheese Burritos

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup refried beans
- 1 cup cheddar cheese
- 4 tortillas 359
- salsa

METHOD

1. Warm refried beans in pan 3 mins.
2. Spread onto tortillas, top with cheddar, roll into burritos, and pan-warm 2 mins. Salsa on the side, or spooned in before they are rolled.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, Cumin and paprika* Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last minute of cooking — any longer and it burns bitter. A teaspoon of cumin and one of paprika in with the meat as it cooks. Or the taco seasoning: Recipe 310.

309 kcal · 14g protein · 34g carbs · 13g fat All pantry staples

NO. 191 4 WRAP ROLLS · 6 MINS · EASY 58

Warm Chicken & Ranch Wrap Rolls

INGREDIENTS

- 1 can (12.5 oz) chicken
- ¼ cup ranch dressing
- ½ cup cheddar
- lettuce
- 4 tortillas 359

METHOD

1. Mix chicken, ranch, and cheddar.
2. Roll inside tortillas with lettuce, cut in half, and serve.

BETTER WITH *Garlic powder, hot sauce, spring onion* Garlic powder and a few dashes of hot sauce into the ranch. Sliced spring onion in the wrap.

349 kcal · 24g protein · 25g carbs · 17g fat All pantry staples

NO. 192

4 SERVINGS · 15 MINS · EASY

59

Sloppy Joes on Hamburger Buns

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef
- ½ cup ketchup
- 1 tbsp mustard
- 1 tbsp brown sugar
- 4 buns

METHOD

1. Brown beef in skillet 8 mins, drain fat.
2. Stir in ketchup, mustard, and brown sugar; simmer 5 mins. Spoon onto buns.

386 kcal · 28g protein · 37g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 193

4 SANDWICHES · 10 MINS · EASY

55

Pizza Grilled Cheese Melts

INGREDIENTS

- 8 bread slices [295]
- ½ cup spaghetti sauce
- 1 cup cheddar cheese
- 2 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Spread spaghetti sauce and cheddar inside bread slices.
2. Butter outsides and griddle 4 mins per side until melted.

BETTER WITH *Garlic, oregano, chili flakes, parmesan* Garlic butter on the outside, oregano stirred into the spaghetti sauce. Parmesan with the cheddar, chili flakes if you like it hot.

325 kcal · 12g protein · 31g carbs · 17g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 329

4 SERVINGS · 10 MINS · EASY

73

Orange Julius

Frothy and Pale

INGREDIENTS

- 3 oranges
- 1 cup milk
- ¼ cup non-fat dry milk
- 2 tbsp sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 2 cups ice

METHOD

1. Squeeze the oranges. You want about a cup of juice.
2. Blend the juice with the milk, dry milk, sugar and vanilla until smooth.
3. Add the ice and blend on high until it is frothy and pale.
4. Drink it inside ten minutes; it separates as it stands.

121 kcal · 4g protein · 24g carbs · 1g fat

Also needs: Oranges

NO. 327

8 SERVINGS · 15 MINS · EASY 58

Restaurant Queso

Evaporated Milk Keeps It Smooth

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp butter
- 2 tbsp white flour
- 1 can (12 oz) evaporated milk
- 2 cups cheddar
- ½ cup salsa
- ½ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Melt the butter in a small pan and whisk in the flour. Cook it a full minute.
2. Add the evaporated milk a splash at a time, whisking smooth after each, until it thickens.
3. Take it off the heat and stir in the cheddar a handful at a time, letting each one melt before the next goes in.
4. Stir in the salsa and the salt.
5. Serve it warm. It thickens as it stands, and a splash of milk over low heat brings it back.

216 kcal · 10g protein · 8g carbs · 16g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 328

4 SERVINGS · 10 MINS · EASY 57

Chocolate Frosty

Thick Enough for a Spoon

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups milk
- ½ cup non-fat dry milk
- 2 packets (1 oz) hot cocoa mix
- 2 tbsp sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 3 cups ice

METHOD

1. Blend the milk, dry milk, cocoa mix, sugar and vanilla until completely smooth.
2. Add the ice and blend again on high, until it is thick enough to hold a spoon upright.
3. Serve it at once. The dry milk is what makes it thick rather than thin and sweet.

176 kcal · 8g protein · 27g carbs · 4g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 194

4 SANDWICHES · 10 MINS · EASY 53

Crunchy Tuna Melt Paninis

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cans (5 oz) tuna
- ¼ cup mayo
- 4 cheddar slices
- 8 bread slices 295
- butter

METHOD

1. Mix drained tuna and mayo.
2. Place on bread with cheddar, butter outsides, and press on hot skillet 4 mins per side.

BETTER WITH *Onion, celery, lemon, dill, black pepper* Finely diced raw onion and celery into the tuna mix. Tuna salad is a texture problem before it is a flavour one. Lemon, dill and black pepper — the lemon especially, which is what stops mayo tasting heavy.

445 kcal · 27g protein · 28g carbs · 25g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 195

8 TAQUITOS · 18 MINS · EASY 69

Chicken & Cheese Taquito Roll-Ups

INGREDIENTS

- 1 can (12.5 oz) chicken
- ½ cup cheddar
- 8 small tortillas 359
- 1 tbsp oil

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 400°F.
2. Roll chicken and cheddar tightly inside tortillas.
3. Brush with oil and bake at 400°F for 12 mins until crispy.

BETTER WITH *Cumin, chili powder, garlic, lime* Cumin and chili powder into the chicken before it is rolled. Lime over the taquitos as they come out of the pan.

175 kcal · 12g protein · 16g carbs · 7g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 196

6 BOWLS · 12 MINS · EASY

50

Creamy Tomato Pasta Bowls

INGREDIENTS

- 16 oz macaroni
- 2 cans (14.4 oz) tomato soup
- 1 cup milk
- 1 cup cheddar

METHOD

1. Boil macaroni 8 mins; drain.
2. Return the pot to low heat, add the tomato soup and milk, and stir until hot. Stir in the cheddar and the pasta until creamy.

BETTER WITH *Garlic, oregano, parmesan, chili flakes* A clove of garlic and a teaspoon of oregano stirred into the tomato soup — canned soup is sweet, and the herbs are what stop it tasting like a dessert. Parmesan and chili flakes over the bowls.

474 kcal · 18g protein · 78g carbs · 10g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 197

4 WRAPS · 6 MINS · EASY

46

Ham & Cheese Pinwheel Wraps

INGREDIENTS

- 8 oz sliced ham
- ½ cup cheddar
- 2 tbsp mayo
- 4 tortillas [359]

METHOD

1. Spread mayo on tortillas, layer ham and cheddar.
2. Roll tightly and slice into 1-inch pinwheels.

BETTER WITH *Mustard, black pepper, dill* Mustard mixed into the mayo — ham and mustard is the whole point of a ham wrap. Black pepper and a little dill.

322 kcal · 16g protein · 24g carbs · 18g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 326

8 SERVINGS · 1 HR 30 MINS · IN-DEPTH

46

Cottage Cheese Lasagna

The Egg Holds the Layers

INGREDIENTS

- 16 oz pasta
- 2 lbs ground beef
- 1 jar (27.7 oz) spaghetti sauce
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 2 cups cottage cheese
- 1 egg
- 2 cups cheddar
- 1 tsp salt
- black pepper

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F.
2. Boil the pasta two minutes short of the packet time; it finishes in the oven.
3. Brown the beef in a wide pan, breaking it up, until no pink is left. Drain the fat off.
4. Stir the spaghetti sauce and tomato sauce into the beef and simmer 10 minutes.
5. Beat the egg into the cottage cheese with the salt and plenty of pepper. The egg is what stops it running out of the layers.
6. Layer a 9x13 dish: sauce, pasta, cottage cheese, cheddar. Repeat, and finish with sauce and cheddar on top.
7. Cover with foil and bake 30 minutes, then uncover and bake 15 more, until brown at the edges.
8. Stand it 15 minutes before cutting. Cut hot, it slides apart.

BETTER WITH *Parmesan* A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

641 kcal · 46g protein · 58g carbs · 25g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 325

6 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · MEDIUM

51

Broccoli Cheddar Soup

Off the Heat for the Cheese

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb broccoli
- 2 carrots
- 1 onion
- 4 tbsp butter
- ¼ cup white flour
- 2 cups milk
- 1 can (12 oz) evaporated milk
- 2 cups water
- 2 cups cheddar
- 1 tsp salt
- black pepper

METHOD

1. Cook the diced onion in the butter over medium heat for 6 minutes, until soft and not browned.
2. Whisk in the flour and cook it a full minute, until it looks like wet sand.
3. Add the milk and evaporated milk a splash at a time, whisking each smooth before the next, then stir in the water.
4. Add the broccoli cut small and the carrots grated. Simmer 15 minutes, until the broccoli gives under a spoon.
5. Off the heat, stir in the cheddar a handful at a time. Boiled, cheese goes grainy and the fat splits out.
6. Salt and pepper it, and taste it. A soup this thick takes more salt than seems right.

411 kcal · 18g protein · 24g carbs · 27g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 198

4 PERSONAL PIZZAS · 12 MINS · EASY

60

BBQ Chicken Tortilla Pizzas

INGREDIENTS

- 4 tortillas 359
- 1 can (12.5 oz) chicken
- 4 tbsp BBQ sauce 355
- ½ cup cheddar

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 400°F.
2. Spread BBQ sauce on tortillas, top with chicken and cheddar. No bottle in the house? Recipe 355 makes barbecue sauce from the storehouse shelf.
3. Bake at 400°F for 8 mins until crispy.

BETTER WITH *Red onion, cilantro, chili flakes* Thin-sliced red onion over the barbecue sauce before the cheese. Cilantro and chili flakes after it comes out.

306 kcal · 23g protein · 31g carbs · 10g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 199

4 BOWLS · 20 MINS · MEDIUM 58

Cheesy Potato Chowder

INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups cubed potatoes
- 2 cups milk
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 cup cheddar
- 4 oz ham

METHOD

1. Boil potatoes in 2 cups water 12 mins.
2. Mash about a third of the potatoes against the side of the pot. Stir in the milk, butter and diced ham and bring back to a gentle simmer for 5 mins, until it thickens slightly.
3. Take it off the heat and stir in the cheddar until melted.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, thyme, bay, black pepper, A bottle of vinegar*

Soften a diced onion in the butter before anything else goes in, with a clove of garlic for the last minute. A bay leaf and a pinch of thyme in with the milk, fished out before serving. Potato and milk on their own taste of almost nothing; this is the whole difference. A teaspoon of vinegar stirred in at the end, off the heat. It does not taste of vinegar; it tastes like the pot woke up.

360 kcal · 18g protein · 27g carbs · 20g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 324

6 SERVINGS · 35 MINS · MEDIUM 55

Onion Rings

Dry Flour First

INGREDIENTS

- 2 onions
- ¾ cup white flour, for the batter
- ¾ cup white flour, for the dredge
- 1 cup milk
- 1 egg
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 4 cups vegetable oil (for frying)

METHOD

1. Slice the onions into rounds half an inch thick and push them apart into rings.
2. Whisk half the flour with the milk, egg, salt and pepper into a batter about the thickness of pouring cream.
3. Put the rest of the flour in a shallow bowl.
4. Heat the oil to 350°F in a deep pan.
5. Turn each ring in the dry flour first, then through the batter. The dry coat is what gives the batter something to hold on to.
6. Fry a handful at a time for 2 to 3 minutes, turning once, until gold. Drain them and salt them straight away.

275 kcal · 5g protein · 21g carbs · 19g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 323

6 SERVINGS · 40 MINS · MEDIUM

71

Chicken Nuggets

Even Sizes, Uncrowded Pan

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breast
- 1 cup milk, for the soak
- 1 egg, for the soak
- 1.5 cups white flour, for the dredge
- 2 tsp salt, for the dredge
- 1 tsp black pepper, for the dredge
- 4 cups vegetable oil (for frying)

METHOD

1. Cut the chicken into pieces about an inch and a half across. Even sizes matter more than shape here — a small piece is dry by the time a big one is done.
2. Whisk the milk and egg together in one bowl. Mix the flour, salt and pepper in another.
3. Soak the chicken in the milk and egg for 15 minutes.
4. Heat the oil in a deep pan to 350°F. A pinch of flour dropped in should sizzle straight away.
5. Lift each piece out, let it drip, and turn it in the seasoned flour until it is covered all over.
6. Fry in batches for 4 to 5 minutes, turning once, until deep gold. Crowding the pan drops the temperature and gives you greasy nuggets.
7. Cut the thickest one open before serving: white through, 165°F, no pink.

329 kcal · 27g protein · 8g carbs · 21g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 200

4 BOWLS · 12 MINS · EASY

71

Taco Salad Bowls

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef
- 2 cups lettuce
- 2 tomatoes
- ½ cup cheddar
- salsa
- sour cream
- 2 tbsp taco seasoning (optional) 310

METHOD

1. Brown beef in skillet 8 mins. Add 2 tbsp taco seasoning and ¼ cup water to the browned beef and let it bubble a minute until it clings. Seasoning tipped over the top at the end sits on the meat instead of in it. No packet in the house? Recipe 310 makes taco seasoning from seven pantry spices.
2. Layer lettuce, tomatoes, beef, cheddar, salsa, and sour cream in 4 bowls.

290 kcal · 27g protein · 5g carbs · 18g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 201

4 SANDWICHES · 10 MINS · EASY

48

Ham & Peach Hawaiian Melts

INGREDIENTS

- 8 bread slices 295
- 8 oz ham
- 1 cup canned peaches, drained and diced
- ½ cup cheddar
- butter

METHOD

1. Layer ham, diced peaches, and cheddar inside bread.
2. Griddle in butter 4 mins per side.

BETTER WITH *Mustard, black pepper* A scrape of mustard inside. Ham, cheese and something sweet needs a sharp corner or it is just sweet. Black pepper over the peaches.

346 kcal · 18g protein · 37g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 202 4 BOWLS · 12 MINS · EASY 65

Cheesy Corn & Bean Chowder

INGREDIENTS

- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn
- 1 can (15 oz) black beans
- 2 cups milk
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 cup cheddar

METHOD

1. Combine corn, black beans, milk, and butter in pot; simmer 8 mins.
2. Stir in cheddar until melted.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, cumin, smoked paprika, lime* A diced onion softened in the butter, garlic after. A teaspoon each of cumin and smoked paprika with the milk, and lime squeezed over the bowls.

346 kcal · 16g protein · 30g carbs · 18g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 203 4 STUFFED TOMATOES · 8 MINS · EASY 81

Chicken Salad Stuffed Tomatoes

INGREDIENTS

- 1 can (12.5 oz) chicken
- 2 tbsp mayo
- ½ cup diced cucumber
- 4 large tomatoes

METHOD

1. Hollow out tomatoes.
2. Mix chicken, mayo, and cucumber.
3. Spoon inside tomatoes and serve cold.

BETTER WITH *Onion, lemon, dill* Diced onion into the chicken mix and a squeeze of lemon over the hollowed tomatoes before filling. Dill through the mayo.

176 kcal · 18g protein · 8g carbs · 8g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 322 12 SERVINGS · 30 MINS · MEDIUM 52

Cheddar Bay Biscuits

Dropped, Not Rolled

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups white flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- 6 tbsp butter
- 1 cup cheddar
- ¾ cup milk
- 2 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 425°F.
2. Rub the cold butter into the flour, baking powder and salt with your fingertips, until it looks like coarse crumbs.
3. Stir in the cheddar, then the milk, with a fork — only until it comes together. A few dry patches are better than a smooth dough.
4. Drop twelve spoonfuls onto an ungreased tray, leaving room between them.
5. Bake 12 to 14 minutes, until risen and golden at the edges.
6. Melt the last 2 tbsp of butter and brush it over them as they come out of the oven.

187 kcal · 5g protein · 17g carbs · 11g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 321 · 12 SERVINGS · 2 HRS 15 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 52

Endless Breadsticks

Brushed Hot, Not Cold

INGREDIENTS

- 4 cups white flour
- 1 packet (¼ oz) yeast
- 1.5 cups warm water
- 2 tbsp sugar
- 2 tsp salt
- 6 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Stir the yeast and sugar into the warm water and leave it 5 minutes, until it foams.
2. Mix in the flour, 2 tbsp of the butter melted, and the salt. Knead 8 minutes, until smooth.
3. Cover and rise 1 hour, until doubled.
4. Divide into twelve. Roll each into a rope about 7 inches long and set them on a buttered tray with room between them.
5. Cover and rise another 45 minutes, until puffed.
6. Bake at 400°F for 12 to 14 minutes, until golden.
7. Melt the rest of the butter with a good pinch of salt and brush it over while they are still hot. Brushed cold, it sits on top instead of soaking in.

210 kcal · 5g protein · 34g carbs · 6g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 204 · 4 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · EASY · 53

Beef Frank & Potato Skillet

INGREDIENTS

- 4 sliced beef franks
- 2 cups cubed potatoes
- ½ onion
- 2 tbsp oil
- ¼ cup ketchup

METHOD

1. Fry the cubed potatoes in oil over medium 12 to 15 minutes, until a corner crushes under a spoon. Then add the onion and frank coins for 5 minutes more; the franks only want colour. Serve with ketchup.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic* Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last minute of cooking — any longer and it burns bitter.

279 kcal · 7g protein · 20g carbs · 19g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 205 · 4 PINWHEEL ROLLS · 5 MINS · EASY · 61

PB & Banana Honey Toast Pinwheels

INGREDIENTS

- 4 tortillas [359]
- ½ cup peanut butter
- 2 tbsp honey
- 2 bananas

METHOD

1. Spread peanut butter and honey on tortillas.
2. Place banana in center, roll tightly, and cut into coins.

427 kcal · 12g protein · 52g carbs · 19g fat

All pantry staples



SECTION 3

Kid-Approved Weeknight Comfort Dinners

Weeknight dinners the children will actually finish.

37 RECIPES

NO. 320

8 SERVINGS · 2 HRS · IN-DEPTH 46

Soft Pretzels, Mall-Style

The Soda Bath Is the Whole Thing

INGREDIENTS

- 4.5 cups white flour
- 1 packet (¼ oz) yeast
- 1.5 cups warm water
- 2 tbsp brown sugar
- 4 tbsp butter
- 2 tsp salt
- ⅔ cup baking soda (for the water)
- 8 cups water
- 1 egg

METHOD

1. Stir the yeast and brown sugar into the warm water and leave it 5 minutes, until it foams. Water hotter than bathwater kills the yeast and nothing will rise.
2. Mix in the flour, the melted butter and the salt, then knead 6 minutes, until the dough is smooth and springs back when pressed.
3. Cover it and leave it to rise 1 hour, until doubled.
4. Heat the oven to 450°F. Bring the 8 cups of water to a rolling boil in a wide pot.
5. Divide the dough into eight. Roll each piece into a rope about 20 inches long and twist it into a pretzel.
6. Whisk the baking soda into the boiling water a spoonful at a time. It foams up hard, so stand back and use a pot with room above the water.
7. Lower the pretzels in two at a time for 30 seconds, then lift them out and drain them well.
8. Brush with beaten egg, scatter salt over, and bake 12 to 14 minutes until deep brown. The soda bath is what makes a pretzel taste like a pretzel instead of bread.

323 kcal · 8g protein · 57g carbs · 7g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 319 · 6 SERVINGS · 35 MINS · EASY · 50

Honey Mustard Dipping Sauce

Sweet First, Tangy Second

INGREDIENTS

- ½ cup mayo
- 2 tbsp honey
- 1 tbsp mustard
- 2 tbsp BBQ sauce [355]

METHOD

1. Whisk the mayo and honey together until completely smooth.
2. Add the mustard and the barbecue sauce and whisk again. Recipe 355 makes the barbecue sauce, if there is no bottle.
3. Taste it. It should be sweet first, tangy second, smoky underneath — adjust with a little more honey or mustard.
4. Chill 30 minutes before serving.

158 kcal · 0g protein · 8g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 206 · 6 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · MEDIUM · 62

Homemade Cheesy Beefaroni Skillet

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef
- 16 oz macaroni
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 1 can (28 oz) diced tomatoes
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp Italian seasoning
- 1 cup cheddar

METHOD

1. Boil macaroni 8 mins; drain.
2. Brown ground beef in skillet 8 mins, drain grease.
3. Stir in tomato sauce, diced tomatoes, and pasta. Stir in a teaspoon of garlic powder and a teaspoon of Italian seasoning here — stirred into the sauce is the only place they do anything.
4. Top with cheddar, cover lid 3 mins to melt.

BETTER WITH *Onion, parmesan* A diced onion with the beef. Parmesan over the cheddar before the lid goes on.

543 kcal · 32g protein · 70g carbs · 15g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 207 6 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · MEDIUM 52

Soft Taco & Burrito Bowl Bar

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 12 tortillas 359
- 1 can (15 oz) black beans
- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn
- lettuce
- cheddar
- salsa
- 2 tbsp taco seasoning (optional) 310

METHOD

1. Brown ground beef in skillet 8 mins with 2 tbsp taco seasoning and ¼ cup water, until the water has gone and the seasoning clings. No packet in the house? Recipe 310 makes taco seasoning from seven pantry spices.
2. Warm black beans and corn.
3. Set out tortillas, meat, beans, corn, lettuce, and cheese for custom taco assembly. Salsa out with them.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic* Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last thirty seconds before the liquid goes in — any longer and it burns bitter.

585 kcal · 36g protein · 63g carbs · 21g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 318 6 SANDWICHES · 1 HR 40 MINS · IN-DEPTH 55

Pickle-Brined Chicken Sandwiches

Two Pickles, Nothing Else

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs chicken breasts
- 1 cup pickle juice, for the soak
- 1 cup white flour, for the dredge
- 1 egg
- ½ cup milk
- 2 tsp paprika, for the dredge
- 1 tsp black pepper, for the dredge
- 2 tsp salt, for the dredge
- 3 cups vegetable oil (for frying)
- 6 hamburger buns
- 12 dill pickle slices
- 2 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Slice the chicken breasts flat and pound them to an even thickness so they cook through at the same rate.
2. Soak them in the pickle juice for 1 hour. Longer than two and the texture turns rubbery.
3. Beat the egg with the milk. Mix the flour with the paprika, pepper and salt.
4. Dip each piece in the egg, then press it firmly into the seasoned flour.
5. Heat the oil to 350°F in a heavy pan.
6. Fry 3 to 4 minutes a side until deep gold and the thickest piece reads 165°F inside, then drain on a rack.
7. Butter the cut side of the buns and toast them face down in a dry pan until golden — the buttered toast is what keeps the bun from going soggy.
8. Build with two pickle slices and nothing else. That is the whole point of it.

516 kcal · 42g protein · 33g carbs · 24g fat

Also needs: Pickle juice

NO. 317 10 SERVINGS · 1 HR 15 MINS · MEDIUM 53

Country Store Hash Brown Casserole

Squeezed Dry So It Crisps

INGREDIENTS

- 3 lbs potatoes
- 2 cups cheddar
- 1 cup sour cream
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of chicken soup [361]
- ½ cup butter
- 1 onion
- 1 tsp salt
- black pepper

METHOD

1. Grate the potatoes coarsely, then squeeze them dry in a clean cloth. Wet potato steams instead of browning and the casserole goes watery.
2. Melt the butter and stir it through the potatoes with the finely diced onion.
3. Mix in the sour cream, the soup, half the cheese, the salt and plenty of pepper.
4. Spread it into a buttered 9x13 dish without pressing it down — you want air in it.
5. Scatter the remaining cheese over the top.
6. Bake at 350°F for 50 minutes, until it is bubbling at the edges and the top is deeply browned.
7. Rest 10 minutes before serving so it holds together on the spoon.

BETTER WITH *Parmesan* A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

359 kcal · 9g protein · 29g carbs · 23g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 208 6 SERVINGS · 35 MINS · MEDIUM 48

Creamy Chicken & Biscuit Pot Pie Casserole

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breast (cooked/cubed)
- 2 cans (10.5 oz) cream of chicken soup [361]
- 1 can (14.5 oz) green beans, drained
- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn, drained
- 2 cups flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- ¾ tsp salt
- ¾ cup milk
- 4 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F.
2. Mix chicken, soup, green beans, and corn in 9x13 dish. Cook the chicken through before it goes into the dish — 165°F, no pink at the centre. The topping bakes faster than raw chicken would.
3. Whisk the flour, baking powder and salt, then stir in the milk and melted butter just until a dough forms.
4. Drop spoonfuls over filling and bake at 375°F for 30 mins until golden.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, thyme, black pepper, A bottle of vinegar, Parmesan* A diced onion and a clove of garlic softened and stirred into the soup. A good pinch of dried thyme and more black pepper than seems right. Pot pie is a thyme dish. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself. A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

506 kcal · 35g protein · 51g carbs · 18g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 209

4 SERVINGS · 30 MINS · EASY

43

Sheet-Pan Franks & Crispy Potato Diggers

INGREDIENTS

- 8 beef franks (sliced)
- 1.5 lbs potatoes (cubed)
- 1 lb carrots
- 1 lb broccoli
- 2 tbsp oil

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 425°F. At 400 the cubed potato steams as often as it crisps.
2. Toss the potatoes and carrots with the oil, salt and pepper and spread them out on a sheet pan in one layer — crowded, they steam. Roast 20 minutes.
3. Add the sliced franks and the broccoli, toss everything together, and give it 10 minutes more. The broccoli only needs that; put it in at the start and it is ash by the end.
4. The potatoes are done when a corner crushes under a spoon and the outside has gone golden and rough.

BETTER WITH *Garlic powder, smoked paprika, oregano, Parmesan* Toss the potatoes and carrots with a teaspoon each of garlic powder and smoked paprika as well as the oil. A pinch of oregano over everything for the last ten minutes. A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

555 kcal · 17g protein · 52g carbs · 31g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 316

8 SERVINGS · 1 HR 20 MINS · MEDIUM

73

Thick Diner-Style Chili

Better the Next Day

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs ground beef
- 1 onion
- 1 can (28 oz) diced tomatoes
- 2 cans (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 1 can (15 oz) pinto beans
- 1 can (15 oz) black beans
- 3 carrots
- 2 tbsp chili powder
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 2 cups water
- salt
- black pepper

METHOD

1. Brown the ground beef in a large pot, breaking it up small. Drain off the fat.
2. Add the diced onion and grated carrot and cook 8 minutes until soft. The carrot is the secret — it sweetens the chili without any sugar.
3. Stir in the chili powder and cumin and cook 1 minute, until they smell toasted rather than dusty.
4. Add the diced tomatoes, tomato sauce and water and bring to a simmer.
5. Simmer uncovered 45 minutes, stirring now and then, until it has darkened and thickened.
6. Add both cans of drained beans and simmer another 15 minutes.
7. Season with salt and plenty of black pepper. It is better the next day, and better again the day after.

328 kcal · 29g protein · 26g carbs · 12g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 315 · 10 SERVINGS · 12 MINS · EASY · 45

Sticky Finger Sauce

Sweet, Hot, Sticky

INGREDIENTS

- ⅔ cup hot sauce
- 1.5 cups brown sugar
- 2 tbsp water

METHOD

1. Stir the hot sauce, brown sugar and water together in a small pan.
2. Bring it to a simmer over medium heat, stirring until the sugar has completely dissolved.
3. Simmer 4 to 5 minutes until it thickens enough to coat the back of a spoon.
4. Take it off the heat and let it cool slightly — it thickens more as it stands.
5. Toss it through hot fried chicken pieces just before serving, so the coating stays crisp underneath.

132 kcal · 0g protein · 33g carbs · 0g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 210 · 6 SERVINGS · 22 MINS · MEDIUM · 62

Classic Spaghetti & Meat Sauce

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 16 oz spaghetti
- 1 jar (27.7 oz) spaghetti sauce
- 1 can (14.5 oz) green beans

METHOD

1. Boil spaghetti 9 mins; drain.
2. Brown beef in pot 8 mins, stir in spaghetti sauce and simmer 10 mins.
3. Warm the green beans, or roast them: drained, oil, salt, 425°F, fifteen minutes, until they blister. Boiled beans are a side; roasted beans get eaten off the tray.
4. Serve sauce over spaghetti with green beans on the side.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, oregano, basil, parmesan* Soften a diced onion before the beef and add two cloves of garlic once it has browned. A teaspoon each of dried oregano and basil into the sauce, and let it simmer the full ten minutes with them in — dried herbs need time in liquid to give anything up. Parmesan at the table.

559 kcal · 35g protein · 71g carbs · 15g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 211

4 SERVINGS · 25 MINS · MEDIUM

79

Baked Chicken Breasts with Mashed Potatoes & Corn

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breasts
- 1 tbsp oil
- 2 cups instant potatoes 362
- 2 tbsp butter
- ½ cup milk
- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 425°F. Pat the chicken dry, rub it with the oil, salt and pepper, and bake about 22 minutes, until the thickest part reads 165°F.
2. Make up the mashed potatoes with the butter and milk, 2 cups of flakes to 2 cups of boiling water. No flakes? Recipe 362.
3. Serve chicken with potatoes and corn.

459 kcal · 43g protein · 38g carbs · 15g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 314

18 ROLLS · 2 HRS 30 MINS · IN-DEPTH

50

Steakhouse Rolls with Cinnamon Honey Butter

Square, Pillowy, Dangerous

INGREDIENTS

- 4.5 cups white flour
- 1.25 cups warm milk
- 1 packet (¼ oz) yeast
- ⅓ cup sugar
- 1 egg
- ¼ cup butter
- 2 tsp salt
- ½ cup butter
- ¼ cup honey
- ¼ cup powdered sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon

METHOD

1. Warm the milk to blood heat, stir in the yeast and a spoonful of the sugar, and leave 10 minutes until foamy.
2. Mix in the egg, the remaining sugar, the quarter cup of melted butter and the salt.
3. Add the flour a cup at a time until you have a soft dough, then knead 8 minutes until smooth.
4. Cover and rise 1 hour until doubled.
5. Roll out to half an inch thick and cut into squares — square is the shape that makes these recognisable.
6. Set them on a tray with room to spread, cover, and rise 45 minutes.
7. Bake at 350°F for 12 to 14 minutes, only until barely golden. Overbaked, they lose the pillowy middle.
8. Beat the half cup of soft butter with the honey, powdered sugar and cinnamon until light and whipped.
9. Brush the hot rolls with butter and serve with the honey butter alongside.

233 kcal · 4g protein · 34g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 313 · 6 SERVINGS · 5 HRS · IN-DEPTH · 67

Crispy Buttermilk Fried Chicken

Craggy, Golden, Worth the Mess

INGREDIENTS

- 3 lbs chicken breasts
- 2 cups buttermilk, for the soak
- 3 cups white flour, for the dredge
- 2 eggs
- 2 tbsp paprika, for the dredge
- 1 tbsp garlic powder, for the dredge
- 1 tbsp onion powder, for the dredge
- 2 tsp black pepper, for the dredge
- 1 tsp dried thyme, for the dredge
- 1 tsp dried oregano, for the dredge
- 1 tsp mustard powder, for the dredge
- 1 tbsp salt, for the dredge
- 4 cups vegetable oil (for frying)

METHOD

1. Cut the chicken into pieces and soak them in the buttermilk for at least 4 hours, or overnight. This is what makes it tender all the way through.
2. Mix the flour with the paprika, garlic powder, onion powder, pepper, thyme, oregano, mustard powder and salt. Rub the mixture between your fingers so the spices spread evenly.
3. Beat the eggs with a splash of the buttermilk in a second bowl.
4. Lift each piece out of the buttermilk, into the flour, into the egg, then back into the flour. The double coat is where the craggy crust comes from.
5. Let the coated pieces sit 15 minutes. If you fry them straight away the coating slides off.
6. Heat the oil to 325°F in a deep heavy pan, no more than a third full. Keep a lid nearby.
7. Fry in small batches 12 to 15 minutes, turning once, until deep gold. Crowding the pan drops the temperature and gives you greasy chicken.
8. Check the thickest piece reads 165°F inside, then drain on a rack, not on paper — paper steams the bottom soft.
9. Salt the moment it comes out of the oil.

513 kcal · 56g protein · 16g carbs · 25g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 212 · 6 SERVINGS · 8 HRS · IN-DEPTH · 67

Slow-Cooker Pork Roast with Applesauce & Green Beans

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork roast
- 1 jar (26.5 oz) applesauce
- 2 cans (14.5 oz) green beans
- 1.5 lbs potatoes

METHOD

1. Brown the pork in a hot pan, dark on every side. The cooker cannot make that crust, and the roast tastes of it for hours.
2. Put the pork and quartered potatoes into the slow cooker with 1 cup water. Cook LOW 8 hours.
3. Serve sliced pork with applesauce and green beans.

BETTER WITH *Garlic, rosemary, black pepper, A bottle of vinegar, Parmesan* Cut slits in the pork and push slivers of garlic into them before it goes in the cooker. A branch of rosemary in with it, and black pepper over the top. Pork and applesauce is a sweet pairing and wants something woody against it. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself. A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

548 kcal · 29g protein · 45g carbs · 28g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 213

6 SERVINGS · 30 MINS · MEDIUM

58

Mild Beef & Bean Chili with Corn Skillet Bread

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 2 cans (15 oz) pinto beans
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 1 can (28 oz) diced tomatoes
- 1 cup pancake mix [360]
- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn
- 1 egg
- ½ cup milk
- 1 tbsp vegetable oil

METHOD

1. Brown the beef 8 minutes, breaking it up, and drain it. Add the beans, tomato sauce and diced tomatoes and simmer 20 minutes.
2. Meanwhile whisk the pancake mix with the egg and milk into a thick batter — closer to muffin batter than pancake batter — and fold in the drained corn.
3. Heat the oil in a skillet over medium. Pour the batter in, cover, and cook 6 to 8 minutes until the top is set, then flip it and give it 3 minutes more.
4. Cut it into wedges and serve with the chili.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, smoked paprika, oregano* Onion with the beef, garlic after. Smoked paprika and oregano into the pot with the beans.

497 kcal · 35g protein · 51g carbs · 17g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 312

12 SERVINGS · 1 HR 10 MINS · EASY

55

Creamy Tomatillo Ranch Dressing

The Green Dressing

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup ranch dressing
- ½ cup salsa verde
- ¼ cup milk
- 1 lime
- cilantro
- 1 clove garlic

METHOD

1. Put the ranch, salsa verde and milk in a jug.
2. Add the juice of the lime, a large handful of cilantro and the peeled garlic clove.
3. Blend until it is completely smooth and pale green.
4. Thin with a little more milk if it is thicker than pouring cream.
5. Chill at least an hour before serving — it tastes sharp and disjointed straight away and comes together cold.

93 kcal · 1g protein · 2g carbs · 9g fat

Also needs: Salsa verde, Limes, Cilantro

NO. 311 8 TACOS · 25 MINS · EASY 78

Taco Beef, Drive-Through Style

Fine, Saucy, Made in a Pan

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef
- 2 tbsp taco seasoning 310
- 1 tbsp flour
- 1 cup water

METHOD

1. Brown the beef in a dry skillet over medium-high heat, chopping it with the edge of the spoon as it cooks. Keep chopping: the drive-through version is fine and even, with no big crumbles, and that texture comes from the spoon, not the recipe.
2. Tip off the fat. Sprinkle the flour over the meat and stir it through for a minute so it cooks out.
3. Add the taco seasoning and the water, bring it to a simmer, and let it go 10 to 12 minutes, stirring now and then, until the liquid has thickened to a sauce that coats the meat and nothing pools in the pan.
4. Taste it. It should be a little saltier than seems right on its own, because a tortilla, lettuce and cheese all take some of that back.
5. A quarter cup in a warm tortilla is a taco. It reheats well, which is the point of making a pound.

102 kcal · 11g protein · 1g carbs · 6g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 214 6 SERVINGS · 8 HRS · IN-DEPTH 57

Slow-Cooker Beef Stew with Ribbon Pasta

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs stewing beef
- 1.5 lbs potatoes
- 1 lb carrots
- 1 onion
- 1½ tsp salt
- 16 oz ribbon pasta

METHOD

1. Brown the beef in a hot pan, dark on every side. The cooker cannot make that crust, and the stew tastes of it for hours.
2. Place beef, potatoes, carrots, onions, salt and 2 cups water in slow cooker. Cook LOW 8 hours.
3. Boil ribbon pasta 8 mins; serve stew over pasta.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, A bottle of vinegar* Two cloves of garlic, chopped fine, in after the onion and before the liquid. Thirty seconds is enough; it only needs to smell. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself.

715 kcal · 42g protein · 85g carbs · 23g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 215

6 SERVINGS · 35 MINS · MEDIUM

55

Creamy Chicken Pasta Casserole

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breast
- 16 oz ribbon pasta
- 2 cans (10.5 oz) cream of chicken [361]
- 1¼ cups milk
- 1 cup cheddar
- 1 lb broccoli

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F.
2. Pat the chicken dry and lay it in a hot pan, and do not move it until the underside is brown. Wet chicken steams; dry chicken browns. Cook it through — 165°F, no pink at the centre — then dice it. Twenty-five minutes under a blanket of soup will not cook it, so it goes in already done.
3. Boil the pasta two minutes short of the packet time; it finishes in the oven.
4. Whisk the soup with the milk, then mix it with the chicken, pasta, broccoli and cheese in a 9x13 dish.
5. Bake at 350°F for 25 minutes, until it bubbles at the edges.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, thyme, lemon, parmesan* Soften a diced onion and two cloves of garlic and stir them through the soup. A pinch of dried thyme in, and a squeeze of lemon over the top when it comes out. Acid is what a cream-soup bake is always missing.

625 kcal · 46g protein · 72g carbs · 17g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 310

2 SERVINGS · 5 MINS · EASY

27

Taco Seasoning

Two Tablespoons to the Pound

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp chili powder
- 1 tbsp cumin
- 1 tsp paprika
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp onion powder
- 1 tsp oregano
- 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp cornstarch

METHOD

1. Stir everything together in a small jar and put the lid on. That is the whole method.
2. Half the jar seasons a pound of meat. Add it to browned meat with a quarter cup of water and let it bubble a minute until it clings — the cornstarch is what makes it cling rather than sit on top.
3. It keeps in the cupboard for months. Shake the jar before you measure, since the salt settles to the bottom.

4 kcal · 0g protein · 1g carbs · 0g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 309 8 SERVINGS · 5 HRS 15 MINS · EASY 53

Horchata, Cafe Rio Style

Sweet, Cold, Faintly of Cinnamon

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup rice, blended and strained
- 2 tsp cinnamon
- 4 cups hot water
- 2 cups cold water
- 0.5 cup sugar
- 0.5 cup evaporated milk
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 pinch salt

METHOD

1. Rinse the rice until the water runs mostly clear. Put it in a bowl with the cinnamon and the 4 cups of hot water, cover, and leave it at least 4 hours or overnight in the fridge. Hot water pulls more out of the rice than cold.
2. Tip the lot into a blender and run it on high for 2 minutes, until the rice is a fine, milky slurry.
3. Pour it through a fine sieve lined with a clean cloth into a jug. Squeeze the cloth to get the last of it, then throw the grit away. Strain it twice if you want it silky.
4. Stir in the sugar, the evaporated milk, the vanilla, the salt and the 2 cups of cold water until the sugar is gone. Taste it: sweet, but not syrupy.
5. Chill it an hour. It separates, so stir before you pour. Serve over plenty of ice with a shake of cinnamon on top.

BETTER WITH *Canela (Mexican cinnamon sticks)* Soak 2 canela sticks with the rice in place of the ground cinnamon, and blend them in with it. The flavour is rounder and less dusty. A quarter cup of blanched almonds soaked alongside the rice makes it richer still.

113 kcal · 2g protein · 24g carbs · 1g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 216 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR 10 MINS · MEDIUM 64

Cheesy Ground Beef Potato Casserole

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 2 lbs potatoes (sliced thin)
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of mushroom soup
- ¾ cup milk
- 1 cup cheddar

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F.
2. Brown beef 8 mins and drain the fat.
3. Whisk the soup with the milk. Layer potatoes, beef and soup in a 9x13-inch baking dish, holding back the cheddar. No mushroom soup? Recipe 361 layers in exactly the same way, and Recipe 356 made pale does the binding just as well.
4. Cover with foil and bake at 375°F for 45 mins. Uncover, scatter the cheddar over, and bake 15 mins more, until a knife slides through the potatoes easily.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, paprika, hot sauce, A bottle of vinegar, Parmesan* A diced onion with the beef and garlic at the end. A teaspoon of paprika into the soup, and hot sauce at the table. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself. A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

445 kcal · 32g protein · 32g carbs · 21g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 217 · 6 SANDWICHES · 6–8 HRS · IN-DEPTH · 49

BBQ Pulled Pork Sandwiches on Buns

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork roast
- ½ cup BBQ sauce 355
- 6 hamburger buns
- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn

METHOD

1. Put the pork roast in the slow cooker with ½ cup water and cook on LOW 6 to 8 hours, until it pulls apart easily with two forks. Shred it, pour off most of the liquid, and stir in the BBQ sauce. No bottle in the house? Recipe 355 makes barbecue sauce from the storehouse shelf.
2. Serve on buns alongside warmed corn.

BETTER WITH *Red onion, cider vinegar, A head of garlic* A splash of cider vinegar stirred through the pulled pork — bottled barbecue sauce is sweet and vinegar is what cuts it. Thin-sliced raw red onion on the buns. Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last thirty seconds before the liquid goes in — any longer and it burns bitter.

574 kcal · 32g protein · 44g carbs · 30g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 308 · 8 SERVINGS · 40 MINS · MEDIUM · 44

Cilantro Lime Rice

Green, Bright, Never Sticky

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups rice
- 4 cups water
- 2 tbsp butter
- 2 tsp salt
- 1 lime
- cilantro

METHOD

1. Rinse the rice under cold water until the water runs clear. Rinsing is what stops it going sticky.
2. Melt the butter in the pan and stir the drained rice through it for 2 minutes, until the grains look glassy at the edges.
3. Add the water and salt, bring to a boil, then turn it to the lowest heat and cover.
4. Cook 18 minutes without lifting the lid, then take it off the heat and leave it covered another 10.
5. Fluff with a fork, then fold through the juice of the lime and a good handful of chopped cilantro.
6. Both go in at the end — cooked lime turns bitter and cooked cilantro turns to nothing.

187 kcal · 3g protein · 37g carbs · 3g fat

Also needs: Limes, Cilantro

NO. 307 10 SERVINGS · 7 HRS 30 MINS · IN-DEPTH 47

Sweet Pork Barbacoa, Cafe Rio Style

Browned Hard, Then Braised Sweet

INGREDIENTS

- 3 lbs pork roast
- 1 cup cola
- 1 cup brown sugar
- 1 cup salsa
- 2 tsp chili powder
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 2 tsp salt
- 1 tbsp vegetable oil

METHOD

1. Cut the pork into large chunks and pat them dry. Salt them well and leave them 20 minutes.
2. Brown the chunks hard in the oil, in batches. Do not crowd the pan — this browning is where the depth comes from and you cannot get it back later.
3. Put the pork in a slow cooker with half the cola and cook on low 6 hours, until it shreds under a fork.
4. Drain off and discard the cooking liquid. This is the step that separates the good version from the greasy one.
5. Shred the meat with two forks and return it to the pot.
6. Blend the remaining cola, brown sugar, salsa, chili powder and cumin, and pour it over.
7. Cook another hour on low, uncovered for the last 20 minutes so the sauce tightens and clings.
8. Taste for salt. Serve in tortillas, over rice, or in a bowl with beans and lettuce.

434 kcal · 24g protein · 26g carbs · 26g fat

Also needs: Cola

NO. 218 6 SERVINGS · 30 MINS · MEDIUM 65

Chicken & Broccoli Macaroni Bake

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breast
- 16 oz macaroni
- 1 lb broccoli
- 3 tbsp butter
- 3 tbsp flour
- 2½ cups milk
- 1.5 cups cheddar

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F. If the chicken is raw, pat it dry and lay it in a hot pan, and do not move it until the underside is brown; turn it and cook it through, 165°F with no pink at the centre, then dice it. Wet chicken steams; dry chicken browns.
2. Boil the macaroni two minutes short of the packet time, and add the broccoli for the last three so it keeps some bite. Both finish in the oven.
3. Melt the butter, whisk in the flour for 1 minute, then whisk in the milk and simmer until it coats a spoon. Off the heat, stir in 1 cup of the cheddar.
4. Mix the sauce with the pasta, broccoli and diced chicken in a 9x13 dish and top with the rest of the cheddar.
5. Bake at 350°F for 20 mins.

BETTER WITH *Garlic, mustard powder, black pepper, parmesan* A clove of garlic and half a teaspoon of mustard powder into the sauce — mustard makes cheddar taste more of cheddar without tasting of mustard. Plenty of black pepper, and parmesan mixed into the cheddar.

670 kcal · 48g protein · 70g carbs · 22g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 219

6 SERVINGS · 35 MINS · MEDIUM 52

Ground Beef Enchilada Casserole

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 8 tortillas 359
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 1 can (15 oz) black beans, drained
- 1 cup cheddar
- 2 tbsp taco seasoning (optional) 310

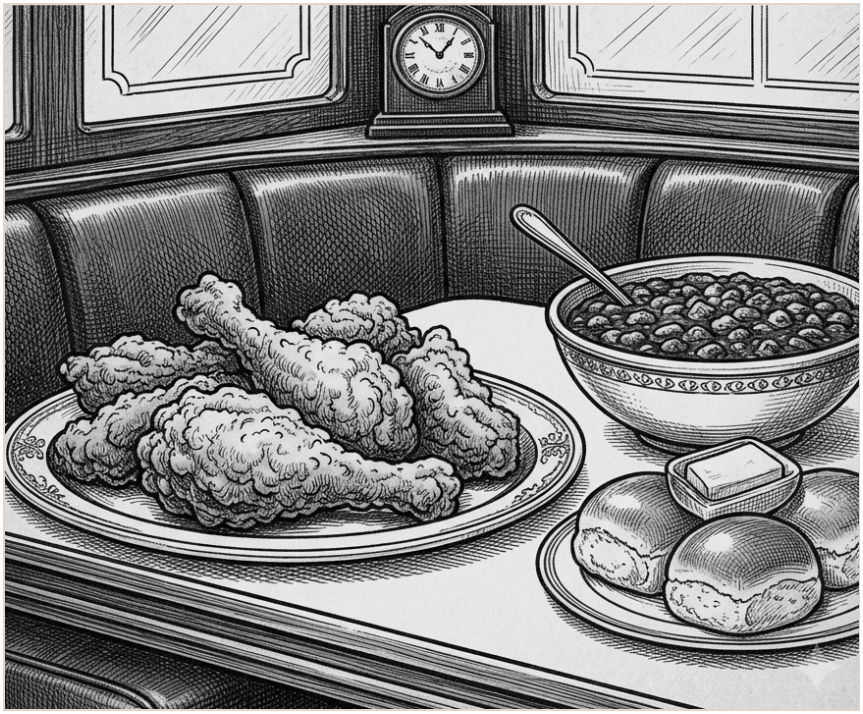
METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F.
2. Brown the beef and drain the fat, then stir in the black beans, tomato sauce and 2 tbsp taco seasoning and let it simmer a minute before it is layered. No packet in the house? Recipe 310 makes taco seasoning from seven pantry spices.
3. Layer tortillas, meat mixture, and cheese in a 9x13-inch dish.
4. Bake at 375°F for 25 mins.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, cumin, cilantro, lime, Parmesan* Onion and garlic with the beef, and a teaspoon of cumin beyond the taco seasoning. Cilantro and lime over the top out of the oven. A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

506 kcal · 35g protein · 42g carbs · 22g fat

All pantry staples



SECTION 7

The Copycat Shelf

The restaurant version, worked out at home.

38 RECIPES

NO. 306 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR 10 MINS · IN-DEPTH 62

White Bean & Ham Soup

Thickened With Its Own Beans

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cans (15 oz) great northern beans
- 1 lb sliced ham
- 1 onion
- 3 carrots
- 2 tbsp butter
- 6 cups water
- black pepper
- salt

METHOD

1. Dice the ham. Cook it in the butter over medium heat until the edges catch and brown — that browning is most of the flavour in a soup with this few ingredients.
2. Add the diced onion and carrot and cook 8 minutes until softened.
3. Pour in the water, scraping the bottom of the pot clean.
4. Add one can of the beans, drained, and simmer gently 40 minutes.
5. Mash the second can of beans to a rough paste and stir it in. It thickens the soup without any flour.
6. Simmer another 10 minutes, until it has body and coats the spoon.
7. Season with plenty of black pepper, and salt only at the end — the ham is already salty and it is easy to overshoot.

242 kcal · 18g protein · 20g carbs · 10g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 220 6 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · MEDIUM 63

Creamy Tomato & Chicken Pasta Skillet

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb chicken breast
- 16 oz spaghetti
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of chicken soup [361]

METHOD

1. Boil spaghetti 9 mins; drain.
2. Cut the chicken into bite-size pieces. Pat it dry and lay it in a hot pan, and do not move it until the underside is brown. Wet chicken steams; dry chicken browns. Pan-fry about 8 mins, until white through the middle and 165°F.
3. Stir in tomato sauce, cream of chicken soup, and pasta until creamy.

BETTER WITH *Garlic, oregano, chili flakes, parmesan* Two cloves of garlic and a teaspoon of oregano into the tomato sauce. Chili flakes to taste and parmesan at the table.

426 kcal · 29g protein · 64g carbs · 6g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 221 · 4 SUBS · 35 MINS · MEDIUM · 49

Meatball Marinara Sub Sandwiches

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 egg
- ½ cup breadcrumbs 358
- 2 cups spaghetti sauce
- 4 hot dog buns
- ½ cup cheddar

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 400°F. Mix beef, egg, breadcrumbs into meatballs; bake 20 mins. No breadcrumbs in the cupboard? Recipe 358 makes them from bread, which is on the order.
2. Simmer in sauce 10 mins.
3. Spoon into buns, top with cheddar.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, oregano, parmesan* A clove of garlic and a spoon of grated parmesan into the meatball mix. Onion and oregano into the marinara while it simmers.

534 kcal · 36g protein · 48g carbs · 22g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 222 · 4 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · MEDIUM · 79

Cheesy Chicken & Rice Skillet Dinner

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breast
- 2 cups cooked rice
- 1 cup cheddar
- 1 bell pepper
- ½ onion

METHOD

1. Sauté the peppers, onions and diced chicken over medium-high about 10 minutes, until the chicken is white through and a piece cut at the thickest point reads 165°F.
2. Stir in cooked rice and cheddar until cheese melts.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, A bottle of vinegar* Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last minute of cooking — any longer and it burns bitter. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself.

418 kcal · 47g protein · 26g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 305 · 16 SQUARES · 45 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 56

Browned Butter Cocoa Brownies

Glossy Top, Fudgy Middle

INGREDIENTS

- ¾ cup butter
- 1.25 cups sugar
- ¾ cup cocoa powder
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- ½ tsp salt
- ¾ cup white flour

METHOD

1. Melt the butter in a light-coloured pan and keep cooking it. It will foam, then quieten, then the solids at the bottom will turn golden and smell of nuts — about 5 minutes. That smell is the whole point.
2. Take it off the heat at once and whisk in the sugar, cocoa and salt while it is still hot.
3. Let it cool 5 minutes, or the eggs will cook.
4. Beat in the eggs one at a time, then keep beating for a full minute until the batter turns thick and glossy. That gloss is what gives brownies their papery top.
5. Stir in the vanilla.
6. Fold in the flour just until the last streak disappears. Any more and they turn cakey.
7. Spread in a lined 8-inch pan and bake at 350°F for 25 minutes. A skewer should come out with moist crumbs, not clean.
8. Cool completely in the pan before cutting. Warm brownies tear.

186 kcal · 2g protein · 22g carbs · 10g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 304

12 SERVINGS · 25 MINS · IN-DEPTH

42

Real Caramel Sauce

Copper-Penny Colour

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup sugar
- ¼ cup water
- 6 tbsp butter
- ½ cup evaporated milk
- salt

METHOD

1. Put the sugar and water in a heavy pan over medium heat and let the sugar dissolve without stirring.
2. Once it is clear, leave it alone. Swirl the pan now and then, but do not stir — stirring makes it crystallise and go grainy.
3. Cook 8 to 10 minutes until it turns the colour of a copper penny. Watch it closely at the end; it goes from amber to burnt in seconds.
4. Take it off the heat and add the butter. It will bubble up hard, so stand back and use a long spoon.
5. Warm the evaporated milk, then pour it in slowly, whisking. Cold liquid into hot sugar will seize it.
6. Whisk in a good pinch of salt and return to low heat for a minute if any lumps remain.
7. Cool in a jar. It thickens as it goes cold, and keeps a fortnight in the fridge.

139 kcal · 1g protein · 18g carbs · 7g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 223

6 SERVINGS · 30 MINS · MEDIUM

75

Shepherd's Pie with Fluffy Potato Topping

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 1 can (14.5 oz) carrots, drained
- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn, drained
- 2 cups instant potatoes 362
- 1¾ cups water
- ½ cup milk
- 2 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F.
2. Brown beef and drain the fat, then stir in carrots and corn.
3. Bring the water to a boil, then stir in the milk and potato flakes. Stir the butter into them while they are hot — that is the difference between a topping and a paste.
4. Spread the beef and vegetables in an 8x8-inch or 2-quart dish, spread the potatoes on top, and bake 20 mins.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, thyme, Worcestershire* A diced onion softened with the beef and garlic at the end. Thyme and a splash of Worcestershire into the meat before the potato goes on. This is the same seasoning as No. 063 because it is the same dish, done properly.

372 kcal · 27g protein · 30g carbs · 16g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 224 · 4 SERVINGS · 40 MINS · MEDIUM · 73

Crispy Chicken Strips with Honey Mustard Dip

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breasts (cut into strips)
- 1 cup flour, for the dredge
- 2 eggs
- 4 tbsp oil
- 2 tbsp honey
- 2 tbsp mustard
- 2 lbs potatoes

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 425°F. Cut the potatoes into wedges, toss with 1 tbsp of the oil and a little salt, and bake 30 to 35 mins, turning once, until browned and tender.
2. Pat the strips dry, dip them in beaten egg, and coat in flour. Heat the remaining 3 tbsp oil in a skillet and pan-fry the strips 4 mins per side, not moving them until the underside is brown. Check one at the thickest point: 165°F, no pink.
3. Mix honey & mustard for dip.

605 kcal · 47g protein · 57g carbs · 21g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 303 · 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR 10 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 57

Slow Rice Pudding with Raisins

Stirred, Not Hurried

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup rice
- 4 cups milk
- ⅓ cup sugar
- ½ cup raisins
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- salt

METHOD

1. Simmer the rice in 2 cups of water with a pinch of salt until the water is gone, about 15 minutes.
2. Add the milk and sugar and bring it back to the barest simmer.
3. Cook uncovered 35 to 40 minutes, stirring often and scraping the bottom. This is the whole recipe — stirring is what makes it creamy, and leaving it will catch and scorch.
4. Stir in the raisins for the last 10 minutes so they plump without dissolving.
5. Beat the eggs in a small bowl. Add a ladle of the hot pudding to them slowly, whisking, to warm them through.
6. Take the pan off the heat and stir the egg mixture back in. Off the heat, or it will scramble.
7. Stir in the vanilla and cinnamon.
8. Let it stand 10 minutes to thicken. Good warm, better cold the next day.

BETTER WITH *Nutmeg, lemon zest*

Nutmeg in with the milk, and a strip of lemon zest left in while it cooks and lifted out at the end.

301 kcal · 10g protein · 54g carbs · 5g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 302 6 SERVINGS · 3 HRS · IN-DEPTH 57

Baked Vanilla Custard

Silky, Set, Just Wobbling

INGREDIENTS

- 4 eggs
- 2.5 cups milk
- ½ cup sugar
- 2 tsp vanilla
- salt
- 1 tsp cinnamon

METHOD

1. Heat the milk until it steams and shows a few bubbles at the edge. Do not let it boil.
2. Whisk the eggs, sugar, vanilla and a pinch of salt together until smooth but not frothy — froth turns into bubbles in the finished custard. The vanilla goes in here rather than into the hot milk, where most of it would boil off.
3. Pour the hot milk into the eggs in a thin stream, whisking the whole time. Adding it all at once will scramble them.
4. Pour the mixture through a sieve into a jug. This catches anything that did set and is the difference between silky and grainy.
5. Divide between six dishes and dust the tops with cinnamon.
6. Stand the dishes in a roasting tin and pour hot water around them to come halfway up. The water bath keeps the heat gentle and even.
7. Bake at 325°F for 35 to 40 minutes. They are done when set at the edge and still wobbling slightly in the centre — they firm up as they cool.
8. Lift them out of the water and chill at least 2 hours before serving.

BETTER WITH *Nutmeg* Nutmeg grated over the top before it bakes. A baked custard without nutmeg is missing the thing that makes it taste like one.

165 kcal · 8g protein · 22g carbs · 5g fat All pantry staples

NO. 225 6 SERVINGS · 30 MINS · MEDIUM 59

Cheeseburger Pasta Bake

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 16 oz macaroni
- ¼ cup ketchup
- 1 can (28 oz) diced tomatoes
- 1.5 cups cheddar

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F. Boil the macaroni two minutes short of the packet time — it finishes in the oven.
2. Brown the beef and drain the fat, then mix with the ketchup, tomatoes, pasta and 1 cup of the cheese in a 9x13-inch dish. Top with the rest of the cheese.
3. Bake at 350°F for 20 mins.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, mustard, Worcestershire, Parmesan* A diced onion with the beef, garlic at the end. A teaspoon of mustard and a splash of Worcestershire with the ketchup. That combination is what makes a cheeseburger taste of a cheeseburger. A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

638 kcal · 41g protein · 69g carbs · 22g fat All pantry staples

NO. 226 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR 15 MINS · IN-DEPTH 49

Smothered Pork Roast with Cream Gravy

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork roast
- 2 cans (10.5 oz) cream of mushroom soup
- 2 cups instant potatoes 362

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F.
2. Place the pork roast in a 9x13-inch baking dish, cover with mushroom soup. The soup is the gravy here, and Recipe 356 is a better one — make it pale, with the juices from the tin once the roast is out. Recipe 361 works too if you want it thicker.
3. Bake at 375°F for 50 to 70 mins, until the thickest part of the roast reads 145°F, then rest it 3 minutes before slicing. Serve over instant mashed potatoes. Out of instant potato flakes? Recipe 362 makes mashed potatoes from the potatoes on the order.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, thyme, black pepper, A bottle of vinegar* A sliced onion under the roast and two cloves of garlic in the soup. Thyme and black pepper over the meat before it goes in. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself.

505 kcal · 29g protein · 23g carbs · 33g fat All pantry staples

NO. 301 8 SERVINGS · 1 HR · IN-DEPTH 52

Peach Cobbler with a Biscuit Top

Bubbling at the Edges

INGREDIENTS

- 1 can (29 oz) peaches (drained)
- ½ cup sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tbsp white flour
- 1.5 cups white flour
- 2 tsp baking powder
- 3 tbsp sugar
- 6 tbsp cold butter
- ¾ cup milk

METHOD

1. Toss the drained peaches with the sugar, cinnamon and the tablespoon of flour, along with a few spoonfuls of their syrup.
2. Tip into an 8-inch square baking dish and put it in the oven at 400°F for 10 minutes, until the fruit is hot and beginning to bubble. Putting the topping on hot fruit is what cooks its underside.
3. Meanwhile rub the cold butter into the flour, baking powder and sugar until crumbly.
4. Stir in the milk to make a thick, shaggy batter — lumpy is right.
5. Drop it in rough spoonfuls over the hot fruit, leaving gaps for the juice to come through.
6. Scatter a little more sugar over the top for crunch.
7. Bake 35 minutes more, until the topping is golden and firm in the middle and the juices bubble thickly at the edges.
8. Let it stand 15 minutes before serving, or the juice will be thin.

BETTER WITH *Nutmeg, lemon* A scrape of nutmeg with the cinnamon, and a squeeze of lemon over the peaches. Canned fruit is sweet and flat, and lemon is what wakes it up.

281 kcal · 4g protein · 46g carbs · 9g fat All pantry staples

NO. 300 · 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR 45 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 62

Chicken Pot Pie with a Scratch Crust

The Real Thing, Not the Shortcut

INGREDIENTS

- 1.25 cups white flour
- ½ tsp salt
- ½ cup cold butter
- 3 tbsp cold water
- 1.5 lbs chicken breast
- 1 tbsp butter
- 1 onion
- 3 carrots
- 1 can (14.5 oz) green beans
- ½ cup white flour
- 3 cups milk
- black pepper

METHOD

1. Rub the cold butter into the flour and salt, leaving some pieces the size of peas — those are what make the crust flaky.
2. Sprinkle over the cold water and gather into a dough without kneading. Wrap and rest it in the fridge 30 minutes.
3. Simmer the chicken in salted water about 15 minutes, until it is no longer pink in the middle, then lift out and cut into pieces. Keep a cup of the cooking liquid.
4. Cook the diced onion and carrot in the tablespoon of butter 8 minutes until soft.
5. Stir in the flour and cook 1 minute, then add the milk slowly, stirring, and the reserved cup of chicken liquid.
6. Simmer until it thickens enough to hold its shape on a spoon. Season well.
7. Fold in the chicken and the drained green beans and tip it all into a deep dish. Let it cool a little — a hot filling melts the crust before it can set.
8. Roll the pastry to fit, lay it over, press the edges down and cut two slits in the middle for steam.
9. Bake at 400°F for 35 to 40 minutes until the crust is deep gold and the filling bubbles at the slits.

503 kcal · 34g protein · 40g carbs · 23g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 227 · 6 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · MEDIUM · 63

Taco Pasta Skillet

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef
- 16 oz macaroni
- 1 cup salsa
- 1 can (15 oz) black beans, drained
- 1 cup cheddar
- 2 tbsp taco seasoning (optional) 310

METHOD

1. Boil macaroni 8 mins; drain.
2. Brown the beef in a skillet and drain the fat, then add the salsa, black beans and 2 tbsp taco seasoning and give it a minute to come together. No packet in the house? Recipe 310 makes taco seasoning from seven pantry spices.
3. Stir in macaroni and cheddar until melted.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, Parmesan* Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last minute of cooking — any longer and it burns bitter. A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

531 kcal · 32g protein · 67g carbs · 15g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 228 · 6 SERVINGS · 6 HRS · IN-DEPTH · 74

Slow-Cooker Chicken & Rice Soup

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breast
- 1 cup rice
- 2 cups chopped carrots
- 1 onion
- 7 cups water
- 2 tsp salt

METHOD

1. Put the chicken, carrots, onions, salt and water in the slow cooker, but keep the rice back: six hours turns it to a solid block.
2. Cook on LOW 6 hours. Lift the chicken out and shred it, turn the cooker to HIGH, stir in the rice and cook 30 to 45 minutes until tender, then return the chicken.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, A bottle of vinegar* Two cloves of garlic, chopped fine, in after the onion and before the liquid. Thirty seconds is enough; it only needs to smell. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself.

259 kcal · 28g protein · 30g carbs · 3g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 299 · 6 SERVINGS · 3 HRS 15 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 63

Braised Beef with Onion Gravy

Falls Apart Under a Fork

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs stewing beef
- 2 onions
- 2 tbsp vegetable oil
- 3 tbsp white flour
- 3 cups water
- 2 lbs potatoes
- ¼ cup butter
- ½ cup milk
- salt
- black pepper

METHOD

1. Pat the beef dry and salt it well. Dry meat browns; wet meat steams.
2. Heat the oil until it shimmers and brown the beef hard on all sides, in two or three batches so the pan stays hot. Set it aside.
3. Turn the heat down, add the sliced onions, and cook them 12 to 15 minutes until deep golden and sweet, scraping up the brown bits as they release.
4. Sprinkle over the flour and cook 1 minute more.
5. Pour in the water a little at a time, stirring, until you have a smooth gravy.
6. Return the beef and any juices. Cover and cook at the barest simmer for 2½ hours, until a piece falls apart under a fork. It cannot be rushed — high heat makes it tough, not tender.
7. Boil the potatoes 20 minutes, then mash with the butter and warmed milk. Or roast them instead: cut small, oil, salt, 425°F for thirty minutes, turned once. Boiled potatoes are wet; roasted ones have corners.
8. Taste the gravy and season. Spoon the beef and plenty of gravy over the mash.

BETTER WITH *Soy sauce* A tablespoon of soy sauce in with the liquid. Nobody tastes soy; they taste more beef.

583 kcal · 33g protein · 34g carbs · 35g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 298 6 SERVINGS · 50 MINS · IN-DEPTH 21

Scratch Biscuits & Sausage Gravy

Sunday Breakfast, The Long Way

INGREDIENTS

- 3 cups white flour
- 4 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ cup cold butter
- 1.25 cups milk
- 1 lb pork sausage
- ¼ cup white flour
- 3 cups milk
- black pepper

METHOD

1. Rub the cold butter into the flour, baking powder and salt until it looks like coarse crumbs with some pea-sized pieces left. Cold butter is what makes the layers.
2. Stir in the milk just until it holds together. Handle it as little as you can.
3. Pat the dough out, fold it over on itself three times, then pat to about an inch thick and cut out 12 rounds. Press the cutter straight down — twisting seals the edge and stops the rise.
4. Bake at 450°F for 12 to 14 minutes until risen and browned.
5. Meanwhile, brown the sausage in a wide pan, breaking it up. Leave the fat in the pan.
6. Sprinkle the flour over the sausage and cook it 2 minutes, stirring. This is the step people skip, and it is why gravy tastes of raw flour.
7. Pour in the milk a splash at a time, stirring smooth after each addition.
8. Simmer gently 5 to 8 minutes until it coats a spoon. Season well with black pepper — it needs more than you think.
9. Split the hot biscuits and ladle the gravy over.

714 kcal · 22g protein · 62g carbs · 42g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 229 4 SERVINGS · 25 MINS · EASY 57

Cheesy Black Bean & Rice Bake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cans (15 oz) black beans, drained and rinsed
- 2 cups cooked rice
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- ½ cup sour cream
- 1 cup cheddar

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F.
2. Mix black beans, rice, tomato sauce, and sour cream in an 8-inch square baking dish.
3. Top with cheddar and bake for 20 mins.

BETTER WITH *Cumin, chili powder, garlic, lime, Parmesan* Cumin and chili powder into the beans and rice. Garlic in the tomato sauce, lime over the top. A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

416 kcal · 18g protein · 50g carbs · 16g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 230

4 SERVINGS · 40 MINS · MEDIUM

64

Pan-Seared Beef Roast Slices with Roasted Carrots

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb beef roast (sliced thin)
- 1.5 lbs carrots
- 1.5 lbs potatoes
- 2 tbsp oil
- 2 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 425°F. Cube the potatoes and carrots, toss with the oil and a little salt, spread on a sheet pan, and roast 30 to 35 mins, turning once, until browned and tender.
2. Slice the beef thin across the grain and sear in the butter over high heat 1 to 2 mins per side. Serve together.

BETTER WITH *Garlic, rosemary, thyme*

Rub the sliced roast with garlic, rosemary and thyme before searing. Toss the carrots and potatoes in the same before they roast — the herbs are doing more work on the vegetables than on the beef.

599 kcal · 25g protein · 46g carbs · 35g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 297

12 ROLLS · 2 HRS 45 MINS · IN-DEPTH

52

Cinnamon Rolls with Vanilla Glaze

Saturday Morning, Properly

INGREDIENTS

- 4 cups white flour
- 1 cup warm milk
- 1 packet (¼ oz) yeast
- ½ cup sugar
- 1 egg
- ½ cup butter
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 2 tbsp cinnamon
- 1 cup powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla

METHOD

1. Warm the milk, stir in the yeast and a spoonful of the sugar, and leave 10 minutes until foamy.
2. Mix the flour, salt and half the sugar. Add the yeast milk, the egg, and half the butter, softened. Knead 8 minutes to a soft, smooth dough.
3. Cover and rise 1 hour until doubled.
4. Roll the dough into a rectangle about 12 by 16 inches, keeping the corners square so the rolls come out even.
5. Spread the remaining softened butter right to the edges, then scatter over the brown sugar, the rest of the sugar, and the cinnamon.
6. Roll it up from the long side, snug but not tight. Cut into 12 with a length of thread slid underneath and crossed over — a knife squashes them.
7. Set cut side up in a buttered dish, cover, and rise 40 minutes until they touch.
8. Bake at 350°F for 25 to 28 minutes until the middles are cooked through.
9. Stir the powdered sugar with the vanilla and a spoonful of milk into a pourable glaze, and pour it over while the rolls are still warm.

349 kcal · 6g protein · 61g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 296 15 ROLLS · 2 HRS 15 MINS · IN-DEPTH 56

Soft Buttered Dinner Rolls

Pull-Apart Soft

INGREDIENTS

- 4 cups white flour
- 1.25 cups warm milk
- 1 packet (¼ oz) yeast
- ¼ cup sugar
- 1 egg
- ¼ cup butter
- 1.5 tsp salt

METHOD

1. Warm the milk until it is just body temperature. Stir in the yeast and a spoonful of the sugar, and leave 10 minutes until foamy.
2. Beat the egg with the rest of the sugar and the softened butter.
3. Combine the flour and salt, then add both the yeast milk and the egg mixture. Mix to a soft dough.
4. Knead 8 minutes until smooth. This dough stays softer and tackier than bread dough — resist adding much more flour.
5. Cover and rise 1 hour until doubled.
6. Divide into 15 pieces. Roll each into a ball under a cupped hand and set them just touching in a buttered dish.
7. Cover and rise 35 minutes, until they are puffed and pressing against each other.
8. Bake at 375°F for 15 to 18 minutes until golden. Brush the tops with butter the moment they come out.

176 kcal · 5g protein · 30g carbs · 4g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 231 8 SERVINGS · 1 HR 30 MINS · EASY 64

Traditional Meatloaf with Brown Sugar Glaze

Glazed Twice, Sliced Thick

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs ground beef
- 3 slices bread 295
- ½ cup milk
- 2 eggs
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- ¾ tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 1 cup ketchup
- 2 tbsp mustard
- 3 tbsp brown sugar

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F and line a rimmed baking sheet with foil.
2. Tear the bread into small pieces in a large bowl, pour the milk over and leave it 5 minutes. Mash it to a paste with a fork. This is what keeps the loaf moist.
3. Beat in the eggs, then the onion, garlic, thyme, salt and pepper, ¼ cup of the ketchup and 1 tablespoon of the mustard. The ketchup and mustard in the meat are the savoury, sour note a bottle of Worcestershire would bring.
4. Add the ground beef and work it in with your hands just until nothing is streaky. Squeezing it longer makes the loaf tough.
5. Shape it into a loaf about 9 by 5 inches on the baking sheet. Free-standing rather than in a pan, so the sides brown and the fat runs away from it.
6. Stir the rest of the ketchup, the brown sugar and the rest of the mustard together, and spread half of it over the top. The mustard is the vinegar here; without it the glaze tastes only sweet.
7. Bake 45 minutes. Spread on the rest of the glaze and bake 15 to 25 minutes more, until the middle reads 160°F.
8. Let it rest 10 minutes before slicing into 8. Cut straight from the oven, it crumbles.

BETTER WITH *Worcestershire and vinegar* In the meat, 2 tablespoons of Worcestershire in place of the mustard, and the salt cut to ½ teaspoon; Worcestershire is salty. In the glaze, a tablespoon of cider vinegar in place of the mustard. Sharper, and the way a diner makes it.

301 kcal · 26g protein · 20g carbs · 13g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 232 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR 30 MINS · EASY 58

Baked Porcupine Meatballs

The Rice Cooks in the Sauce

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- ½ cup uncooked white rice
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 1 egg
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper
- 2 cans (14.4 oz) tomato soup
- 1 cup water

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F.
2. Mix the ground beef, the uncooked rice, the onion, egg, salt and pepper with your hands until just combined.
3. Roll into 18 balls the size of a golf ball and set them in a 9x13 dish, a little apart.
4. Whisk the tomato soup with the water and pour it over and around the meatballs.
5. Cover tightly with foil and bake 1 hour. The rice cooks in the sauce and pokes out of the meat as it swells, which is the name.
6. Uncover and bake 15 minutes more, until the rice is tender and the middle of a meatball reads 160°F.

366 kcal · 27g protein · 33g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 295 24 SLICES · 2 HRS 30 MINS · IN-DEPTH 56

Everyday White Bread

Two Loaves, One Afternoon

INGREDIENTS

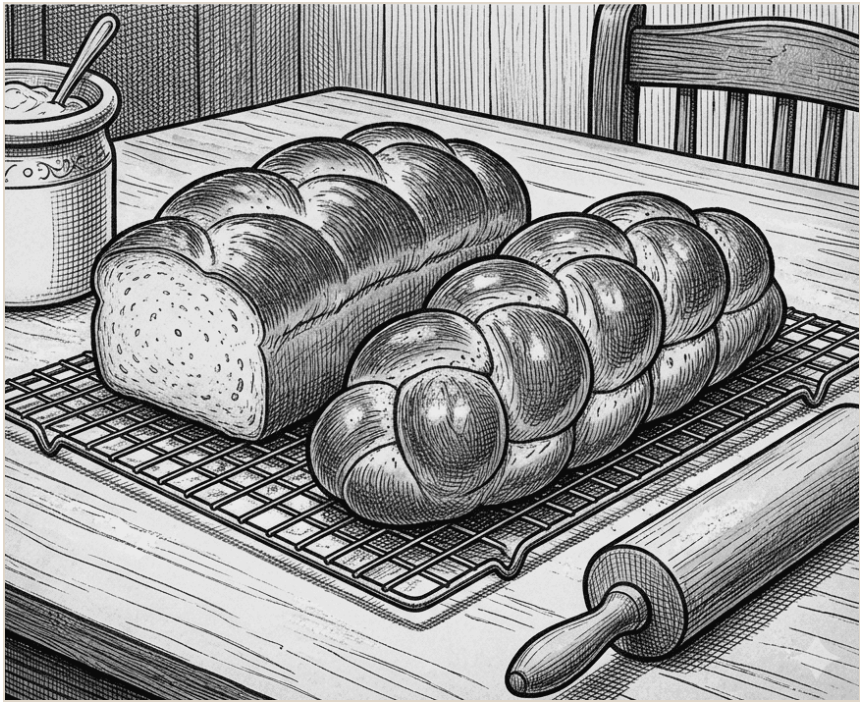
- 5 cups white flour
- 1.75 cups warm water
- 1 packet (¼ oz) yeast
- 2 tbsp sugar
- 3 tbsp non-fat dry milk
- 2 tsp salt
- 3 tbsp melted butter

METHOD

1. Stir the yeast and sugar into the warm water — warm as a bath, not hot, or it will kill the yeast. Leave it 10 minutes until it foams. If nothing happens, the yeast is dead and it is worth starting again.
2. Whisk the flour, dry milk and salt together in a large bowl.
3. Pour in the yeast water and the melted butter. Stir until it comes together into a shaggy, untidy dough.
4. Turn it onto a floured counter and knead 8 to 10 minutes, adding only enough flour to stop it sticking. It is ready when it is smooth and springs back when you press it.
5. Put it in a buttered bowl, cover with a cloth, and leave somewhere warm about an hour, until doubled.
6. Press it down, divide in two, and shape each half into a loaf. Set in buttered pans, cover, and rise again 40 minutes until domed above the rim.
7. Bake at 375°F for 30 to 35 minutes. It is done when the top is deep gold and the bottom sounds hollow when tapped.
8. Turn out onto a rack and let it cool before slicing. Cutting it hot tears the crumb.

114 kcal · 3g protein · 21g carbs · 2g fat

All pantry staples



SECTION 6

Worth the Afternoon

Nothing quick here. Bread that rises, gravy that thickens, custard that sets.

12 RECIPES

NO. 233

6 SERVINGS · 35 MINS · EASY

American Goulash

One Pot, Macaroni and All

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 1 onion, chopped
- 1 bell pepper, chopped
- 1 can (28 oz) diced tomatoes
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 2 cups water
- ½ tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 2 cups macaroni
- 1 cup cheddar cheese

METHOD

1. Brown the ground beef with the onion and bell pepper in a large pot over medium-high, breaking it up, 8 to 10 minutes, until no pink remains. Drain off the fat.
2. Stir in the diced tomatoes, tomato sauce, water, salt and pepper, and bring it to a boil.
3. Stir in the uncooked macaroni. Cover, turn the heat to low and simmer 15 to 18 minutes, stirring every few minutes so it does not catch, until the pasta is tender.
4. Take it off the heat, scatter the cheddar over the top, cover and leave it 2 minutes to melt.

479 kcal · 35g protein · 42g carbs · 19g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 234 4 SERVINGS · 20 MINS · EASY 57

Hamburger Gravy over Mashed Potatoes

Supper on Twenty Minutes

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 onion, chopped
- 3 tbsp flour
- 2 cups milk, for the gravy
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 1.5 cups water
- 2 tbsp butter
- ½ cup milk, for the potatoes
- 2 cups instant potatoes [362]

METHOD

1. Brown the ground beef and onion in a large skillet over medium-high, breaking it up, 8 to 10 minutes, until no pink remains. Spoon off all but about 2 tablespoons of the fat.
2. Sprinkle the flour over the beef and stir 1 minute, so the gravy does not taste of raw flour.
3. Pour in the 2 cups of milk a little at a time, stirring, and simmer 3 to 5 minutes until it is thick enough to coat a spoon. Season with the salt and pepper. It thickens more as it stands, so loosen it with a splash of water if it goes too far.
4. For the potatoes, bring the water and butter to a boil, take it off the heat, add the ½ cup of milk and stir in the instant potatoes. Let them stand 1 minute, then fluff with a fork.
5. Spoon the potatoes onto plates and ladle the gravy over.

464 kcal · 30g protein · 41g carbs · 20g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 294 48 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · MEDIUM 46

Mandie's Sour Cream Sugar Cookies

Frosted Pink

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup butter
- 2 cups sugar
- 2 eggs
- 2 cups sour cream
- 2 tsp vanilla
- 2 tsp baking soda
- 1 tsp salt
- 6½ cups white flour
- ½ cup butter
- 4 cups powdered sugar
- ¼ cup milk
- 1 tsp vanilla

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F.
2. Cream the 1 cup of butter with the sugar until light. Beat in the eggs and 2 teaspoons of the vanilla.
3. Beat in the sour cream, the soda and the salt. The batter will look loose at this stage, and it is meant to.
4. Work in 4 cups of the flour, then the last 2½ cups a cup at a time, until the dough is soft and just holds together. It stays softer than a dough you would roll.
5. Drop rounded spoonfuls onto trays, well apart. They spread.
6. Bake 8 to 10 minutes. They are done when the tops are set and dry to a light touch and the edges have barely coloured. Browned, they are overbaked.
7. Cool them a minute on the tray, then move them to a rack to cool through. Frosting a warm one slides it off.
8. Beat the ½ cup of butter with the powdered sugar, the milk and the last teaspoon of vanilla until smooth and light. Frost the cookies cold. A drop of food colouring stirred into the frosting is what makes them pink.

208 kcal · 2g protein · 32g carbs · 8g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 293

4 SERVINGS · 12 MINS · EASY

58

Cinnamon Sugar Apple Fritter Bites

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 cups pancake mix [360]
- ½ cup milk
- 1 diced apple
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 2 tbsp sugar

METHOD

1. Whisk pancake mix, milk, and diced apple.
2. Pan-fry spoon-sized fritters in buttered skillet 2 mins per side.
3. Toss immediately in cinnamon sugar.

VARIATION Two tablespoons of sour cream or Greek yogurt in the batter make the fritters lighter and more tender.

243 kcal · 5g protein · 49g carbs · 3g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 235

6 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · MEDIUM

45

Swedish Meatballs over Egg Noodles

Creamy, and Ready by Six

INGREDIENTS

- 2 slices bread [295]
- ½ cup milk
- 1 egg
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 1 tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper
- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 2 tbsp oil
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of mushroom soup
- ¾ cup water
- ½ cup sour cream
- 12 oz egg noodles

METHOD

1. Tear the bread into a large bowl, pour the milk over and leave it 5 minutes, then mash it to a paste.
2. Beat in the egg, onion, salt and pepper, then work in the ground beef with your hands just until combined.
3. Roll into about 30 one-inch meatballs.
4. Heat the oil in a large skillet over medium and brown the meatballs in batches, turning, 8 to 10 minutes a batch. They do not have to be cooked through yet.
5. Pour off the fat, return all the meatballs, and stir in the cream of mushroom soup and the water. Cover and simmer 10 minutes, until the middle of a meatball reads 160°F.
6. Meanwhile boil the egg noodles in salted water 6 to 8 minutes, until tender, and drain.
7. Take the skillet off the heat and stir in the sour cream. Do not let it boil again after this, or the sauce splits. Spoon it over the noodles.

582 kcal · 35g protein · 52g carbs · 26g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 236 6 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · EASY 62

Spanish Rice with Ground Beef

The Rice Cooks in the Pan

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 onion, chopped
- 1 bell pepper, chopped
- 1 cup uncooked white rice
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- ½ can (28 oz) diced tomatoes
- ¾ cup water
- ½ cup salsa
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper
- ½ cup cheddar cheese

METHOD

1. Brown the ground beef with the onion and bell pepper in a large, deep skillet over medium-high, 8 to 10 minutes, until no pink remains. Drain off the fat.
2. Stir in the uncooked rice and cook 2 minutes, stirring, so every grain is coated.
3. Add the tomato sauce, half the can of diced tomatoes (the storehouse tin is 28 ounces; the rest keeps a week in the fridge), the water, salsa, salt and pepper, and bring it to a boil.
4. Cover, turn the heat to low and simmer 20 to 25 minutes, until the rice is tender and the liquid is gone. Leave the lid on for the first 15 minutes; the steam is what cooks the rice.
5. Rest it covered 5 minutes off the heat, fluff it, and scatter the cheddar on top.

335 kcal · 22g protein · 37g carbs · 11g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 292 12 BOWLS · 45 MINS · MEDIUM 45

Hot Fudge Cake Bowls

INGREDIENTS

- 1 box (15.25 oz) chocolate cake mix
- 3 eggs
- ½ cup vegetable oil
- 1 cup water
- 1 pkg (3.4 oz) instant chocolate pudding mix
- 2 cups hot water

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F. Butter a 9x13 dish.
2. Make the cake batter the way the box asks — usually the mix with 3 eggs, ½ cup oil and 1 cup water, beaten smooth. Check your box; they vary. Spread it in the dish.
3. Sprinkle the dry pudding mix evenly over the batter. Straight from the packet, not made up — it is the sauce, and it needs to be dry going in.
4. Pour the 2 cups of hot water gently over the whole thing, over the back of a spoon so it does not dig channels. It will look wrong — batter under an inch of water. That is right. Do not stir it.
5. Bake 30 to 35 minutes. The water and pudding sink while the cake rises through them, so it comes out cake on top with hot fudge underneath.
6. Done is a top that looks like cake and springs back at the edges, with the middle still visibly loose. A skewer will not come out clean, and is not supposed to.
7. Let it stand 10 minutes, then spoon into bowls, digging down so each one gets sauce from the bottom. This is why it is bowls and not slices.

BETTER WITH *Instant coffee, flaky salt, vanilla ice cream* A teaspoon of instant coffee dissolved into the hot water before it goes over. It does not taste of coffee; it makes the chocolate taste more like chocolate. A pinch of flaky salt over each bowl, and ice cream while it is still hot.

282 kcal · 3g protein · 36g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 290 9 SQUARES · 40 MINS · EASY 62

Peanut Butter Fudge Squares

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup peanut butter
- ½ cup powdered sugar
- ¼ cup melted butter
- pinch salt
- ½ tsp vanilla

METHOD

1. Stir the melted butter, peanut butter, powdered sugar, salt and vanilla together in a bowl until smooth.
2. Press into a parchment-lined 8-inch square pan and freeze 30 mins before cutting into squares. Keep them in the fridge or freezer; they soften at room temperature.

247 kcal · 7g protein · 12g carbs · 19g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 291 6 SERVINGS · 10 MINS · EASY 45

Yellow Cake Berry Shortcake

INGREDIENTS

- ½ yellow cake (sliced) [273]
- ½ cup strawberry jam
- 1 cup fresh grapes/fruit

METHOD

1. Slice yellow cake horizontally. The cake is half of Recipe 273, baked and left unfrosted.
2. Spread strawberry jam and fresh sliced fruit between layers.

381 kcal · 3g protein · 63g carbs · 13g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 237 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR · MEDIUM 52

Chicken & Dumplings

Lid On, No Peeking

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs chicken breasts
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 carrots, sliced
- 6 cups water
- ½ tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of chicken soup [361]
- 2 cups flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- ½ tsp salt, for the dumplings
- 1 cup milk
- 3 tbsp butter, melted

METHOD

1. Put the whole chicken breasts, the onion, carrots, water, ½ teaspoon of salt and the pepper in a large pot. Bring to a boil, then cover and simmer 20 to 25 minutes, until the thickest part of the chicken reads 165°F.
2. Lift out the chicken, shred it with two forks, and whisk the cream of chicken soup into the pot. Return the chicken and keep it at a gentle simmer.
3. For the dumplings, whisk the flour, baking powder and the ½ teaspoon of salt in a bowl. Stir in the milk and the melted butter just until there is no dry flour. A lumpy dough makes lighter dumplings.
4. Drop the dough by heaping spoonfuls onto the simmering stew, close together.
5. Cover tightly and cook 15 minutes without lifting the lid. They steam, and a peek lets the steam out.
6. They are done when a toothpick through the middle of one comes out clean. Taste the stew before salting it again; the soup and the baking powder have brought a good deal.

417 kcal · 33g protein · 42g carbs · 13g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 238 8 SERVINGS · 1 HR 45 MINS · MEDIUM

Tater Tot Casserole

Rows of Tots on Top

INGREDIENTS

- 3 lbs potatoes
- 3 tbsp flour
- ¾ tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 3 tbsp vegetable oil
- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 1 onion, chopped
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of mushroom soup
- 1 can (14.5 oz) green beans
- ½ cup milk
- 1 cup cheddar cheese

METHOD

1. Peel the potatoes and boil them whole 8 to 10 minutes, until a knife goes in a quarter inch and the middle is still hard. Drain them and let them cool completely, at least 30 minutes. Grated warm, they turn to paste; boiled the day before and kept in the fridge is better still.
2. Heat the oven to 425°F. Grate the potatoes on the large holes of a box grater and toss with the flour, the salt and ¼ teaspoon of the pepper.
3. Brush a baking sheet with half the oil. Squeeze tablespoons of the potato into little logs, about 60 tater tots, set them on the sheet and brush them with the rest of the oil. Bake 20 minutes, turning once, until golden. They finish on the casserole.
4. While they bake, brown the ground beef and onion in a large skillet over medium-high, 8 to 10 minutes, until no pink remains. Drain off the fat.
5. Stir in the cream of mushroom soup, the drained green beans, the milk and the rest of the pepper, and spread it in a 9x13 dish. No more salt: the soup and the cheese carry plenty.
6. Scatter the cheddar over, then stand the tots on top in close rows, one layer. Turn the oven down to 375°F.
7. Bake 25 to 30 minutes, until the tots are deep gold and crisp and the sauce bubbles at the edges.
8. Tots made ahead and frozen (Recipe 365) save the first hour: bake them from frozen at 425°F for 25 minutes, then carry on from the beef.

445 kcal · 26g protein · 38g carbs · 21g fat All pantry staples

NO. 288 4 POPS · 10 MINS · EASY

Chocolate Covered Banana Pops

INGREDIENTS

- 2 bananas (halved)
- ¼ cup cocoa powder
- ¼ cup butter
- ¼ cup sugar
- 2 tbsp milk
- 4 wooden sticks

METHOD

1. Insert sticks into banana halves.
2. Melt the butter in a small pan over low heat, then whisk in the sugar, the cocoa and the milk until it is glossy and pours off the spoon in a ribbon. Cocoa is a dry powder — without the milk it seizes into a paste you cannot dip anything in.
3. Dip bananas and freeze on foil 1 hour.

241 kcal · 2g protein · 29g carbs · 13g fat All pantry staples

NO. 289 4 CUPS · 2 HRS 20 MINS · EASY

Strawberry Gelatin Whip Cups

INGREDIENTS

- 1 pkg (3 oz) strawberry gelatin
- 1 cup boiling water
- 1 cup vanilla yogurt

METHOD

1. Dissolve gelatin in boiling water. Let cool 10 mins.
2. Whip in vanilla yogurt with hand mixer 2 mins.
3. Chill in cups 2 hours.

133 kcal · 4g protein · 27g carbs · 1g fat All pantry staples

NO. 287 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR 20 MINS · MEDIUM 58

Sweet Cinnamon Raisin Bread Pudding

INGREDIENTS

- 6 bread slices (cubed) 295
- 3 eggs
- 1.5 cups milk
- ⅓ cup sugar
- ¼ cup raisins
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 2 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Butter an 8-inch square baking dish and heat the oven to 350°F.
2. Use bread that has gone stale. If it is fresh, spread the cubes on a tray and dry them in the oven for 10 minutes — soft bread turns to paste, dry bread drinks the custard and keeps its shape.
3. Scatter the bread cubes and the raisins in the dish.
4. Whisk the eggs, milk, sugar, cinnamon, vanilla and a pinch of salt together until no streaks of white are left.
5. Pour it over the bread and press the cubes down with the back of a spoon until every one of them is wet.
6. Leave it to soak 30 minutes, pressing it down again halfway. Baked straight away, the custard sets around the bread instead of inside it.
7. Dot the rest of the butter over the top.
8. Bake 35 to 40 minutes, until the edges are set and the middle still wobbles a little when you move the dish. It firms as it cools, and baked until the centre is solid it comes out dry.
9. Stand it 10 minutes before serving. Recipe 304 poured over the top makes it a pudding for company.

BETTER WITH *Nutmeg* A good grating of nutmeg into the custard with the cinnamon. It is the spice nobody can name in a bread pudding and everybody misses when it is gone.

236 kcal · 8g protein · 33g carbs · 8g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 239 6 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · EASY 55

Tuna Noodle Casserole

Buttered Crumbs on Top

INGREDIENTS

- 8 oz egg noodles
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of mushroom soup
- 1 cup milk
- 2 cans (5 oz) tuna
- 1 can (14.5 oz) green beans
- 1 cup cheddar cheese
- ¼ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper
- 2 slices bread 295
- 2 tbsp butter, melted

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F and butter a 2-quart or 8x8 dish.
2. Boil the egg noodles 2 minutes short of the packet time, about 6 minutes. They finish in the oven. Drain.
3. Whisk the cream of mushroom soup and the milk in a large bowl. Fold in the drained, flaked tuna, the drained green beans, half the cheddar, the salt and pepper, and the noodles.
4. Spread it in the dish and scatter the rest of the cheddar over.
5. Tear the bread into fine crumbs, toss them with the melted butter, and scatter them on top.
6. Bake 25 to 30 minutes, until it bubbles at the edges and the crumbs are golden.

396 kcal · 24g protein · 39g carbs · 16g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 240

6 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · EASY

69

Ham & White Bean Soup

Thickened with Its Own Beans

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tbsp butter
- 1 onion, chopped
- 2 carrots, diced
- 2 potatoes, diced
- 6 cups water
- 2 cans (15 oz) great northern beans
- 2 cups chopped ham
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ tsp salt

METHOD

1. Melt the butter in a large pot over medium and cook the onion and carrots 5 minutes, until the onion softens.
2. Add the potatoes, water, drained beans, ham and pepper. Bring to a boil, then lower the heat and simmer 25 to 30 minutes, until the potatoes are tender.
3. Mash about a cup of the beans against the side of the pot and stir them back in. That is what thickens it.
4. Taste before you add the salt. The ham brings a good deal of its own.

226 kcal · 15g protein · 28g carbs · 6g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 286

8 SLICES · 3 HRS 30 MINS · MEDIUM

49

Homemade Chocolate Pudding Pie

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 cups flour
- ½ cup butter
- 4 tbsp cold water
- salt
- 1 pkg (3.4 oz) instant chocolate pudding mix
- 1¾ cups milk

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F. Rub the cold butter into the flour and a pinch of salt until it looks like coarse crumbs, then stir in the cold water a tablespoon at a time until it just comes together. Rest it 15 minutes.
2. Roll it out, line a 9-inch pie dish, and prick the base all over with a fork. Pricking is what stops the base rising into a dome under the filling. Chill 15 minutes.
3. Line the crust with foil, fill it with dry beans or rice, and bake 15 minutes. Lift out the foil and beans and bake 8 to 10 minutes more, until dry and pale gold. Let it cool completely.
4. Whisk the pudding mix with the 1¾ cups of milk for two minutes until it thickens, pour it into the cooled crust, and chill 2 hours before cutting.

257 kcal · 4g protein · 31g carbs · 13g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 284

6 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · EASY

43

Vanilla Cream Fruit Trifle

INGREDIENTS

- ½ yellow cake (cubed) 273
- 1 pkg (3.4 oz) instant vanilla pudding mix
- 2 cups milk
- 1 can (29 oz) peaches (diced)

METHOD

1. Whisk vanilla pudding with cold milk.
2. Layer in glass bowl: yellow cake cubes, vanilla pudding, diced peaches. Chill 30 mins. The cake is half of Recipe 273, baked and left unfrosted.

439 kcal · 6g protein · 70g carbs · 15g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 285

4 WAFFLES · 10 MINS · EASY

42

Cinnamon Dessert Waffles

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups waffle mix 360
- 1 cup milk
- 1 egg
- 2 tbsp butter
- 2 tbsp cinnamon sugar
- syrup 363

METHOD

1. Cook waffles in waffle iron. Beat the waffle mix, milk and egg together first and let the batter stand a couple of minutes.
2. Brush with melted butter, sprinkle generously with cinnamon sugar, serve with syrup.

VARIATION A quarter cup of sour cream or Greek yogurt in place of a quarter cup of the milk: crisper edges, softer middle.

379 kcal · 9g protein · 61g carbs · 11g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 241

6 SERVINGS · 40 MINS · EASY

51

Cheesy Baked Potato Soup

Thick, with Pieces Left In

INGREDIENTS

- 3 lbs potatoes
- 4 tbsp butter
- 1 onion, chopped
- ⅓ cup flour
- 4 cups milk
- 2 cups water
- 1.5 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 1 cup cheddar cheese
- ½ cup sour cream

METHOD

1. Peel the potatoes and cut them into ½-inch dice.
2. Melt the butter in a large pot over medium and cook the onion 5 minutes, until soft.
3. Stir in the flour and cook 1 minute, then pour in the milk a little at a time, stirring, followed by the water.
4. Add the potatoes, salt and pepper and simmer gently 15 to 20 minutes, stirring now and then, until the potatoes are tender. A hard boil scorches the milk on the bottom of the pot.
5. Mash about half the potatoes in the pot, for a soup that is thick but still has pieces in it.
6. Take it off the heat and stir in the cheddar until it melts. Serve with a spoonful of sour cream on each bowl.

477 kcal · 16g protein · 56g carbs · 21g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 242

6 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · EASY

71

Chicken Noodle Soup from Scratch

The Water Becomes the Broth

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 onion, chopped
- 3 carrots, sliced
- 10 cups water
- 1.5 lbs chicken breasts
- 2 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 6 oz egg noodles

METHOD

1. Melt the butter in a large pot over medium and cook the onion and carrots 5 minutes, until the onion softens.
2. Add the water, the whole chicken breasts, the salt and pepper. Bring to a boil, then cover and simmer 20 to 25 minutes, until the thickest part of the chicken reads 165°F. The water becomes the broth.
3. Lift out the chicken and shred it with two forks.
4. Bring the soup back to a boil, add the egg noodles and cook 6 to 8 minutes, until tender.
5. Return the chicken, taste, and salt it again if it wants it. A light broth needs more than you expect.

292 kcal · 30g protein · 25g carbs · 8g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 282

24 CAKE POPS · 45 MINS · EASY

51

Chocolate Cake Pops

INGREDIENTS

- ½ baked chocolate cake
- 2 tbsp cocoa
- 2 tbsp milk
- lollipop sticks

METHOD

1. Crumble baked chocolate cake into a bowl.
2. Mix in the cocoa and the milk until it comes together into a fudgy dough that holds a shape when squeezed. Add the milk a teaspoon at a time — too much and it will not hold a stick.
3. Roll into 1¼-inch balls — about 24 — insert sticks, freeze 30 mins.

71 kcal · 1g protein · 10g carbs · 3g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 283

6 SERVINGS · 45 MINS · MEDIUM

63

Pear & Apple Crumble

INGREDIENTS

- 1 can (29 oz) pears, drained
- 3 fresh apples (sliced)
- 1 cup oats
- ½ cup flour
- ½ cup butter
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F.
2. Dice the drained pears and mix them with the apples and cinnamon in an 8-inch square dish.
3. Melt the butter and mix it with the oats, flour and brown sugar into a crumble. Scatter it over the fruit and bake at 350°F for 35 to 40 mins, until bubbling and the apples are tender.

377 kcal · 4g protein · 52g carbs · 17g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 281

12 COOKIES · 25 MINS · MEDIUM

53

PB & Jam Thumbprint Treats

INGREDIENTS

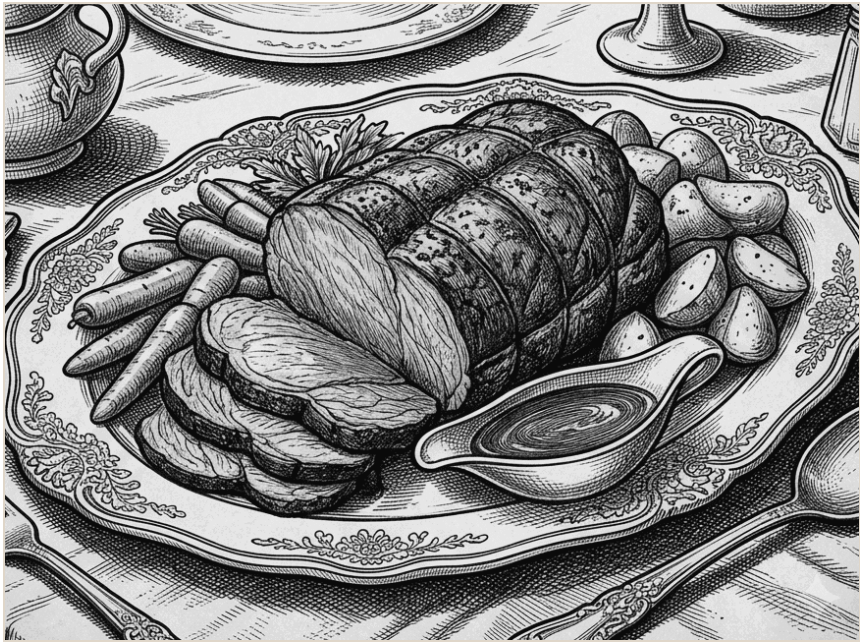
- 1.5 cups flour
- ½ cup peanut butter
- ½ cup butter (softened)
- ¾ cup sugar
- 1 egg
- ½ tsp baking powder
- salt
- ¼ cup strawberry jam

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F.
2. Beat the softened butter, peanut butter and sugar together until light, then beat in the egg.
3. Stir in the flour, baking powder and a pinch of salt until it comes together into a soft dough. Flour and fat alone will not — it needs the sugar and the egg to bind, which is the difference between a dough and a bowl of crumbs.
4. Roll into 12 balls, set them well apart on a parchment-lined sheet, and press a deep thumbprint into each.
5. Spoon jam into the hollows and bake 12 to 14 minutes, until the edges are set and just colouring. They firm up as they cool.

270 kcal · 5g protein · 31g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples



SECTION 4

Elaborate Sunday Feasts & Roasts

Sunday, when there is time to do it properly.

26 RECIPES

NO. 243 · 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 8 HRS · IN-DEPTH · 56

Slow-Cooker Sunday Pot Roast with Brown Gravy

INGREDIENTS

- 3.75 lb beef roast
- 1 tbsp Worcestershire sauce
- 2 lbs potatoes (quartered)
- 1 lb carrots
- 1 onion
- 1 pkg (0.87 oz) brown gravy mix
  356

METHOD

1. Sear beef roast in hot skillet 3 mins per side. Rub the roast with a tablespoon of Worcestershire before it goes in the pan. It is what gives the gravy its savoury depth, and searing it on is better than pouring it over later.
2. Place quartered potatoes, carrots, and onions in slow cooker, put roast on top.
3. Whisk gravy mix with 1 cup water and pour over roast. No packet? Pour a cup of plain water over instead, and make Recipe 356 at the end from the liquid in the cooker.
4. Cook LOW for 8 hours until tender.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, A bottle of vinegar* Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last thirty seconds before the liquid goes in — any longer and it burns bitter. A teaspoon of vinegar stirred in at the end, off the heat. It does not taste of vinegar; it tastes like the pot woke up.

876 kcal · 54g protein · 39g carbs · 56g fat

Also needs: Gravy mix

NO. 280 · 4 DUMPLINGS · 35 MINS · MEDIUM · 52

Apple Cinnamon Dumplings

INGREDIENTS

- 2 fresh apples (quartered)
- 1.5 cups flour
- ½ cup butter
- 4 tbsp cold water
- ¼ cup sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- salt

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F.
2. Rub the cold butter into the flour and a pinch of salt with your fingertips until it looks like coarse crumbs, then stir in the cold water a tablespoon at a time until it just holds together in a ball. Stop there — a pastry worked smooth goes tough.
3. Rest the dough 15 minutes, then roll it out and cut it into four squares.
4. Wrap each apple quarter in a square, pinching the seams shut, and sit them seam-down on a baking sheet. Mix the sugar with the cinnamon and scatter it over.
5. Bake 25 minutes, until the pastry is golden and a skewer slides into the apple without resistance.

484 kcal · 5g protein · 62g carbs · 24g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 278 · 6 SERVINGS · 25 MINS · MEDIUM · 54

Warm Banana Pudding Crisp

INGREDIENTS

- 3 ripe bananas (sliced)
- 1 pkg (3.4 oz) instant vanilla pudding mix
- 2 cups milk
- 1 cup oats
- ½ cup flour
- ½ cup butter
- ¼ cup sugar

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F.
2. Whisk the pudding mix with the 2 cups of cold milk for two minutes until it thickens, then layer it with the banana slices in an 8-inch square dish.
3. Melt the butter and mix it with the oats, flour and sugar into a crumble; spread on top.
4. Bake at 350°F for 20 mins.

414 kcal · 6g protein · 57g carbs · 18g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 279 · 2 MUGS · 4 MINS · EASY · 60

Hot Cocoa & Cinnamon Cups

INGREDIENTS

- 2 packets (1 oz) hot cocoa mix
- 1.5 cups milk
- ½ tsp cinnamon

METHOD

1. Heat milk in saucepan or microwave 2 mins.
2. Whisk in hot cocoa packets and cinnamon until frothy.

210 kcal · 8g protein · 31g carbs · 6g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 244 · 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 50 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 56

Roast Pork Loin with Sweet Applesauce & Ribbon Noodles

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork roast
- 1 jar (26.5 oz) applesauce
- 16 oz ribbon pasta
- 2 cans (14.5 oz) green beans
- 4 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F. Season pork roast and bake 50 mins until internal temp reaches 145°F.
2. Boil ribbon noodles 8 mins; toss with butter. Heat the green beans through in their own liquid while the noodles boil, then drain them.
3. Serve sliced pork over noodles with applesauce.

BETTER WITH *Garlic, rosemary, black pepper, A bottle of vinegar* Garlic and rosemary rubbed over the pork before it roasts. Black pepper into the applesauce — a sweet sauce against a savoury roast wants something to argue with. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself.

800 kcal · 37g protein · 82g carbs · 36g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 245 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 40 MINS · IN-DEPTH 59

Homemade Meatballs & Italian Spaghetti Feast

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 1 egg
- ½ cup breadcrumbs 358
- 16 oz spaghetti
- 1 jar (27.7 oz) spaghetti sauce
- 1 can (14.5 oz) green beans

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 400°F. Mix ground beef, egg, and breadcrumbs; roll into meatballs. Bake 20 mins. No breadcrumbs in the cupboard? Recipe 358 makes them from bread, which is on the order.
2. Simmer meatballs in spaghetti sauce for 10 mins.
3. Serve over cooked spaghetti. Heat the green beans through, drain them, and put them on the table alongside.

BETTER WITH *Parmesan, fresh garlic* A clove of minced garlic and a tablespoon of grated parmesan into the meatball mix, with the egg and crumbs. Both are in there before it cooks, which is where they do the most. Parmesan grated over each plate at the table, not into the pot. It stops tasting of anything after ten minutes in a sauce.

600 kcal · 37g protein · 77g carbs · 16g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 276 4 BOWLS · 25 MINS · EASY 59

Vanilla Pudding Fruit Bowls

INGREDIENTS

- 1 pkg (3.4 oz) instant vanilla pudding mix
- 2 cups milk
- 1 diced apple
- 1 sliced banana
- 1 cup grapes

METHOD

1. Whisk vanilla pudding mix with cold milk 2 mins.
2. Fold in fresh apple, banana, and grapes. Chill 15 mins.

239 kcal · 5g protein · 48g carbs · 3g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 277 4 SERVINGS · 12 MINS · EASY 47

Cinnamon Sugar Churro Bites

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups pancake mix 360
- ¾ cup milk
- ¼ cup sugar
- 1 tbsp cinnamon
- 2 tbsp oil

METHOD

1. Whisk the pancake mix with the milk into a batter thick enough to hold its shape on a spoon — thicker than pancake batter. Add the milk a little at a time; loosening it is easy and thickening it is not.
2. Drop spoon-sized balls into oiled skillet; fry 2 mins per side until golden.
3. Roll immediately in cinnamon sugar.

375 kcal · 7g protein · 62g carbs · 11g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 274 · 8 SQUARES · 1 HR 10 MINS · EASY · 68

No-Bake PB & Oat Squares

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups rolled oats
- ½ cup peanut butter
- ⅓ cup honey
- ¼ cup raisins
- pinch salt
- ½ tsp vanilla

METHOD

1. Warm peanut butter and honey in microwave 30 secs.
2. Stir in the oats, raisins, salt and vanilla. The salt and vanilla are the two things a box leaves out, and the two that make it taste like a kitchen.
3. Press firmly into a parchment-lined 8-inch square pan and chill in fridge 1 hour before cutting.

237 kcal · 7g protein · 32g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 275 · 6 SERVINGS · 4 HRS 10 MINS · EASY · 52

Strawberry Gelatin Fruit Mold

INGREDIENTS

- 1 pkg (3 oz) strawberry gelatin
- 2 cups boiling water
- 1 can (29 oz) peaches, drained

METHOD

1. Dissolve gelatin in boiling water.
2. Refrigerate about 1 hour, until it is as thick as unbeaten egg white. Dice the drained peaches and stir them in so they stay suspended.
3. Pour into dish and refrigerate 3 hours until set.

100 kcal · 1g protein · 24g carbs · 0g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 246 · 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 45 MINS · IN-DEPTH · 44

Creamy Chicken & Ribbon Pasta Alfredo Bake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs chicken breast
- 16 oz ribbon pasta
- 2 cans (12 oz) evaporated milk
- ½ cup butter
- ¼ cup flour
- 2½ cups cheddar
- ½ cup breadcrumbs 358
- salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F. Boil the pasta in well-salted water, but stop two minutes short of the packet time — it finishes in the oven. Save a mug of the water.
2. Salt and pepper the chicken and cook it in a wide skillet over medium-high, about 6 minutes a side. Done is 165°F, or white through with clear juices. Rest 5 minutes, then slice. Keep the skillet.
3. Melt the butter in the same skillet over medium-low. Whisk the flour in and cook it a full minute. It will look like wet sand, and that minute is what stops the sauce tasting of raw flour.
4. Add the evaporated milk a splash at a time, whisking smooth after each, until it thickens at a bare simmer.
5. Off the heat — boiled, cheese turns grainy and splits — stir in two cups of cheddar a handful at a time. Loosen with pasta water if it is thicker than pouring cream, then salt it well.
6. Fold the pasta and chicken through, tip into a buttered 9x13 dish, and scatter the last half cup of cheddar and the breadcrumbs over. No crumbs? Recipe 358 makes them, and an air fryer makes better ones than an oven.
7. Bake 20 minutes, until it bubbles at the edges and the top has colour. Stand 5 minutes before serving or the first spoonful runs.

BETTER WITH *Parmesan, fresh garlic, Italian seasoning* Soften 3 or 4 minced garlic cloves in the butter for a minute before the flour. Garlic in the fat tastes of the dish; garlic added late tastes of garlic. Swap half a cup of cheddar for grated parmesan, and keep half back for the top. Salt the sauce after it goes in — parmesan is saltier. A teaspoon of Italian seasoning with the cheese, and a pinch of nutmeg if you have it.

985 kcal · 65g protein · 80g carbs · 45g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 247 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 2 HRS 30 MINS · IN-DEPTH 50

Dutch Oven Beef Stew with Fluffy Drop Biscuits

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs stewing beef
- 2 lbs potatoes
- 1 lb carrots
- 1 onion
- 2 cups flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- ¾ cup milk
- 4 tbsp butter
- 1 tsp salt

METHOD

1. Brown the beef in the Dutch oven in batches, dark on every side. The stew tastes of that crust; skip it and it tastes of boiled beef. Return all the beef, add 3 cups of water, cover, and simmer gently 1 hour.
2. Add the potatoes, carrots and onion, cover again, and simmer 45 minutes more, until a cube of beef breaks apart under a fork. Heat the oven to 375°F.
3. Rub the cold butter into the flour, baking powder and the teaspoon of salt until it looks like coarse crumbs, then stir in the milk with a fork until it just holds together. Do not knead it — drop biscuits are light because the dough is barely mixed.
4. Drop the dough over the stew in rough spoonfuls, leaving gaps for the steam, and bake uncovered for 20 minutes. They are done when the tops are golden and one pulled open at the middle is dry rather than sticky.

VARIATION Sour cream for a quarter cup of the milk makes them softer and taller.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, A bottle of vinegar* Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last thirty seconds before the liquid goes in — any longer and it burns bitter. A teaspoon of vinegar stirred in at the end, off the heat. It does not taste of vinegar; it tastes like the pot woke up.

707 kcal · 38g protein · 69g carbs · 31g fat All pantry staples

NO. 273 8 SLICES · 50 MINS · MEDIUM 34

Golden Yellow Cake with Chocolate Frosting

INGREDIENTS

- 1 box (15.25 oz) yellow cake mix
- 3 eggs
- ½ cup vegetable oil
- 1 cup milk
- ½ cup butter (softened)
- ½ cup cocoa powder
- 2 cups powdered sugar
- ¼ cup milk
- vanilla
- salt

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F and butter a 9x13 dish.
2. Make the cake batter as the box asks, but with the milk in place of the water — it is a box mix either way and milk makes it taste less like one. Usually that is the mix, 3 eggs, ½ cup oil and 1 cup milk, beaten 2 minutes.
3. Bake 25 to 30 minutes, until the top springs back and a skewer in the middle comes out with a crumb or two and no wet batter. Let it cool completely in the dish. Frosting a warm cake slides it off.
4. For the frosting, beat the softened butter on its own until it is pale and fluffy — a minute or two, and it must be soft or the cocoa will not go in smoothly. Sift in the cocoa and powdered sugar a bit at a time, beating in the ¼ cup of milk a tablespoon at a time between additions until it spreads, then a splash of vanilla and a pinch of salt.
5. Spread over the cooled cake.

VARIATION Sour cream or Greek yogurt for half the milk: a closer, softer crumb.

637 kcal · 7g protein · 78g carbs · 33g fat All pantry staples

NO. 272 · 8 SLICES · 35 MINS · MEDIUM · 35

Fudgy Chocolate Cake Bake

INGREDIENTS

- 1 box (15.25 oz) chocolate cake mix
- 3 eggs
- 3 cups milk
- ½ cup butter
- 1 pkg (3.4 oz) instant chocolate pudding mix

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F and butter a 9x13 dish.
2. Whisk the cake mix with the 3 eggs, 1¼ cups of the milk and the melted butter until smooth.
3. In a second bowl, whisk the pudding mix with the remaining 1¾ cups of milk for two minutes until it thickens. Do not cook it — it goes in soft.
4. Pour the cake batter into the dish, spoon the pudding over in blobs, and drag a knife through both once or twice. Two or three passes, not twenty: swirl it too far and it is one colour again.
5. Bake 28 minutes. The pudding stays fudgy, so a skewer will not come out clean — go by the cake around it, which should spring back.

VARIATION Half a cup of sour cream or Greek yogurt in place of half a cup of that milk makes the cake softer and richer.

448 kcal · 8g protein · 59g carbs · 20g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 248 · 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 8 HRS · IN-DEPTH · 40

Slow-Cooker Pulled Beef BBQ Feast

INGREDIENTS

- 3.75 lb beef roast
- 1 cup BBQ sauce 355
- 6 hamburger buns
- 2 cans (14.4 oz) corn
- 6 baked potatoes

METHOD

1. Cook beef roast in slow cooker on LOW for 8 hours; shred and toss with BBQ sauce. No bottle in the house? Recipe 355 makes barbecue sauce from the storehouse shelf.
2. Serve on buns alongside baked potatoes and corn.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, smoked paprika, cider vinegar* A sliced onion under the beef and garlic in with the sauce. A teaspoon of smoked paprika, and a splash of cider vinegar stirred through the pulled meat at the end. Bottled barbecue sauce is sweet; vinegar is what cuts it.

1143 kcal · 61g protein · 92g carbs · 59g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 249 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 35 MINS · IN-DEPTH 86

Homestyle Roasted Chicken & Gravy with Mashed Potatoes

INGREDIENTS

- 3 lbs chicken breasts
- 3 cups instant potatoes 362
- 1 pkg (0.87 oz) chicken gravy mix 356
- 2 cans (14.5 oz) green beans

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 400°F. Roast chicken breasts 25 mins. Roast until the thickest breast reads 165°F and the juices run clear.
2. Make up the mashed potatoes: about 3 cups of flakes to 3 cups of boiling water and a splash of milk. Whisk the gravy packet into 1 cup of cold water before heating it, or it goes lumpy. No packet? Recipe 356, stopped while the flour is still blond.
3. Serve chicken and gravy over potatoes with green beans.

BETTER WITH *Garlic powder, thyme, black pepper, lemon, Parmesan* Garlic powder, thyme and black pepper rubbed over the chicken before roasting. Lemon squeezed over at the table. A handful of grated Parmesan over the top for the last five minutes — salt, and a crust that a box never makes.

394 kcal · 55g protein · 30g carbs · 6g fat

Also needs: Gravy mix

NO. 271 6 SERVINGS · 55 MINS · MEDIUM 51

Warm Peach Cobbler

INGREDIENTS

- 1 can (29 oz) peaches, drained
- 1 cup pancake mix 360
- ½ cup sugar
- ¼ cup melted butter
- ½ cup milk

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F.
2. Pour the drained peaches into an 8-inch square baking dish.
3. Whisk pancake mix, sugar, butter, and milk into batter.
4. Pour batter over peaches and bake at 350°F for 45 to 50 mins, until the top is deep golden and a skewer in the middle of the topping comes out clean.

VARIATION Sour cream or Greek yogurt in place of half the milk gives a softer, closer crumb.

273 kcal · 3g protein · 45g carbs · 9g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 269 6 SERVINGS · 50 MINS · MEDIUM 64

Cinnamon Apple Crisp

INGREDIENTS

- 6 fresh apples (sliced)
- 1 cup oats
- ½ cup flour
- ½ cup butter
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp cinnamon

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F.
2. Toss sliced apples with 1 tsp cinnamon in an 8-inch square baking dish.
3. Mix oats, flour, melted butter, and brown sugar into crumble.
4. Spread crumble over apples and bake at 350°F for 45 mins, until the juices bubble at the edges and a knife slides into the apples easily.

413 kcal · 4g protein · 61g carbs · 17g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 270 4 DESSERT CUPS · 10 MINS · EASY 56

Chocolate Pudding Parfait Cups

INGREDIENTS

- 1 pkg (3.4 oz) instant chocolate pudding mix
- 2 cups milk
- 1 can (29 oz) peaches (diced)

METHOD

1. Whisk chocolate pudding mix with cold milk for 2 mins until set.
2. Layer in 4 dessert cups with diced peaches.

227 kcal · 5g protein · 45g carbs · 3g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 250 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 50 MINS · IN-DEPTH 47

Baked Ham with Brown Sugar Glaze

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb sliced ham
- ½ cup brown sugar
- 2 tbsp mustard
- 2 lbs potatoes
- 2 tbsp oil
- 1 tsp salt

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 400°F. Cut the potatoes into 1-inch chunks, toss them with the oil and the salt, and roast 25 minutes.
2. Mix the brown sugar and mustard. Turn the oven down to 350°F, brush the glaze over the ham slices, and bake them alongside the potatoes for 20 minutes, until the potatoes are browned and tender.
3. Serve the ham with the roasted potatoes.

453 kcal · 28g protein · 47g carbs · 17g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 251 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 40 MINS · IN-DEPTH 48

Cheesy Beef & Spaghetti Roll-Up Bake

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 16 oz spaghetti
- 1 jar (27.7 oz) spaghetti sauce
- ½ cup sour cream
- 1.5 cups cheddar

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 350°F. Boil the spaghetti two minutes short of the packet time — it finishes in the oven.
2. Brown beef with sauce.
3. Layer spaghetti, sour cream, beef sauce, and cheese in dish.
4. Bake 25 mins.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, oregano, parmesan* Onion and garlic with the beef, oregano into the sauce. Parmesan folded into the sour cream layer.

704 kcal · 42g protein · 71g carbs · 28g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 252 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 6 HRS · IN-DEPTH 38

Slow-Cooked Pork Carnitas Feast

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork roast
- 1 onion (chopped)
- 1 jar (26.5 oz) salsa
- 12 tortillas [359]
- 1 can (15 oz) black beans
- 2 cups dry rice
- sour cream

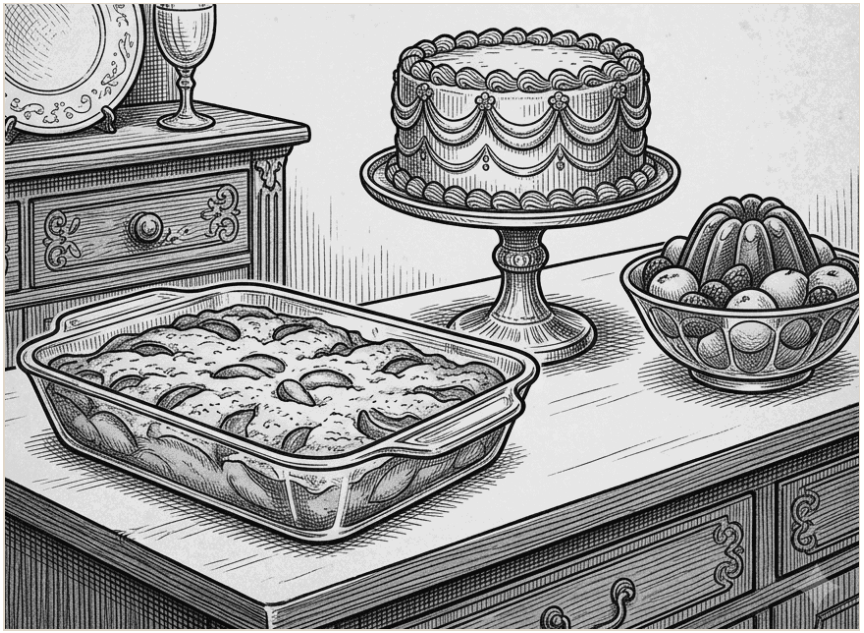
METHOD

1. Cook the pork roast in the slow cooker on LOW 6 hours with the salsa, then shred it. An onion first: chopped, into a hot skillet with a spoonful of the pork fat, and left until the edges go gold. Then add the shredded pork and sear it until crispy.
2. While the pork crisps, bring 4 cups of water to the boil with a pinch of salt, stir in the rice, cover, and simmer on the lowest heat 18 minutes. Leave it covered off the heat 5 minutes, then fluff it with a fork. Serve with the rice, beans, tortillas, and sour cream.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, Cumin and paprika* Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last minute of cooking — any longer and it burns bitter. A teaspoon of cumin and one of paprika in with the meat as it cooks. Or the taco seasoning: Recipe 310.

931 kcal · 42g protein · 112g carbs · 35g fat

All pantry staples



SECTION 5

Simple Family Treats & Desserts

Sweets, made from what is on the shelf.

26 RECIPES

NO. 268 6 SERVINGS · 1 HR 15 MINS · IN-DEPTH 57

Chicken-Fried Steak from the Roast, with Cream Gravy

A Roast, Pounded Thin

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs beef roast, trimmed
- 1 tsp salt
- ½ tsp black pepper
- 1 cup flour, for the dredge
- 2 eggs
- ½ cup milk, for the dredge
- ⅓ cup oil
- 3 tbsp flour, for the gravy
- 2 cups milk, for the gravy

METHOD

1. Put the beef roast in the freezer 30 minutes. Firm, it slices cleanly.
2. Cut it across the grain into 6 slices about ½ inch thick, trimming away the thick seams of fat and gristle.
3. Lay each slice between plastic wrap and pound it with a meat mallet or a heavy pan to ¼ inch. This is what makes a chuck roast tender enough to fry; do not skip it. Season both sides with the salt and pepper.
4. Put the dredge flour in one shallow dish and whisk the eggs with the ½ cup of milk in another. Coat each steak in flour, then egg, then flour again, pressing it on. Let them sit 10 minutes so the coating sets.
5. Heat the oil in a large heavy skillet to 350°F, or until a pinch of flour sizzles at once. Fry the steaks two or three at a time, 3 to 4 minutes a side, until deep golden and cooked through, the middle reading 160°F. Drain them on a rack, not paper, so the bottoms stay crisp.
6. Pour off all but 3 tablespoons of the fat. Whisk in the 3 tablespoons of flour and cook 1 minute, then whisk in the 2 cups of milk a little at a time and simmer 3 to 5 minutes, until thick. Season it, and pour it over the steaks.

481 kcal · 33g protein · 13g carbs · 33g fat All pantry staples

NO. 253 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 40 MINS · IN-DEPTH 39

Chicken Cordon Bleu Casserole

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs chicken breast
- 8 oz sliced ham
- 2 cans (10.5 oz) cream of chicken soup 361
- 1 cup cheddar
- 2 cups dry rice

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F.
2. Pound the thick end of each breast level so they cook evenly. Layer the chicken breasts and ham slices in a 9x13 dish and cover with the cream soup and cheddar.
3. Bake at 375°F for 30 mins. Whole breasts under a blanket of sauce take longer than you expect. Check the thickest one reads 165°F before serving.
4. While it bakes, bring 4 cups of water to the boil with a pinch of salt, stir in the rice, cover, and simmer on the lowest heat 18 minutes. Leave it covered off the heat 5 minutes, then fluff it with a fork. Serve the chicken over the rice.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, mustard, thyme, parmesan* A teaspoon of mustard into the cream soup — mustard is what makes cordon bleu taste like cordon bleu. Onion, garlic and thyme in with it, parmesan on top.

607 kcal · 51g protein · 58g carbs · 19g fat All pantry staples

NO. 254 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 1 HR 40 MINS · IN-DEPTH 66

Braised Stewing Beef over Rice

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs stewing beef
- 2 onions
- 1 pkg (0.87 oz) brown gravy mix 356
- 3 cups cooked rice
- 2 cans (14.5 oz) green beans

METHOD

1. Simmer the stewing beef and onions in the gravy mix with 2 cups water, covered, on low for 1.5 hours until tender, adding a splash of water if it gets too thick. No packet? Simmer the beef and onions in 2 cups of plain water instead, and turn that liquid into gravy at the end with Recipe 356.
2. Serve over warm white rice with green beans.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, A bottle of vinegar* Two cloves of garlic, chopped fine, in after the onion and before the liquid. Thirty seconds is enough; it only needs to smell. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself.

458 kcal · 33g protein · 32g carbs · 22g fat

Also needs: Gravy mix

NO. 267 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 30 MINS · IN-DEPTH 45

Ultimate Family Taco & Nacho Grand Platter

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 12 tortillas (baked crisp) 359
- 1 can (15 oz) black beans
- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn
- 1.5 cups cheddar
- salsa
- sour cream
- 2 tbsp taco seasoning (optional) 310

METHOD

1. Brown the beef in a hot pan, breaking it up, and drain it. Stir in 2 tbsp taco seasoning and ¼ cup water and let it bubble a minute, until the liquid has gone and the meat is coated. No packet in the house? Recipe 310 makes taco seasoning from seven pantry spices.
2. Bake tortilla wedges at 400°F 8 mins until crisp.
3. Top with the beef, beans, corn, and cheese; melt under broiler 3 mins. Serve with salsa/sour cream.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic* Two cloves of garlic, chopped, into the pan for the last thirty seconds before the liquid goes in — any longer and it burns bitter.

673 kcal · 40g protein · 63g carbs · 29g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 266 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 8 HRS · IN-DEPTH 62

Slow-Cooker Beef Stew Meat in Rich Tomato Sauce

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs stewing beef
- 2 cans (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 2 lbs potatoes
- 2 cans (14.5 oz) green beans

METHOD

1. Brown the stewing beef in a hot pan, dark on every side. The cooker cannot make that crust, and the stew tastes of it for hours. Place it in the slow cooker with the quartered potatoes and the tomato sauce. Keep the green beans out — they are cooked already, in the can, and eight hours turns them to threads.
2. Cook on LOW for 8 hours until the beef falls apart, then stir the drained green beans through and give them 10 minutes to warm.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, bay, thyme, Worcestershire* A quartered onion, garlic and a bay leaf in with the beef. Thyme and a splash of Worcestershire into the tomato sauce.

482 kcal · 34g protein · 37g carbs · 22g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 255 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 40 MINS · IN-DEPTH 56

Savory Beef & Vegetable Cobbler

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn
- 1 can (14.5 oz) green beans
- 1 can (14.5 oz) carrots
- 1 pkg (0.87 oz) beef gravy mix
  356
- 2 cups flour
- 1 tbsp baking powder
- 4 tbsp butter
- ¾ cup milk
- salt

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F.
2. Brown the beef and drain it. Drain the vegetables, stir them in, and make up the gravy as the packet says. No packet? Recipe 356, browned dark and made with a cup of water, does the same job.
3. Rub the cold butter into the flour, baking powder and a teaspoon of salt until crumbly, then stir in the milk until it just comes together.
4. Spoon the beef into a 9x13-inch baking dish, drop the dough over it in rough spoonfuls, and bake 25 minutes until the topping is golden and dry at the centre.

VARIATION Sour cream or plain Greek yogurt in place of a quarter cup of the milk makes the topping softer and taller.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, thyme, Worcestershire, A bottle of vinegar* Onion and garlic with the beef, thyme into the gravy. A splash of Worcestershire before the topping goes on. A teaspoon of vinegar stirred in at the end, off the heat. It does not taste of vinegar; it tastes like the pot woke up.

513 kcal · 30g protein · 51g carbs · 21g fat

Also needs: Gravy mix

NO. 256 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 55 MINS · IN-DEPTH 57

Roasted Pork Loin with Garlic Potatoes

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork roast
- 2 lbs potatoes
- 1 lb carrots
- 4 tbsp butter
- garlic powder
- 1 tsp salt

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F.
2. Cut the potatoes into 1½-inch chunks and the carrots into thick batons; they roast in the same time. Season the pork roast, potatoes and carrots with the salt, garlic powder and melted butter.
3. Roast on one pan at 375°F for 50 mins, until the thickest part of the pork reads 145°F. Rest the pork 10 minutes before slicing.

567 kcal · 29g protein · 34g carbs · 35g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 265 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 30 MINS · IN-DEPTH 70

Country Fried Chicken Breasts with Gravy

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs chicken breasts
- 1 cup flour, for the dredge
- 2 tbsp flour, for the gravy
- 2 cups milk
- 2 tbsp butter
- 2 tbsp oil
- 3 cups mashed potatoes 362

METHOD

1. Pound the thick end of each breast level so they fry evenly. Dip the chicken in ½ cup of the milk, then coat it in the dredge flour.
2. Heat the butter and oil in a large skillet over medium and pan-fry the chicken in batches, 5 mins per side until crispy. A crisp crust is not proof it is cooked. Check the thickest part reads 165°F. Rest it five minutes before cutting. Throw away the dipping milk and leftover dredge.
3. Pour off all but 2 tbsp of the pan fat, whisk in the 2 tbsp flour and cook a minute, then whisk in the remaining 1½ cups of milk a splash at a time and simmer until it thickens. Salt and pepper it well and serve over the potatoes. Recipe 356 is this gravy, step by step.

BETTER WITH *Garlic powder, paprika, black pepper, hot sauce, A bottle of vinegar* Garlic powder, paprika and plenty of black pepper into the flour before dredging. Seasoned flour is the difference between fried chicken and fried breading. A few dashes of hot sauce into the milk you dip it in. A teaspoon of vinegar stirred in at the end, off the heat. It does not taste of vinegar; it tastes like the pot woke up.

438 kcal · 40g protein · 29g carbs · 18g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 264 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 55 MINS · IN-DEPTH 64

Roasted Pork Loin with Peach Glaze

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb pork roast
- 1 can (29 oz) peaches, drained
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- 1 tbsp mustard

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 375°F.
2. Puree the drained peaches with the brown sugar and mustard, then simmer in a small pan 10 to 15 minutes until it is thick enough to coat a spoon. Keep it back for now: brushed on at the start it has fifty minutes to burn, and burnt sugar is bitter all the way through.
3. Bake the pork roast at 375°F for 35 minutes, then brush half the glaze over and give it 15 minutes more, brushing again halfway. Done is 145°F at the thickest part, and it wants 10 minutes' rest before slicing. Serve the rest of the glaze as a sauce.

431 kcal · 26g protein · 21g carbs · 27g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 257 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 45 MINS · IN-DEPTH 54

Loaded Chicken Enchilada Grand Bake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs chicken breast (shredded)
- 12 tortillas 359
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 1 can (15 oz) black beans
- 1.5 cups cheddar
- 2 tbsp taco seasoning (optional) 310

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F.
2. Pat the chicken dry and lay it in a hot pan, and do not move it until the underside is brown; turn it and cook it through, 165°F with no pink at the centre, then shred it. It will not cook through once it is rolled up and covered in sauce.
3. Toss the shredded chicken with 2 tbsp taco seasoning and a splash of water, until the liquid has gone and the meat is coated. No packet in the house? Recipe 310 makes taco seasoning from seven pantry spices.
4. Fill the tortillas with the chicken and beans and roll them into a 9x13 dish, seam side down.
5. Cover with the tomato sauce and the cheddar.
6. Bake 30 minutes.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, cumin, cilantro, lime* Onion and garlic into the chicken filling, cumin with the seasoning. Cilantro and lime at the end.

616 kcal · 51g protein · 58g carbs · 20g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 258 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 8 HRS · IN-DEPTH 60

Sunday Pot Roast with Glazed Carrots

INGREDIENTS

- 3.75 lb beef roast
- 2 lbs carrots
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- 2 tbsp butter
- 2 lbs potatoes

METHOD

1. Sear the roast hard on both sides in a hot skillet, 3 minutes a side. This is where the colour and most of the flavour of the gravy comes from, and a slow cooker cannot do it.
2. Put the roast and the quartered potatoes in the slow cooker with 1 cup of water and a good pinch of salt, and cook on LOW for 8 hours until a fork twists in the meat with no effort.
3. Slice the carrots into ¼-inch coins and put them in a wide skillet with the brown sugar, the butter, ½ cup of water and a pinch of salt. Cover and simmer 8 minutes, then uncover and cook 5 to 7 minutes more, until the liquid has gone syrupy and coats them.
4. Rest the roast 10 minutes before slicing it across the grain. The liquid left in the cooker makes Recipe 356, poured over.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, bay, thyme, black pepper, Soy sauce* A quartered onion and two cloves of garlic in the cooker with the roast, and a bay leaf. Thyme and black pepper over the meat before searing. A tablespoon of soy sauce in with the liquid. Nobody tastes soy; they taste more beef.

956 kcal · 54g protein · 50g carbs · 60g fat All pantry staples

NO. 263 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 25 MINS · IN-DEPTH 55

Creamy Beef Stroganoff over Noodles

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of mushroom soup
- 1 cup sour cream
- 1 cup water
- 16 oz ribbon pasta

METHOD

1. Boil ribbon pasta 8 mins.
2. Brown the beef over medium-high about 8 minutes and drain it. Stir in the soup and the water and simmer 5 minutes. Take the pan off the heat before the sour cream goes in — boiled, it splits and will not come back. No mushroom soup? Recipe 361 does the same job.
3. Serve over ribbon noodles.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, paprika, Worcestershire* A diced onion softened before the beef, garlic in at the end of browning. A teaspoon of paprika and a splash of Worcestershire with the soup. Stroganoff without paprika is beef in white sauce.

587 kcal · 34g protein · 61g carbs · 23g fat All pantry staples

NO. 262 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 4 HRS 20 MINS · IN-DEPTH 77

Slow-Cooked Salisbury Steak Patties with Gravy

INGREDIENTS

- 1.5 lbs ground beef (formed into 6 patties)
- 1 onion
- 1 pkg (0.87 oz) brown gravy mix 356
- 3 cups instant potatoes 362

METHOD

1. Sear beef patties in skillet 3 mins per side.
2. Put the patties in the slow cooker with the sliced onions. Whisk the gravy packet into 1½ cups of water and pour it over — dry powder alone will not make gravy. Cook on LOW for 4 hours. No packet? Use plain water and make Recipe 356 from the liquid.
3. Stir the instant potatoes into 3 cups of boiling water, let them stand a minute, and serve the patties and their gravy over them.

BETTER WITH *A head of garlic, A bottle of vinegar* Two cloves of garlic, chopped fine, in after the onion and before the liquid. Thirty seconds is enough; it only needs to smell. Finish with a teaspoon of vinegar, off the heat. Everything in the pot tastes more like itself.

328 kcal · 26g protein · 29g carbs · 12g fat

Also needs: Gravy mix

NO. 259 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 40 MINS · IN-DEPTH 58

Creamy Tomato Chicken Pasta Bake

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs chicken breast
- 16 oz ribbon pasta
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 1 can (10.5 oz) cream of chicken 361
- 1 cup cheddar

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350°F.
2. Pat the chicken dry and lay it in a hot pan, and do not move it until the underside is brown; turn it and cook it through, 165°F with no pink at the centre, then dice it. Raw breast stirred into sauce and baked twenty-five minutes is not reliably done.
3. Boil the pasta two minutes short of the packet time; it finishes in the oven.
4. Mix the chicken, pasta, tomato sauce, cream soup and cheese in a 9x13 dish.
5. Bake 25 minutes.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, oregano, parmesan* Onion and garlic in the tomato sauce, oregano with them. Parmesan over the top.

582 kcal · 50g protein · 64g carbs · 14g fat

All pantry staples

NO. 260 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 45 MINS · IN-DEPTH 48

Hearty Country Beef Chili & Corn Skillet Bread

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lbs ground beef
- 2 cans (15 oz) pinto beans
- 1 can (14.4 oz) tomato sauce
- 1 cup cheddar
- 2 cups pancake mix [360]
- 1 can (14.4 oz) corn
- 2 eggs
- 1 cup milk
- 1 tbsp butter

METHOD

1. Brown the beef in a large pot, breaking it up, until no pink remains, and drain off the fat. Add the drained beans and the tomato sauce and simmer 30 minutes.
2. Heat the oven to 400°F with a 9-inch oven-safe skillet inside, the butter in the skillet. Meanwhile whisk the pancake mix with the eggs and milk into a thick batter, and fold in the drained corn.
3. Pour the batter into the hot skillet. It should hiss — that is where the crust comes from, and a cold pan will not give you one.
4. Bake 20 to 25 minutes, until the top is golden and a knife in the middle comes out clean. No oven-safe skillet? A buttered cake pan works — you lose the crust, not the bread.
5. Serve the chili topped with the cheddar, with the bread cut into wedges alongside.

VARIATION Sour cream or Greek yogurt for a quarter cup of the milk keeps the corn bread moist.

BETTER WITH *Onion, garlic, smoked paprika, cocoa* Onion and garlic with the beef. Smoked paprika, and a tablespoon of cocoa powder into the pot. Cocoa in chili does not taste of chocolate; it makes the whole thing taste deeper and older than it is.

685 kcal · 48g protein · 58g carbs · 29g fat All pantry staples

NO. 261 6 LARGE FEAST SERVINGS · 70 MINS · IN-DEPTH 43

Glazed Ham & Cheesy Scalloped Potatoes

INGREDIENTS

- 2 lb sliced ham
- 2 lbs potatoes (sliced thin)
- 2 cups milk
- 2 tbsp flour
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1.5 cups cheddar
- ¼ cup brown sugar
- 1 tsp mustard
- salt
- pepper

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 375°F. Slice the potatoes as thin as you can — a quarter inch or less — and simmer them in salted water for 8 minutes. They will not cook through under the sauce otherwise, however long you give them.
2. Melt the butter in a saucepan over medium-low, whisk in the flour and let it cook a full minute — it should look like wet sand. Add the milk a splash at a time, whisking smooth after each, and let it come to a bare simmer until it thickens.
3. Off the heat, stir in a cup of the cheddar a handful at a time. Off the heat matters: boiled, cheese goes grainy and the fat splits out. Salt and pepper it, and taste — under sauce, thin potato needs more salt than seems right.
4. Layer the drained potatoes and the sauce in a buttered dish, finishing with sauce, and scatter the last half cup of cheddar over. Bake 40 minutes, until a knife goes through the middle with no resistance and the top has browned.
5. Meanwhile the glaze the title promises: stir the brown sugar and mustard together, spread it over the ham slices in a second dish, and give them 15 minutes in the same oven until the sugar has gone shiny and dark at the edges. Serve them with the potatoes.

VARIATION Half a cup of sour cream in the sauce gives it body and tang.

575 kcal · 38g protein · 45g carbs · 27g fat All pantry staples